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National & States Affairs

News - 1

- Sarbananda Sonowal (Min. of PS&W) – launched "Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI)" for FY25
  - During – 37th Foundation Day celebrations of Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) in Mumbai
- LPPI – a national benchmarking mechanism designed to assess & improve operational performance of Indian ports
  - It is developed under 'Sagar Aankalan' framework
- LPPI evaluates ports across 3 cargo segments – dry bulk, liquid bulk & container cargo
- Union Minister also launched 4 digital initiatives developed by Directorate General of Shipping (DGS)
  - A 24x7 grievance redressal module under 'e-Navik' platform | A medical practitioner module
  - A ship registration module on 'e-Samudra' platform | A unified ship recycling credit note module
- He also unveiled unified ship recycling portal for ship recycling credit scheme
  - A part of government's Rs 70,000 Cr maritime development package announced in 2025
- Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Sarbananda Sonowal | Constituency – Dibrugarh, Assam

  MoS in Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Shantanu Thakur

News - 2

- ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India (AM/NS India) – 1st company approved for Strategic Investment Plan (SIP) under Rs 60,000-Cr PM-SETU scheme
- National Steering Committee (NSC) – chaired by Debashree Mukherjee
  - It approved SIP for Visakhapatnam ITI Cluster, Andhra Pradesh during 3rd meeting in New Delhi
- Andhra Pradesh – 1st state to operationalise industry partnership under PM-SETU
- PM-SETU – vocational education & training upgradation scheme approved by Union Cabinet 2025
  - It aims to upgrade 1,000 Govt ITIs via hub-and-spoke model
- HQs of ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India – Hazira, Gujarat | Chairman – Aditya Mittal | CEO – Dilip Oommen

News - 3

- Jyotiraditya M. Scindia (Min. for DoNER) & Himanta Biswa Sarma (CM of Assam) – launched "Mission Senehjori"
  - For Assam Muga Silk | Investment – ₹396-411 Cr over 3 years (including ₹136-151 Cr from MDoNER)
  - Anchored by – MDoNER
- Muga silk – world's only naturally golden silk & India's 1st Geographical Indication-tagged silk
- Assam produces 90% of world's Muga silk | Its current producer earnings – ₹18,000-21,000 per year
- It covers entire Muga silk value chain across 8 districts – Jorhat, Sivasagar, Lakhimpur, Dhemaji, Dibrugarh, Tinsukia, Majuli & Sualkuchi
- It targets establishment of 5 modernised Muga reeling units & a Muga Spun Mill
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

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- Minister of DoNER: Jyotiraditya M. Scindia | Constituency – Guna, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of DoNER: Sukanta Majumdar

News - 4

- Manohar Lal (Min. for H&UA) – launched "Swachha App" in Kolkata
  - It is a geo-tagged mobile platform developed under 'Swachh Bharat Mission', available in Bengali, Hindi & English
- It is being rolled out as a pilot project across 10 civic bodies – Asansol Municipal Corporation, Durgapur Municipal Corporation, Basirhat Municipality, Pujali Municipality, Tufanganj Municipality, Contai Municipality, Krishnanagar Municipality, Baidyabati Municipality, Nalhati Municipality & Madhyamgram Municipality
- Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs: Manohar Lal Khattar | Constituency – Karnal, Haryana
  MoS in Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs: Tokhan Sahu

News - 5

- DIBD (MeitY) – launched "VYOMA Innovation Challenge"
  - To encourage development of open-source, multilingual & voice-first AI solutions that can operate in offline & low-connectivity environments
  - It has been launched in collaboration with – Current AI & Kalpa Impact
- It builds on 'Sunno Sutra', a multilingual, voice-first, open-source handheld AI reference device
  - Jointly developed by – BHASHINI & Current AI
- 'Sunno Sutra' was unveiled at – 'IndiaAI Impact Summit 2026'
- Winning teams will be eligible for prizes worth up to Rs 80 lakh
- HQs of Bhashini – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag

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News - 6

- MSDE launched "Navachar Mantra", a national initiative at IIT Delhi, New Delhi
  - To identify, nurture & scale grassroots innovations & early-stage entrepreneurship
  - Inaugurated by – Jayant Chaudhary (MoS (I/C) for SD&E & MoS for Education)
- Implemented by – National Institute for Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development (NIESBUD)
  - In partnership with Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer, IIT Delhi, as Technical Knowledge Partner
- Registrations open on Skill India Digital Hub until – July 5, 2026
- It focuses on innovators from Tier-2 & Tier-3 towns, aspirational districts & underserved geographies across 6 sectors:
  - Agritech, HealthTech, EdTech & Skilling, Climate & Sustainability, Rural Commerce and MSME Enablement
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship: Jayant Chaudhary | Constituency – Mathura, UP

Join us

News - 7

- Cabinet approved one-time budgetary support not exceeding ₹10,000 Cr for Oil Marketing Companies
  - To provide Aviation Turbine Fuel price stabilisation support to Scheduled Indian Airlines for both domestic & international operations
- ATF prices – surged nearly 2.5 times to ₹142 per litre in May 2026 (from ₹60.50 per litre in March 2026)
- ATF accounts for ~40% of airline operating costs under normal conditions & up to 60% during extreme volatility period
- When international ATF prices moderate, differential is recovered from OMCs & returned to Consolidated Fund of India
- Under arrangement, participating Scheduled Indian carriers will procure ATF exclusively from OMCs for up to 3 years
  - Overall support will remain in force for 36 months

News - 8

- Maruti Suzuki India Ltd – launched India's 1st flex-fuel car, Wagon R, from E20 to E100
- Hero MotoCorp – launched its 1st flex-fuel motorcycles in Indian market, Hero Splendor Plus & HF Deluxe
- HQs of Maruti Suzuki India – New Delhi | Chairman – R. C. Bhargava | MD & CEO – Hisashi Takeuchi

News - 9

- PFRDA launched "StAR NPS" platform, a new digital onboarding framework for NPS
  - Developed by – Bombay Stock Exchange Limited (BSE) Technologies Private Limited (BTPL)
- On successful completion of KYC & onboarding formalities, a subscriber will initiate 1st contribution through platform
  - Contribution will be directly remitted to Trustee Bank
- Upon confirmation of receipt of funds, Permanent Retirement Account Number (PRAN) will be generated through integration with CRA systems
- Onboarding of NPS accounts under this framework would cost Rs 200 plus any applicable taxes
- Currently, framework applies only to resident Indian individuals aged 18 years & above & up to 85 years

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News - 10

- CCEA approved 4 major national highway projects worth more than Rs 24,200 Cr across Odisha, Telangana, Bihar & MP
- Among largest projects approved is construction of a new coastal highway between Rameshwar & Paradip in Odisha
  - Estimated cost – Rs 8,300.79 Cr | Corridor length – 160.18-km | To be developed under Hybrid Annuity Model
  - It will pass through Khurda, Puri, Kendrapada & Jagatsinghpur districts
- CCEA approved Armoor-Jagtial-Mancherial section of NH-63 & Jagtial-Karimnagar section of NH-563 in Telangana
  - Cost – Rs 7,597.16 Cr | Length – 190.76-km
  - To be implemented through a mix of HAM & Build Operate Transfer (Toll) models
- CCEA approved upgradation of 143.53-km Khagaria-Purnea section of NH-31 & NH-231 in Bihar
  - Cost – Rs 3,936.05 Cr under BOT (Toll) model | It includes a 6.73-km greenfield bypass around Purnea city
- CCEA approved highway upgrades on key stretches of NH-347B in Madhya Pradesh

Join us

- Cost – Rs 4,415.60 Cr under HAM model
- It involves upgrading Hiwarkhedi-Roshni-Ashapur-Rudhy section into a two-lane highway with paved shoulders & widening Deshgaon-Julwania stretch to four lanes
- It will also include a 16.2-km greenfield bypass in Khargone district

News - 11

- Centre decided to expand its QR tagging initiative for FCI foodgrain bags, with plans to implement system across 3 states
  - Andhra Pradesh, Telangana & Odisha (in ongoing marketing season)
- HQs of FCI – New Delhi | CMD – Rabindra Kumar Agarwal

News - 12

- Ladakh Lt. Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena – laid foundation for India's 1st Model Border Village at Chumur, Ladakh (16,700 ft, India-China border) under Vibrant Village Programme (VVP)
- Chumur – 1st of 10 border villages in Phase-1 of VVP in Ladakh
- Project is structured around 4 pillars: Infrastructure; Employment & Livelihood Creation; All-Weather Functionality; Civilian-Defence Integration
- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena

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News - 13

- Government's wheat procurement for 2026-27 rabi marketing season – reached 35 million tonnes (MT)
  - It represents a 17% y-o-y increase from 30 MT procured in 2025-26 season | Revised seasonal target – 34.5 MT
- FCI & state agencies procured wheat at MSP of ₹2,425 per quintal for 2026-27
- Domestic wheat production for 2025-26 crop year (July-June) – 120.65 MT

News - 14

- Gujarat State Police – launched "Operation Delta Hunt", a crackdown on illegal Bangladeshi nationals
  - Announced by – Harsh Sanghavi (Gujarat Deputy CM & Home Minister)
- By city, highest arrests within first 72 hours came from – Ahmedabad city (155), Surat city (84), Ahmedabad rural (34), East Kutch-Gandhinagar (13) & Bharuch (12)
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 15

- GoI, through OEA (under DPIIT) approved revision of base year of WPI from 2011-12 to 2022-23 & compilation of Producer Price Indices (PPIs)
- Revised WPI series (base year 2022-23=100) & 3 new PPI series are scheduled for simultaneous release on Jun 15, 2026:
  - Output Producer Price Index (OPPI) | Trial Input Producer Price Index (IPPI)

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- Service Producer Price Index (Service PPI)

- PPI addresses 3 structural limitations of WPI: Its exclusion of services (~55% of India's GDP)
  - Its inbuilt double-counting bias arising from tracking same product at multiple wholesale stages
  - Its divergence from internationally agreed System of National Accounts (SNA) framework

News - 16

- DGFT tightened silver import restrictions by mandating a valid Import Authorisation from DGFT for 4 specific HS code categories:
  - Silver powder (HS code 71061000) | Silver grains (HS code 71069110)
  - Silver containing 99.9% or more by weight (HS code 71069120) | Silver not elsewhere specified (HS code 71069190)
- Imports through nominated agencies notified by RBI (in case of banks) & by DGFT (in case of other agencies) will henceforth be permitted only against a valid Import Authorisation issued by DGFT
- Imports by qualified jewellers notified by IFSCA for import through IIBX are similarly required to secure a valid Import Authorisation from DGFT
- Existing provision permitting silver dore to be imported by refineries against a licence with an AU Condition has been retained
- HQs of DGFT – New Delhi | Director General – Lav Aggarwal

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News - 17

- APEDA – flagged off 1st commercial consignment of fresh mangoes from Jharkhand to the UK
- Consignment – 1.5 MT of Amrapali mangoes from Beura Farmer Producer Company Ltd (an all-women FPC)
- Amrapali mango (grown in Jharkhand) – recognised for quality characteristics & market acceptance
- Jharkhand: Capital – Ranchi | CM – Hemant Soren | Governor – Santosh Kumar Gangwar
- HQs of APEDA – New Delhi | Chairman – Abhishek Dev | Established in – 1986 (functions under Ministry of C&I)

News - 18

- Kirti Vardhan Singh – launched 'NZP Saathi App' & inaugurated Self-ticketing Kiosks at National Zoological Park (NZP)
- It offers 4 tour formats – Express, Family, Grand Zoo & personalised My Tour
- NZP (New Delhi) – established 1959 | Administered under MoEFCC
- Minister of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Bhupender Yadav | Constituency – Alwar, Rajasthan
  MoS in Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Kirtivardhan Singh

News - 19

- UGC – formally presented Letter of Approval (LoA) to University of Liverpool, UK, on Jun 4, 2026, in Bengaluru
  - Enabling it to establish its International Branch Campus at Alembic City, Whitefield, Bengaluru, Karnataka
  - Operations commencing from – Aug 2026

Join us

- University of Liverpool became:
  - 2nd UK university to receive permission to establish an International Branch Campus in India under "UGC (Setting Up and Operation of Campuses of Foreign Higher Educational Institutions in India) Regulations, 2023"
    - After University of Southampton
  - 1st UK Russell Group university to receive such approval for a campus in South India
- A Letter of Intent (LoI) had been granted to University of Liverpool on May 26, 2025 under same UGC Regulations
- HQs of UGC – New Delhi | Chairman – Dr. Vineet Joshi | Founded in – 1956

News - 20

- GoI constituted 6 sector-specific working groups to identify as many as 100 products for promoting their domestic manufacturing & reducing import dependence
- These groups will be chaired by secretary in DPIIT
- India's imports – up 7.5% to $775 billion in 2025-26

News - 21

- Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Ballia, UP) – designated India's 100th Ramsar site under Ramsar Convention
  - It is 13th Ramsar Site situated in UP
- India now possesses highest number of Ramsar Sites in Asia & ranks 3rd globally (behind UK (176) & Mexico (144))
- It was originally declared a bird sanctuary by UP government in 1991 | It falls strictly under Central Asian Flyway
- India became a Contracting Party to 'Ramsar Convention' on Feb 1, 1982
- Ramsar Convention – signed in Ramsar, Iran, in 1971

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News - 22

- Government of India – reduced annual subsidised LPG cylinders under PMUY from 9 to 4 for beneficiaries
- PMUY – launched in May 2016 to provide deposit-free 14.2-kg LPG connections to adult women from poor households
  - initially 12 cylinders/year (reduced to 9 in 2025, & now 4)
- Govt introduced a targeted subsidy of Rs 200 per 14.2-kg LPG cylinder in May 2022
  - It increased to Rs 300 per cylinder in Oct 2023 with proportionate benefit for 5-kg cylinders

News - 23

- Department of Consumer Affairs – amended SoP (Dec 29, 2023) for net quantity & standard pack sizes of edible oils & fats under Legal Metrology
- Standard pack sizes – 200 ml/g, 500 ml/g, 1 litre/kg, 2 litre/kg, 3 litre/kg, 4 litre/kg, 5 litre/kg, 15 litre/kg, 20 litre/kg
- Packs <200 ml/g – exempt to ensure affordable small-quantity options | Minor & niche oils also exempt
- Manufacturers, packers & importers – granted 3-month transition to comply with revised norms

Join us

News - 24

- Kerala – launched upgraded HAWK as India's 1st fully digitised, judiciary-integrated wildlife offence management system
- HAWK – first instance in India linking forest enforcement records with District Court Management System (DCMS)
  - Developed with – Wildlife Trust of India | Supported by – NTT Data Corporation
- Idea conceived after – Malayatoor Elephant Poaching Case (19 elephants killed)
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 25

- APSEZ – secured a 10-year marine services contract for Argentina's 1st liquefied natural gas (LNG) export project
  - Awarded to Adani Harbour International FZCO (APSEZ's subsidiary) through a consortium with Meridian Group (Argentina)
  - Worth – $70 million
- It will be executed through Meridian Transportes Marítimos S.A., a 51:49 JV between Adani Harbour & Meridian Group
- In its 1st phase, project is expected to produce 2.45 million tonnes of LNG annually
- HQs APSEZ – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | CEO – Ashwani Gupta

News - 26

- Amit Shah (Home Min.) – launched Land Port Management System (LPMS), named "VINIMAY", in New Delhi
  - It is an integrated digital platform for land port management
- It eliminates approx 90% of paperwork through introduction of a Single Electronic Window & an Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR)-based gate operation system
- MHA is implementing a 4-pronged 'Smart Borders' strategy in which Land Ports Authority of India serves as a key pillar
- 15 land ports are currently operational across India
- Land port trade – grown to ₹83,000 crore in 2026 (from ₹5,000 crore in 2014)
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

News - 27

- APEDA – facilitated 1st export consignment of GI-tagged 'Tezpur Litchi' from Assam to Dubai on Jun 7, 2026
  - With a 1-metric-tonne shipment exported through M/s DMR Green Valley Agro Fresh Pvt. Ltd.
- APEDA facilitated multiple 1st-time GI-tagged agri exports from northeastern states in 2025-26, including:
  - 25 metric tonnes of Assam's GI-tagged Joha Rice to UK & Italy in Mar 2026
- HQs of APEDA – New Delhi | Chairman – Abhishek Dev | Established in – 1986 (functions under Ministry of C&I)

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News - 28

- Rajnath Singh – approved establishment of a 250 MW Solar Power Project integrated with a Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) at Sitapur (Ex-Cantonment), UP
  - To be developed on approximately 850 acres of vacant defence land
  - 1st large-scale solar power generation facility with BESS support on defence land to be undertaken by MoD
- It will be implemented by – NTPC Limited
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 29

- India's solar power capacity – grown to 155 GW in 2026 (from 2.8 GW in 2014)
- India's solar additions in FY26 – reached 44.61 GW
- As per IRENA's 'Renewable Energy Statistics 2026' report: India surpassed US in annual solar capacity additions in 2025 to become world's 2nd largest solar growth market
- China – first/largest solar growth market, adding 315 GW of solar capacity in 2025
- India's total non-fossil fuel-based installed electricity capacity – now exceeds 50% of total installed capacity

News - 30

- MoE issued 3 Letters of Approval (LoA) to 3 globally reputed Foreign Higher Education Institutions (FHEIs)
  - University of Bristol – to establish its Mumbai Enterprise Campus
  - University of York – to establish its 1st overseas campus in Mumbai
  - University of New South Wales – to establish UNSW Bengaluru (to open from Aug 2026 at Manyata Business Park)
- Overall, 5 LoAs have now been issued under UGC Regulations for FHEIs, including University of Southampton & University of Liverpool
- UGC also issued 10 Letters of Intent (LoIs) to other globally reputed FHEIs from UK, US, Australia & Italy
  - For establishing campuses across India
- Deakin University, University of Wollongong & Queen's University Belfast – already started operations in GIFT City
- Minister of Education: Dharmendra Pradhan | Constituency – Sambalpur, Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Education: Jayant Chaudhary & Sukanta Majumdar

News - 31

- Andhra Pradesh – launched "Yogandhra-2026", at Veerabhadra Swamy Temple premises in Lepakshi, Sri Sathya Sai
  - It is a statewide yoga promotion & awareness campaign (Jun 7-20, 2026)
- Online registrations – opened on Yogandhra portal on Jun 7
- In terms of registrations, leading district – Guntur (98,000) | Followed by – Nellore, Nandyal, Kurnool & Palnadu
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

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News - 32

- Assam's first "Blue Valley Cluster" (an industrial hub focused on flavours, fragrances & AYUSH) – launched
  - AYUSH – Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homoeopathy
- It aligns with priorities outlined in 'EU-India Comprehensive Strategic Agenda' adopted at 'EU-India Summit' in Jan 2026
- Assam Industrial Development Corporation Ltd + Federation of European Businesses in India = an MoU to promote investment awareness, B2B & B2G linkages, and knowledge exchange
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya
- HQs of EU – Brussels, Belgium | Member Countries – 27

  President of European Parliament – Roberta Metsola

  President of European Council – António Costa

  President of European Commission – Ursula von der Leyen

News - 33

- Air India – launched its 1st "Easy Connect" flights under GoI's 'hub-and-spoke' aviation model
  - With services from Varanasi scheduled to commence on Jun 25, 2026
- Easy Connect service from Varanasi to Delhi will operate daily as flight AI1111
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Campbell Wilson (subsidiary of Tata Group)

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News - 34

- GoI announced a Rs 1.25 lakh Cr framework for rural development under "VB-GRAMG", w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026
  - VB-GRAMG – Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission
- Centre already allocated Rs 30,000 Cr under 'Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005'
- An interim allocation of Rs 95,692 Cr has been released to States & UTs
- 26 States have already made budgetary provisions keeping in mind objective of 'VB-GRAMG'
- Jharkhand, Karnataka, Telangana & Mizoram – urged to complete process at earliest
- Among major allocations announced: UP – Rs 9,721.48 Cr | WB – Rs 8,508 Cr | Andhra Pradesh – Rs 7,707.21 Cr
  - Tamil Nadu – Rs 7,585.49 Cr | Rajasthan – Rs 7,581.87 Cr | Bihar – Rs 6,715.83 Cr | MP – Rs 6,252.03 Cr
- Centre allocated a total of Rs 92,550.17 Cr to States & Rs 1,291.52 Cr to UTs
- Rs 1,850.62 Cr – earmarked for central administration & social audit activities
  - Overall interim allocation to Rs 95,692.31 Cr

News - 35

- MoT selected 96 companies under 3rd round of "Production Linked Incentive (PLI)" scheme for textiles
  - Total investment commitment – Rs 12,822.67 Cr | Projected turnover – Rs 58,294.18 Cr
- Out of 96, Ministry cleared 22 new applicants in latest meeting under 3rd Round 3 of PLI scheme for textiles
  - 22 newly approved companies are expected to bring in a total investment of Rs 2,339.14 Cr

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- Approved companies under PLI scheme are from man-made fibre apparel, MMF fabrics & technical textile segments
- PLI scheme for textiles – notified on Sep 24, 2021 | Approved outlay – Rs 10,683 Cr
- Minister of Textiles: Giriraj Singh | Constituency – Begusarai, Bihar

  MoS in Ministry of Textiles: Pabitra Margherita

News - 36

- ICAR – launched India's first AI-based WhatsApp tool, "Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra"
  - To help oilseed farmers access timely, research-based advisory services in multiple languages
- It is developed by – ICAR-Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR) in Hyderabad
- They can save number +91 4024598180 as 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra' on WhatsApp & ask questions in any Indian language
- Knowledge base of chatbot has been developed in collaboration with:
  - ICAR-National Soybean Research Institute, Indore
  - ICAR-Indian Institute of Groundnut Research, Junagadh
  - ICAR-Indian Institute of Rapeseed and Mustard Research, Bharatpur
  - PC Unit (Sesame & Niger)
- India's imports of edible oil – approximately 55-60% of total consumption
- India produces about 12.2 million tonnes of edible oils but imports around 16 million tonnes at ~Rs 1.32 lakh Cr
- HQs of ICAR – New Delhi | DG – Mangi Lal Jat | Established in – 1929

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News - 37

- India's rank in 'Doing Business Report' (released by World Bank) – 63rd in 2019 (from 142nd in 2014)
- India's rank in 'World Competitiveness Ranking' (released by IMD) – 41st in 2025 (from 43rd in 2021)
- India also consistently remained in highest category of World Bank's 'GovTech Maturity Index'
  - It assesses public sector digital transformation, placing India in Group A in 2020, 2022 & 2025
- One of most notable outcomes of reform agenda has been expansion of startup ecosystem
  - Recognised startups – increasing to more than 2.23 lakh by Mar 2026 (from 502 in 2016)
- Reforms simplifying business incorporation, compliance & formalisation for entrepreneurs and MSMEs:
  - Startup India, SPICe+, MCA21 Version 3 & 'Udyam Registration Portal'
- National Single Window System – facilitated more than 8.29 lakh approvals since 2021
- 'PM GatiShakti National Master Plan' – evaluated projects worth over Rs. 16 lakh Cr
- PARIVESH portal – reduced average environmental clearance approval time to 64 days (prescribed timeline - 105 days)
  - PARIVESH – Pro-Active and Responsive facilitation by Interactive, Virtuous, and Environmental Single Window Hub
- Government e-Marketplace (GeM) – recorded cumulative transactions exceeding Rs. 18.4 lakh Cr
- UPI processed transactions worth approximately Rs. 314 lakh Cr in 2025-26

Join us

News - 38

- India proposes to build 74 additional land ports along international border in coming years
  - It includes 3 land ports along China border & 6 ports along Pakistan border, as per Jayant Singh (LPAI chairperson)
- Land ports along China border are proposed at – Namgia (HP), Gunji (Uttarakhand) & Nathu La (Sikkim)
  - India does not have any other land port operational along 3,488-km China border
- As per MEA, 3 points are designated for conducting border trade between India & China – Lipulekh Pass (Uttarakhand - since 1992), Shipki La Pass (HP - since 1995) & Nathu La Pass (Sikkim - since 2006)
- Land ports planned along Pakistan border – Teetwal, Adusa & Chakan Da Bagh (J&K), Attari railway station & Hussainiwala (Punjab) and Munabao railway station (Rajasthan)
- At present, there is just one operational land port at Attari in Punjab & trade from 2 facilitation centres located at Salamabad, Uri, Baramulla district & Chakkan-da-Bagh, Poonch district along LoC (J&K)
- As per MHA, at present, 15 land ports are operational, 11 are under construction & 23 ports are proposed in Phase I
  - 40 others are proposed in Phase II
- Under Phase II, 13 land ports are proposed along Nepal border, 12 along Bangladesh, 4 along Bhutan & 2 along Myanmar
- As per Ministry, total trade with neighbouring countries – Rs 2,27,522 Cr
  - Out of which trade worth Rs 82,844 Cr was conducted through land ports
- Land borders have a potential for another Rs 4,44,167 Cr worth of untapped trade
- India shares 15,106.7 km of land border with Afghanistan, Pakistan, Bangladesh, China, Nepal, Bhutan & Myanmar

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News - 39

- MoCA proposed capping number of airport bundles that can be awarded to a single bidder at 2 to 3 bundles, or roughly 5 to 6 airports, for 3rd round of airport privatization
  - It involves 11 airports to prevent an 'oligopoly' as airport sector
- Adani Group – handle around 78 million passengers annually (accounting for nearly 25% of India's air traffic)
- Oligopoly market – a market form that is dominated by a small group of large sellers
- Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) – reviewing MoCA's proposal to privatise 11 airports
- 11 airports proposed for privatisation have been grouped into 5 bundles:
  - Amritsar & Kangra; Varanasi, Kushinagar & Gaya; Bhubaneswar & Hubli; Raipur & Aurangabad; and Trichy & Tirupati
- Minister of Civil Aviation: Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu | Constituency – Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Civil Aviation: Murlidhar Mohol

News - 40

- Nitin Gadkari (Min. for RT&H) – witnessed excavation breakthrough of main tunnel at eastern portal of Zojila Tunnel Project at Minamarg, Kargil
- Being constructed between Baltal & Minamarg on NH-1 at altitudes ranging from 2,900m to 3,310m
  - By – National Highways & Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (NHIDCL) | Cost – ₹6,800 Cr
  - Using 'New Austrian Tunnelling Method (NATM)' with a Smart Tunnel (SCADA) system

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- It is India's longest road tunnel & world's longest single-tube bi-directional road tunnel at highest altitude
- Road & tunnel projects worth ~₹18,000 Cr are currently under implementation between Kargil & Leh-Ladakh

News - 41

- 11 traditional products from Jharkhand – granted GI tags by Geographical Indications Registry (GIR) in Chennai
  - Bhoya Saree and Fabric, Kuchai Silk Saree, Kesaria Kalakand, Dokra Craft, Tumka Chadar, Baroni Paintings, Munda Jewellery, Jharkhand Bamboo Craft, Tussar Silk and Sarees, Jadopatia Painting, and Pancho Saree and Fabric
- Sohrai Painting (Jharkhand) – also received a GI tag earlier
- 4 artisan products from Assam – also granted GI tags
  - Karbi Anglong Handloom Products, Assam Bihu Pepa, Assam Bamboo Crafts & Deuri Handloom Products
- Certification process was supported & facilitated by – National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
- Geographical Indication Registry in Chennai, under DPIIT – issues GI tags in India | Validity of a registered GI – 10 yrs
- Jharkhand: Capital – Ranchi | CM – Hemant Soren | Governor – Santosh Kumar Gangwar
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

News - 42

- "IS 20201:2026 Community Seed Bank Management - Requirements" (a new Indian Standard) – published by BIS
  - Formulated by – Biodiversity Sectional Committee (EED 06) under Environment & Ecology Department (EED) of BIS
- 'National Food Security & Nutrition Mission (NFSNM)' – provides one-time assistance of Rs 50 lakh
  - For establishing community seed banks & statutory protections under 'Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act, 2001' & 'Biological Diversity Act, 2002'
- Draft for this management system standard was developed under convenorship of ICAR-NBPGR
  - With critical inputs from National Biodiversity Authority, Protection of Plant Varieties & Farmers' Rights Authority, Rythu Sadhikara Samstha & BAIF Development Research Foundation
- IS 20201:2026 – downloaded free of cost from official BIS portal
- BIS – established under BIS Act, 2016
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

News - 43

- PM Modi – to lead 12th International Day of Yoga main national celebrations from Kolkata's Red Road on Jun 21, 2026
  - Theme – "Yoga for Healthy Ageing" (Swasth Aayu Ke Liye Yog)
  - Nodal agency – Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga (MDNIY) under Ministry of Ayush
- Ministry of Ayush + Habuild Healthtech Pvt Ltd = organised a free 14-day online yoga course
  - They also made a Guinness World Record on Jun 14, 2026 for 'Most Viewers for a YouTube Live Yoga Stream'
  - With 4,35,831 verified viewers (Previous record - 2,46,252 verified viewers, set in 2024)
- Yoga Sangam 2026 initiative – accessible via Yoga Sangam Portal
- Yoga Park Portal – also launched by Prataprao Jadhav (Ayush Minister) during IDY 2026 pre-event activities

Join us

News - 44

- Ashwini Vaishnaw – virtually inaugurated a 20 kW Akashvani FM Transmitter at Ramgarh in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan
  - Total number of FM transmitters in Rajasthan – 39
- It will provide radio coverage within an 80-km radius in western border region
- Minister of Railways and Information & Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Railways: V. Somanna & Ravneet Singh
  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

News - 45

- Department of Posts – launched drone-based transmission of mail & parcels between Mandi Head Post Office & Rehardhar Branch Post Office (Himachal Pradesh), w.e.f. Jun 12, 2026
- Mandi-Rehardhar route – 1st to operationalise under a broader plan to deploy drone-based mail transmission

News - 46

- BIS – released IS 20201:2026 "Community Seed Bank Management: Requirements"
- Standard was developed by – Biodiversity Sectional Committee (EED 06) under Environment & Ecology Dept of BIS
- Community Seed Banks – decentralised, community-managed institutions that collect, conserve, multiply & distribute traditional & indigenous seeds
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

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News - 47

- Pralhad Joshi – launched 'WT-MARUT', India's 1st dedicated Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management Portal
  - WT-MARUT – Wind Turbine Materials and Resources Utility Tracker
  - Developed under aegis of MNRE with support from Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers Association (IWTMA)
- At – Global Wind Day Conference 2026 held in Goa on Jun 15, 2026
  - Theme – "Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration"
  - Organised by – MNRE in association with IWTMA, WIPPA & IWPA
- "Wind DCR (Domestic Content Requirement) Portal", a Coffee Table Book on 'Pawan Urja' – also launched
- India added 6.1 GW of new wind capacity in FY26, highest annual installation achieved so far (growth of 46% over FY25)
- India's cumulative installed wind capacity now exceeds 56 GW (among world's leading wind energy markets)
- Global Wind Day – observed annually on June 15
- Minister of New & Renewable Energy: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad-Hubballi, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of New & Renewable Energy: Shripad Yesso Naik

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News - 48

- 'Tripura Sarinda (Musical Instrument)' – granted GI tag, under 'Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999'
- Tripura now has 4 GI-tagged products | Previous 3 – Tripura Queen Pineapple, Risha & Pachra, and Matabari Peda
- Tripura Sarinda – a traditional bowed string instrument crafted from a single piece of wood with hollow resonator body
- Tripura: Capital – Agartala | CM – Manik Saha | Governor – Indra Sena Reddy Nallu

News - 49

- 42nd meeting of NCR Planning Board – chaired by Manohar Lal, reviewing draft Regional Plan 2041 for NCR
- It proposes 3 primary spatial development zones:
  - A focused urban development zone within a 100-km radius from Rajghat, Delhi
  - A linear Highway Corridor Zone beyond 100 km
  - A Natural Conservation Zone protecting ecologically sensitive areas
- Among the most significant proposals are: 4 greenfield 'Namo Cities'
  - ₹5,000 Cr in Central assistance – proposed over next 5 years
- A '30-Minute NCR' integrated transit network – proposed to reduce inter-city travel times to 30 minutes across region
- It projects NCR's population – to grow to 147.3 million by 2041 (from 78.6 million currently)
  - 9 Counter Magnet Areas (CMAs) – identified to divert population pressure from NCR core
- Manohar Lal confirmed Natural Conservation Zone in Aravalli hills will remain untouched & NCRPB will increase regional green cover
- NCR's vehicle replacement scheme – also confirmed at meeting
  - Cabinet-approved ₹9,585 Cr programme as 'PARIVARTAN' (Program for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivization of Vehicle Assets for Reducing Transport Air-Pollution and Network Emission)
- NCRPB – established under NCRPB Act, 1985
- NCR currently spans ~55,083 sq km across NCT Delhi & 27 districts from Haryana, UP & Rajasthan

News - 50

- Pralhad Joshi – launched "Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)", developed by MNRE
  - At National Workshop on 'Strengthening the National Green Hydrogen Mission: Through State Policies, Hubs and Infrastructure' – organised by MNRE
- On state-level progress: 6 states – notified dedicated Green Hydrogen Policies
  - 7 states – integrated hydrogen into their existing industrial & renewable energy policy frameworks
  - 4 states – in process of finalising their dedicated policies
- Financial incentives – awarded to 15 companies to establish 3,000 MW per annum of indigenous electrolyser manufacturing capacity
  - Under 'SIGHT (Strategic Interventions for Green Hydrogen Transition)' programme

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- Incentives have been awarded for 8,62,000 MTPA of green hydrogen production capacity

- In refinery sector, contracts were awarded for supply of 30,000 MTPA of green hydrogen to IOCL, BPCL, HPCL & NRL
- ₹84 Cr – sanctioned for pilot projects testing 100% hydrogen injection in steel sector
- Agreements have been signed for supply of 6.7 lakh MTPA of Green Ammonia to 11 fertiliser plants
- It also allocated ₹100 Cr to support startups on green hydrogen technologies
  - With 1st list of 9 startups approved with total funding of ₹22 Cr
- National Green Hydrogen Mission – launched in Jan 2023 with an outlay of ₹19,744 Cr
  - It targets 5 Million Metric Tonnes (MMT) annual green hydrogen production capacity by 2030
- Minister of New & Renewable Energy: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad-Hubballi, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of New & Renewable Energy: Shripad Yesso Naik

News - 51

- Pralhad Joshi approved 1st batch of Rs 22 Cr support to 9 startups under NGHM's Rs 100 Cr 'Startup Support Programme'
- Joshi also launched 'Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)'
  - To facilitate certification & regulatory compliance under Green Hydrogen Certification Scheme of India
  - Launched at a workshop on NGHM – organised by MNRE
- As per Pralhad Joshi: 6 states – notified dedicated green hydrogen policies
  - 7 states – integrated hydrogen into their existing industrial & renewable energy policy frameworks
  - 4 states – in process of finalising their policies
- NGHM – launched in 2023 & has an outlay of Rs 19,744 Cr
- Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad
  MoS in Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: B. L. Verma & Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya

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News - 52

- Vinai Kumar Saxena – approved constitution of 1st-of-its-kind "Snow Leopard and High-Altitude Nature (SHAN) Conservation Society" in Ladakh
- It is constituted under Department of Forest, Ecology & Environment, Ladakh | Chairman – LG of Ladakh
- Snow leopard (Panthera uncia) (State Animal of Ladakh) – classified as 'Vulnerable' on IUCN Red List
  - It is revered as – 'Ghost of the Mountains'
- India's snow leopard population – 718 (as per '2024 Snow Leopard Population Assessment in India')
  - It ranges across – Ladakh, J&K, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim & Arunachal Pradesh
- Snow leopard is protected under Schedule I of 'Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972'
  - It is covered under – 'Project Snow Leopard', India's programme for in-situ conservation of species
- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena

Join us

News - 53

- I4C launched two new portals – "Grievance Redressal Module (GRM)" & "Money Restoration Module (MRM)"
- Under Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System (CFCFRMS)
- India recorded 28.15 lakh cybercrime cases in 2025 involving financial losses of ₹22,495 Cr
- HQs of I4C – New Delhi | CEO – Rajesh Kumar | Founded in – 2018

News - 54

- Pralhad Joshi inaugurated 'Smart Warehousing System' for foodgrain storage at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- It will initially cover 216 bag-based foodgrain warehouses of Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) & FCI
- Developed by – Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD)
- Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad
  MoS in Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: B. L. Verma & Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya

News - 55

- MoF approved upgradation of Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd (CPCL) to a central public sector enterprise (CPSE)
- CPCL – became 28th Navratna amongst CPSEs | CPCL – a CPSE under MoPNG
- With status of a Navratna company, CPCL will have financial independence to invest up to Rs 1,000 Cr without seeking approval from central government
  - It will also be allowed to invest up to 15% of their net worth on a single project, or 30% of their net worth in a year
- To qualify as a Navratna, a CPSE having a Miniratna-I status must obtain an 'Excellent' or 'Very Good' MoU rating in 3 out of last 5 years & have a composite score of 60 or more in 6 selected performance indicators
  (i) net profit to net worth | (ii) manpower cost to total cost of production | (iii) profit before depreciation,
  (iv) interest & taxes (PBDIT) to capital employed | (v) profit before Interest & taxes to turnover, earnings per share
  (vi) inter-sectoral performance
- CPCL – formed as a JV in 1965 between GoI, AMOCO & National Iranian Oil Company (NIOC)
  - Present shareholders (with shares): IOCL – 51.89% | NICO – 15.40% | Others – 32.71%
- HQs of CPCL – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Chairman – Shri A. S. Sahney | MD – H. Shankar | Established in – 1965

News - 56

- As per an UNCTAD report, cited by Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways:
- India – became world's leading ship recycling nation in 2025, achieving a key target under 'Maritime India Vision 2030'
- India increased its share of global ship recycling activity to 35.4% in 2025 (from 30.1% in 2024)
- India recycled 2.99 million gross tonnes (GT) of ships in 2025 (~60% increase from 1.86 million GT in 2024)
- 'Hong Kong International Convention for Safe and Environmentally Sound Recycling of Ships' – ratified by India in 2019
- Govt also provided Rs 53.5 Cr in financial assistance to modernise ship recycling yards

Join us

News - 57

- NIXI – celebrated its 23rd Foundation Day on Jun 19, 2026, launching 4 new digital platforms
  - "IX Portal", "myIRINN Portal", ".IN Auction Portal" & an AI-Powered "WHOIS Screening Platform"
- Platforms were launched by – S. Krishnan (Secretary, MeitY) & Chairman (NIXI)
- WHOIS Screening Platform uses AI to detect suspicious websites & strengthen integrity of India's '.in' domain space
- NIXI currently manages over 39 lakh '.IN' domain names, operates 79 Internet Exchange Points (IXPs) across India
  - It supports domain registrations in 22 Indian languages
- NIXI – a not-for-profit organisation established in 2003 under MeitY
- HQs of NIXI – New Delhi | Chairman – S Krishnan | CEO – Devesh Tyagi | Established in – 2003

News - 58

- Nirmala Sitharaman inaugurated "Organic Spice Industrial Unit (PRIME-HUB)" at Bhoirymbong in Ri-Bhoi district
  - It is Northeast's largest & 1st organically certified spice processing facility
- Established by – Eastern Ri-Bhoi Organic Farmer Producer Company Limited (FPC)
- It is a farmer-owned enterprise promoted under GoI's 'Mission Organic Value Chain Development for North Eastern Region (MOVCD-NER)', with an investment of approximately ₹32 Cr
- Annual processing capacity – 10,346 metric tonnes of premium organic spices
  - Certified under both National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) & European Union (EU) Organic Standards
  - 1st spice processing unit in Northeast India to hold dual certification
- Minister of Finance & Corporate Affairs: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary
  MoS in Ministry of Corporate Affairs: Harsh Malhotra

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News - 59

- MoD – granted working permission to Musi Riverfront Development Corporation Ltd, Hyderabad
  - For use of 83.814 acres of defence land under jurisdiction of Artillery Centre, Golconda, Hyderabad
  - Valued at – ₹533.42 Cr | For proposed 'Gandhi Sarovar Project' at Bapu Ghat
- Permission has been granted under – MoD's Equal Value Infrastructure (EVI) Policy
  - It requires MRDCL to create infrastructure assets of equivalent value for Indian Army's Local Military Authority (LMA) in lieu of defence land
- Bapu Ghat – a memorial located at confluence of Esa & Musi rivers in Hyderabad, where ashes of Mahatma Gandhi were immersed in Feb 1948
- Musi Riverfront Development Programme – flagship project of Telangana government
  - For comprehensive rejuvenation & redevelopment of Musi River corridor in Hyderabad

Join us

News - 60

- Amit Shah launched 4 applications to integrate policing, criminal identification, forensic probe & prosecution management into a seamless digital chain of Integrated Criminal Justice System
  - 'National Crime Records Bureau's (NCRB) Abhigyan' | 'Criminal Procedure Identification (CrPI)'
  - 'e-prosecution 2.0' | 'e-forensics 2.0'
- National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS) & CrPI will identify offender
- Crime & Criminal Tracking & Network System (CCTNS) and Crime Multi Agency Centre (Cri-MAC) will connect & support investigations
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

News - 61

- 3 agricultural products from MP – awarded GI tags under Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999
  - 'Khurasani Imli' (Baobab fruit, Adansonia digitata) – originates from Mandu (Mandav) in Dhar district
  - 'Ratlami Garadu' (purple yam tuber) – a winter delicacy grown in Bangrod, Bandgarod, Khetalpur, Sejawata & Dhamotar areas of Ratlam
  - 'Balam Kakdi' (Sailana Balam Cucumber) – a special cucumber variety cultivated in tribal region of Sailana, Ratlam
- Ratlam now holds GI tags for 4 unique products (1st district in MP)
  - Previous 2 – Ratlam Sev & Riyawan Silver Garlic
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

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News - 62

- V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority (VOCPA) – emerged as a model for sustainable maritime development in India
  - Citing a 45% reduction in net carbon emissions
- Academic activities were commenced for 2026-27 session at Kendriya Vidyalaya, VOC Port
  - Established with approval of Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan
  - It will initially operate from Port School campus & provide CBSE education to children of port employees, central government staff & local residents
- Sarbananda Sonowal – released an IIM Calcutta case study titled 'The Hydrogen Pivot: Orchestrating the Green Transition at V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority'
- VOC Port – also recognised as a 'Scope-2 Emission Free Port'
- VOCPA + Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya (Vadodara) = an MoU to facilitate establishment of a Centre of Excellence in Maritime Logistics & Port Management
- He also launched 'PortGPT' mobile application, making VOC Port 1st major port in India to extend an enterprise-grade generative AI platform through a dedicated mobile application

Join us

- Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Sarbananda Sonowal | Constituency – Dibrugarh, Assam

  MoS in Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Shantanu Thakur

News - 63

- APEDA – concluded 1st cohort of its flagship export acceleration programme "BHARATI"
  - BHARATI – Bharat's Hub for Agritech, Resilience, Advancement and Incubation for Export Innovation
- Aim: To empower 100 agri-food startups through innovation & incubation
- APEDA facilitated participation of top 8 BHARATI startups at 'Gulfood 2026' in Dubai
- HQs of APEDA – New Delhi | Chairman – Abhishek Dev | Established in – 1986 (functions under Ministry of C&I)

News - 64

- Odisha will provide free education from Kindergarten to Postgraduate level across all govt educational institutions
  - It makes Odisha potentially 1st state in India to implement such an extensive bottom-to-top free education policy
- It will cover general education across 3 major streams of Science, Arts & Commerce in all government & aided colleges
  - It will not cover technical, medical or other professional courses
- Odisha already provides free education up to Class 10 in government institutions
- Other states/acts in same field: Telangana – offers free KG-to-PG education only for economically weaker sections
  - Kerala – provides free undergraduate education in government Arts & Science colleges but not at PG level
  - Delhi – offers free schooling up to Class 12
  - India's Right to Education Act – guarantees free & compulsory education only for children aged 6-14 (up to Class 8)
- Odisha's education budget – grown to ₹42,565 Cr in 2026-27 (from ₹26,840 crore in 2022-23)
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

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News - 65

- India + China = discussing joint nomination for 'The Great Tang Records on the Western Regions' on UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage List
- Accounts of Xuanzang, aka Hiuen Tsang – remain a source for study of early medieval India
  - He authored 'Si-yu-ki'
- India also aims at securing a place for 'Panchtantra' on UNESCO list along with Iran
  - Also for 'philosophy of Satyagraha' along with South Africa under UNESCO's cultural heritage framework
- 2nd BRICS Culture Working Group Meeting – held in Varanasi under India's chairmanship
- India ratified UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) framework, under 2003 Convention, in 2005
  - It currently has 16 elements inscribed on UNESCO's Representative List
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

Join us

News - 66

- MoCA + DIAL = launched "AIR SUVIDHA 2.0", an upgraded contactless Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal
  - To strengthen public health surveillance at points of entry in response to ongoing Ebola disease outbreak
- WHO declared Ebola/Bundibugyo virus disease outbreak in Democratic Republic of the Congo & Uganda as a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC) on May 17, 2026, under International Health Regulations (IHR) 2005
- Developed in collaboration with – Directorate General of Health Services (MH&FW)
  - It enables international arriving passengers to submit a mandatory online Health Self-Declaration prior to immigration clearance
- Airsuvidha Self Declaration Form (SDF) – can be completed 24 hours in advance before arrival in India
- Minister of Civil Aviation: Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu | Constituency – Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Civil Aviation: Murlidhar Mohol

News - 67

- 8th edition of "Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026" – concluded with 6 youth-led startups selected as winners for developing scalable, high-impact solutions addressing sustainability challenges
  - Co-led by – UNDP India & Citi Foundation (in partnership with AIM & NITI Aayog)
  - Implemented by – T-Hub Foundation
- It received over 350 applications from youth-led startups across 28 states, themed around 3 areas:
  - Sustainable Textiles & Fashion | Circular Economy Innovations
  - Sustainable Food Systems & Water Conservation
- 50 high-potential startups were enrolled in 'National Springboard Programme'
- Top 20 startups advanced to a 5-day 'Regional Immersion Bootcamp' hosted at T-Hub, Hyderabad (Jun 15-19, 2026)
- 3 winning startups each received seed grant support of ₹3,50,000
- 'Youth Co:Lab' – co-created in 2017 by UNDP & Citi Foundation
  - Launched in India in 2019 in partnership with AIM, NITI Aayog

News - 68

- MHFW published 2 separate draft notifications proposing amendments to 'Drugs Rules, 1945' for stakeholder consultation
- Aim: To reduce pharmaceutical supply-chain wastage & simplify regulatory approvals for research imports
  - Both proposals are open for objections & suggestions for 30 days from date of gazette notification
- 1st amendment proposes replacing existing residual shelf-life requirement for imported drugs with a fixed minimum residual shelf life of 12 months at time of import
- 2nd amendment proposes replacing mandatory Form 11 test licence requirement for importing small quantities of drugs for analytical & non-clinical testing with an acknowledgement-based system
- Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation – national regulatory body for pharmaceuticals & medical devices in India

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- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 69

- Amit Shah inaugurated pilot project of "PM Family Care Tracker" in Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- PM Family Care Tracker – an integrated digital platform that monitors children's health, nutrition, education & welfare from prenatal stage until age of 16
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 70

- Amit Shah – launched cooperative-based taxi service "Bharat Taxi" in Gujarat
  - At Mahatma Mandir Convention and Exhibition Centre, Gandhinagar
- It expands service to 14 major Gujarat cities – Ahmedabad, Surat, Dwarka, Vadodara, Rajkot, Somnath, Valsad, Anand, Jamnagar, Bhavnagar, Nadiad, Junagadh, Mehsana & Amreli (target to cover all of Gujarat within 1 month)
- Bharat Taxi – established on Jun 6, 2025, by 8 founding national cooperative institutions
  - NCDC, Amul (GCMMF), NDDB, NAFED, IFFCO, KRIBHCO, NABARD & NCEL
  - Registered under 'Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002' & nationally launched on Feb 5, 2026
- It embodies concept of 'Saarthi Hi Maalik' under PM Modi's 'Sahkar se Samriddhi' vision
  - This business model operates on a zero-commission structure
  - Saarthis also receive: personal accident insurance of ₹5 lakh, family health insurance of ₹5 lakh, access to pension schemes & government gig-worker welfare schemes
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 71

- Cabinet is actively reviewing a Rs 20,000 Cr framework to scale "Carbon Capture, Utilisation, and Storage (CCUS)" technologies across India over next 5 years
- It will support CCUS initiatives to aid decarbonisation goals of 5 industrial sectors of economy, power, steel, cement, refineries & chemicals
- "R&D roadmap to enable India's Net Zero goals through CCUS" – outlines phased Research & Development pathways
  - It draws on 7 years of prior research & is aligned with broader national innovation schemes

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News - 72

- Mohan Yadav (MP CM) + Pralhad Joshi (Min. for NRE) + Rakesh Shukla (MoS in MNRE) = inaugurated 2 major solar power parks in MP
  - 500 MW Neemuch Solar Park – comprises 3 units with unit-wise tariffs of ₹2.15, ₹2.14 & ₹2.15 per unit
  - 450 MW Shajapur Solar Park – comprises 3 units with tariffs of ₹2.35, ₹2.33 & ₹2.339 per unit
- A Power Purchase Agreement (PPA) was also signed for 440 MW Morena Solar Plus Storage Project which secured a tariff of ₹2.70 per unit (lowest in India for solar energy integrated with storage)
  - 1st utility-scale solar-plus-storage project of its kind in MP
- Development projects worth ₹1,593.98 Cr were carried out at same programme
- India's total installed solar capacity – crossed 155 GW as of 2026 (world's 2nd largest solar energy growth market)
- Rewa Ultra Mega Solar Limited (RUMSL) – nodal state agency driving large-scale solar park development in MP
- 750 MW Rewa Ultra Mega Solar Project – 1st solar project in Asia to supply power to an open-access consumer (Delhi Metro) at competitive tariffs without any government viability gap funding
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel
- Minister of New & Renewable Energy: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad-Hubballi, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of New & Renewable Energy: Shripad Yesso Naik

News - 73

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan – launched 'Rural Internal Audit Portal' at 'Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan'
  - At Pusa Campus, New Delhi | It was piloted in Chandauli District, UP from Apr 1, 2025
  - Conceived by – Office of Chief Controller of Accounts (CCA), MoRD
  - Hosted by & developed in collaboration with – National Informatics Centre (NIC)
- Minister of Rural Development: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Rural Development: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani & Kamlesh Paswan

News - 74

- 16th Meeting of Central Council of Health and Family Welfare (CCHFW) – held at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
- JP Nadda released 'Anemia Mukt Bharat (AMB) Abhiyaan - Operational Guidelines'
- These guidelines expand existing 6×6×6 strategy into a 7×7×7 framework by introducing 3 new additions:
  - Low Birth Weight (LBW) babies (0-6 months) as 7th beneficiary group
  - 'Eating Right' approach as a daily habit as 7th intervention
  - A strengthened Monitoring & Evaluation framework as 7th institutional mechanism
- It also transitions from T3 approach (Test, Treat, Talk) to T4 approach (Test, Treat, Talk & Track)
- India carries one of world's highest anemia burdens – as per NFHS-5, 2019-21
  - 67.1% of children (6-59 months) & 57% of women (15-49 years) are anemic
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

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International Affairs

News - 75

- US + Britain (UK) + Australia = launched joint partnership under 'AUKUS Pillar Two' to develop & deploy advanced Uncrewed Undersea Vehicles (UUVs) at Shangri-La Dialogue, Singapore
- UUV tech. – 1st signature project under Pillar Two covering long-range hypersonic missiles, undersea robotics & AI
- AUKUS (started in 2021) – affirmed the 3 countries would develop nuclear submarines
- Under Pillar One, nuclear-powered attack submarines would be built in UK & Australia for use in their navies
  - AUKUS submarines are only scheduled to be ready in the 2040s
- Meanwhile, US & UK will rotate existing nuclear submarines through Australia
  - In the 2030s, Australia will acquire second-hand nuclear submarines from US
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance
- UK – London – Pound Sterling | PM – Keir Starmer | New King – King Charles lll
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

News - 76

- India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) – entered into force on Jun 1, 2026
  - Operationalised in – New Delhi | Signed on – Dec 18, 2025
  - 1st consignments of agriculture & gems & jewellery exports availing preferential tariff benefits flagged off from Mumbai, Kolkata & Chennai
- India-Oman CEPA – India's 2nd FTA signed within 6 months (after India-UK FTA)
- Oman offered zero-duty access on 98.08% of its tariff lines covering 99.38% of India's exports to Oman
- For services, CEPA facilitates 100% FDI by Indian companies in major services sectors
  - It also introduces 1st-ever comprehensive commitment on Traditional Medicine
  - It also provides for mutual recognition of Halal certification
  - It accepts India's 'National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP)' certification for organic products
- Bilateral trade between India & Oman – $11.18 billion in FY26 (from $10.61 billion in FY25)
- Oman – India's 2nd-largest trading partner in Gulf region
- Oman – Muscat – Rial | Sultan – Haitham bin Tariq Al Said

News - 77

- Austria, Kyrgyzstan, Portugal, Trinidad & Tobago, and Zimbabwe – elected as non-permanent members of UNSC
- Kyrgyzstan – elected for 1st time as a non-permanent member of UNSC since becoming a member of UN in 1992
- They will serve two-year terms starting on Jan 1, 2027, & ending on Dec 31, 2028
- They will replace – Greece, Pakistan, Denmark, Panama & Somalia

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- UNSC comprises 15 members, including 5 permanent members (P5) with veto power & 10 non-permanent members elected for 2-year terms
- In 2027, they will join P5 nations and Bahrain, Colombia, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Latvia & Liberia
- HQs of UNSC – New York, US | Presidency in June 2026 – Colombia (May'26 - China | July'26 - DR Congo)

  The UNSC has 10 non-permanent members & 5 permanent members (China, France, Russia, UK, US)

News - 78

- India + MERCOSUR bloc = targeting conclusion of a significantly expanded Preferential Trade Agreement by mid-2027
  - MERCOSUR bloc comprises – Brazil, Argentina, Paraguay & Uruguay
- Existing India-MERCOSUR PTA came into effect on Jun 1, 2009, after a Framework Agreement was signed on Jun 17, 2003, in Asunción
- HQs of MERCOSUR Secretariat – Montevideo, Uruguay | Director – Jimmy Alberto Voss Donamarí | Founded in – 1991

  Member Countries – Brazil, Argentina, Paraguay & Uruguay

News - 79

- PM Modi + Emmanuel Macron = unveiled 13 major outcomes & inaugurated 'India-France Year of Innovation 2026'
  - During 1st leg of PM Modi's France visit in Nice on Jun 13-14, 2026
- 'India-France Innovation Roadmap 2030' – formally adopted as a strategic framework
- 'Joint India-France AI Working Group' – established to advance cooperation on AI & its global governance
- 'Dialogue on Economic Security' – instituted to strengthen supply chain resilience
- A high-level mechanism was set up to double bilateral trade within 5 years
- They jointly inaugurated 'Bharat Innovates 2026' at Palais des Expositions in Nice
  - A total of 19 institutional agreements in innovation ecosystem of both countries were signed
- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu

News - 80

- India + Japan = adopted 'Rule of Implementation' of Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM) under Article 6.2 of Paris Agreement of UNFCCC
- It follows Memorandum of Cooperation (MoC) for JCM signed by India & Japan in Aug, 2025
- Japan – Tokyo – Yen | PM – Sanae Takaichi

News - 81

- Uzbekistan – officially became a shareholder of NDB after ratifying NDB Articles of Agreement on Jun 5, 2026
  - Uzbekistan now became 10th member of NDB & 1st country from Central Asia to join NDB
- NDB – established in 2015 by BRICS nations | It has approved 139 projects worth nearly US $43 billion
- HQs of NDB – Shanghai, China | President – Dilma Vana Rousseff | Established in – July 2014 (by BRICS countries)

  Members (11) – Algeria, Bangladesh, Brazil, China, Colombia, Egypt, India, Russia, South Africa, UAE & Uzbekistan

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News - 82

- India – to assume Vice-Presidency of Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for 1st time
- Vivek Aggarwal – elected & appointed as Vice-President of FATF by FATF Plenary for term of Jul 2026 to Jun 2027
- FATF Presidency operates on a 2-year term
- India became a full member of FATF in 2010 & was placed in 'regular follow-up' category, following its Mutual Evaluation at FATF Plenary in Jun 2024
- HQs of FATF – Paris, France | President – Elisa de Anda Madrazo | Established – July 1989

News - 83

- UK – will ban social media access for all children under 16, w.e.f. early 2027
  - It covers platforms including TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, X & YouTube
  - It excludes messaging services such as WhatsApp
- Australia – 1st country to implement such a ban
- Indonesia – banned children under 16 from 'high-risk platforms' including TikTok & YouTube
- Canada – introduced Digital Safety Legislation in June 2026, barring under-16s from social media
- In India: Andhra Pradesh – committed to barring children below 13 from social media within 90 days
  - Karnataka – announced a ban for under-16s in its 2026-27 budget speech
- UK – London – Pound Sterling | PM – (vacant) | New King – King Charles lll

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News - 84

- Bangladesh – formally joined International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) as its 27th member nation
  - Saudi Arabia – 26th member
- India invited Bangladesh to become a full member in Apr 2026
- IBCA – launched by PM Modi on Apr 9, 2023, during commemoration of 50th anniversary of 'Project Tiger'
  - For conservation & protection of 7 big cat species: Tiger, Lion, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar & Puma
- IBCA – became a full-fledged treaty-based inter-governmental international organisation & legal entity on Jan 23, 2025
- Countries with observer status (5) – Kazakhstan, Namibia, Thailand, Ecuador & Vietnam
- 1st IBCA Summit – postponed (originally scheduled for Jun 1-2, 2026, in New Delhi)
  - Theme – "Save Big Cats, Save Humanity, Save Ecosystem"
- India is home to approximately 3,682 wild tigers (75% of world's wild tiger population)
  - India also hosts world's only Asiatic lion population in Gir National Park, Gujarat
- HQs of IBCA – New Delhi | President – Bhupender Yadav | DG – SP Yadav | Founded in – April 2023
- Bangladesh – Dhaka – Taka | President – Mohammed Shahabuddin | PM – Tarique Rahman

Join us

News - 85

- 2nd 'Pax Silica Summit' – held in Washington, D.C.
- 35 nations (including India) – signed on to US initiative to build trusted & resilient supply chains to power AI technologies
- Argentina, Germany, Netherlands, Chile, Costa Rica, Greece, Kazakhstan, Panama & EU – joined 'Pax Silica' initiative on sidelines of Summit
- India is represented by – S Krishnan (Secretary of MeitY), Nagraj Naidu (Additional Secretary (Americas) in MEA) & representatives of Indian industry
- 1st 'Pax Silica Summit' – held in Washington, D.C. in Dec 2025
- India joined this initiative in Feb 2026 on sidelines of AI Impact Summit in New Delhi

Banking, Digital/Finance, Economic & Insurance Affairs

(Note: This chapter includes Digital/Financial Awareness and RBI Circulars & Notifications too.)

News - 86

- BoB – launched 3 new features on its UPI payments application "bob ₹ Pay"
  - Mobile OS-Native Biometric Authentication for payments
  - UIDAI-based Face Authentication for setting & resetting UPI PIN
  - Internet of Things (IoT)-based payments
- 'bob ₹ Pay' – a universal UPI application open to customers of any bank
- Mobile OS-Native Biometric Authentication – enables customers to authorise UPI transactions up to ₹5,000 using fingerprint or face ID registered on their mobile device
- UIDAI-based Face Authentication feature – allows customers to set or reset their UPI PIN using UIDAI facial recognition
- IoT-based payments – enables UPI transactions through supported connected devices linked to bob ₹ Pay app
- HQs of BoB – Vadodara, Gujarat | MD & CEO – Debadatta Chand | Tagline – "India's International Bank"

News - 87

- Bajaj Finserv Ltd – launched "Finserv Intelligence", a group-wide strategic initiative in applied research & innovation
- Bajaj Finserv Ltd + IIT Bombay = an MoU & Master Collaboration Agreement to establish a joint research centre
  - It also defines a joint Statement of Work across 4 initial focus areas: AI, cybersecurity, quantum technologies & reimagining of physical retail experience
- Bajaj Finserv companies – to invest ₹1,500-₹2,000 Cr over 5 years in startups & early-stage companies
- HQs of Bajaj Finserv – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman & MD – Sanjiv Bajaj | Established in – 2007
- Director of IIT Bombay – Prof. Shireesh Kedare

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News - 88

- DFS – launched the "Common Landing Portal for Unclaimed Financial Assets" to facilitate easier access to information on unclaimed financial assets
- Developed in collabo with – Public Sector Bank Alliance (PSBA), a centralised umbrella Org. promoted by 12 Indian PSBs
- The initiative builds upon the nationwide campaign "आपकी पूँजी, आपका अधिकार (Your Money, Your Right)"

News - 89

- MCA – amended Schedule VII of 'Companies Act, 2013' to include subscription to Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments on Social Stock Exchanges as eligible CSR activity
- Companies may allocate up to 10% of annual CSR expenditure towards ZCZP instruments
- ZCZP instruments offer no financial returns or principal repayment; raise funds for social impact projects with disclosure & oversight through SSE platform
- SSE framework – proposed in Union Budget 2019-20 | SEBI regulates issuance of ZCZP instruments by eligible NPOs
- Minister of Corporate Affairs: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Corporate Affairs: Harsh Malhotra

News - 90

- Karur Vysya Bank – launched premium credit card portfolio on Visa platform with 4 variants:
  - Aura (Visa Platinum): for everyday online shopping
  - Samara (Visa Signature): for dining & premium lifestyle experience
  - Altura (Visa Infinite): for frequent travellers
  - Eternis (Visa Infinite): for top-tier variant
- HQs of Karur Vysya Bank – Karur, Tamil Nadu | MD & CEO – B. Ramesh Babu | Founded in – 1916

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News - 91

- As per data released by NPCI, India's UPI recorded an all-time high in both transaction volume & value in May 2026
  - Transactions – 23,201.93 million | Value – ₹29.90 trillion | Previous volume record – 22.64 billion (March 2026)
- Y-o-y growth stood at 24% in volume & 19% in value
- Daily average for May 2026 – 748 million transactions, with value ₹96,452 Cr
- UPI's average ticket size – declined to ₹1,313 in 2025 (from ₹1,848 in 2021)
- Total UPI figures published exclude 'Credit Card on UPI' & 'Credit Line on UPI' accounts
- IMPS recorded 358.10 million transactions worth ₹6.96 trillion in May 2026
- UPI – launched in April 2016
  - It is currently live in 8 countries – UAE, Singapore, Bhutan, Nepal, Mauritius, Sri Lanka, France & Qatar
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

Join us

News - 92

- Mahindra + Manulife Insurance JV – received certificate of incorporation from MCA, forming "Mahindra Manulife Insurance Ltd (MMIL)"
- JV – 50:50 partnership announced Nov 2025 | Each partner committed up to Rs 3,600 Cr
  - with initial Rs 1,250 Cr investment over first 5 years (~Rs 250 Cr annually)
- HQs of Mahindra Group – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Anand Mahindra | MD & CEO – Dr. Anish Shah

News - 93

- NIPL + ACLEDA Bank Plc. (Cambodia) = launched UPI acceptance in Cambodia on Jun 2, 2026, through "KHQR"
  - Powered by – Bakong mobile payment platform of National Bank of Cambodia
- In 1st phase, Indian travellers can make real-time QR-based payments using UPI-enabled applications
- In 2nd phase, Cambodian visitors to India will be enabled to make payments at UPI QR merchant locations in India
- India' UPI is now live in 9 countries – Cambodia, UAE, Singapore, Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka, France, Mauritius & Qatar
- HQs of NPCI Int. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Ritesh Shukla

News - 94

- BharatPe – launched "BharatPe Flex", a Credit-on-UPI solution powered by YES BANK
- It offers option to repay in full within billing cycle or convert spends into flexible EMIs, depending on preference
- Users can pay on UPI & settle dues within a 45-day interest-free period
- HQs of BharatPe – New Delhi | CEO – Nalin Negi | Chairperson – Rajnish Kumar

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News - 95

- S. Janakiraman – re-appointed as DG of RBI for 2-year term (w.e.f. June 26, 2026)
- First appointed – June 26, 2023 for 3-year term (succeeding - Mahesh Kumar Jain)
- His Category – represents 'commercial banker' DG under RBI Act, 1934
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 96

- As per RBI's Monetary Policy Report (June 2026): Repo rate – unchanged at 5.25% & continues with a 'neutral' stance
  - Other rates: SDF – 5% | MSF & Bank rate – 5.50% | Reverse repo rate – 3.35% | CRR – 3% | SLR – 18%
- Factors cited – prolonged West Asia conflict & crude oil price volatility increasing inflation & growth risks
- CPI inflation forecast FY27 – 5.1% (previous 4.6%) | Quarterly projections – Q1: 4.2%, Q2: 5.1%, Q3: 5.9%, Q4: 5.4%
- Headline CPI (April 2026) – 3.5% | Core inflation (Jan-Apr 2026) – 3.7%
- Real GDP growth FY27 – projected at 6.6%
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 97

- Jammu & Kashmir Bank – won Gold Award at "Finacle Innovation Awards 2026" during Finacle India Connect 2026
  - in 'Modern Technologies-led Innovation - Data Insights & Analytics Platform' category
- Award-winning platform is a cloud-based enterprise data lake & analytics ecosystem serving as unified source for reporting, business intelligence, advanced analytics & AI applications
- HQs of J&K Bank – Srinagar | MD & CEO – Amitava Chatterjee | Founded in – 1938 | Tagline – "Serving to Empower"

News - 98

- IFSCA granted Indian Overseas Bank (IOB) a licence to establish an IBU, functioning as a branch at GIFT City, Gujarat
- Licence was preceded by Reserve Bank of India's permission to set up an IBU, granted in Dec 2025
- GIFT City – India's 1st operational International Financial Services Centre located between Ahmedabad & Gandhinagar
  - It is governed by IFSCA, established under IFSC Authority Act, 2019 & operational since April 2020
  - GIFT City – Gujarat International Finance Tec-City
- HQs of IFSCA – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Chairman – K. Rajaraman | Ex. Director – Dipesh Shah | Established – 2020
- HQs of IOB – Chennai, TN | MD & CEO – Ajay Kumar Srivastava | Tagline – "Good people to grow with"

News - 99

- "Provisional Estimates (PE) of Annual Gross Domestic Product (GDP) for Financial Year 2025-26 (FY26)" and "Quarterly Estimates of GDP for 4th Quarter of FY26" – released by NSO (MoSPI)
- Indian economy – grew 7.7% in FY26, 60 basis points (bps) higher than 7.1% in FY25
- Latest estimates use 2022-23 as base year, a revised GDP series, introduced by MoSPI in Feb 2026
- Real GDP or GDP at Constant Prices – Rs 323.12 lakh Cr in FY26, against FRE of GDP for FY25 of Rs 299.89 lakh Cr
- Nominal GDP or GDP at Current Prices – Rs 346.36 lakh Cr in FY26, against Rs 318.07 lakh Cr in FY25
- Real gross value added – Rs 294.91 lakh Cr in FY26, against Rs 273.36 lakh Cr in FY25
- Nominal GVA – Rs 314.87 lakh Cr during FY26, against Rs 288.54 lakh Cr in FY25
- Real GDP at Constant Prices in Q4 of FY26 – Rs 87.77 lakh Cr (from Rs 81.40 lakh Cr in Q4 of FY25)
- Nominal GDP or GDP at Current Prices in Q4 of FY26 – Rs 94.65 lakh Cr (from Rs 86.75 lakh Cr in Q4 of FY25)
- Real GVA in Q4 of FY26 – Rs 80.18 lakh Cr (from Rs 74.32 lakh Cr in Q4 of FY25)
- Nominal GVA in Q4 of FY26 – Rs 86.46 lakh Cr (from Rs 78.68 lakh Cr in Q4 of FY25)

News - 100

- RBI – allowed banks to exclude positions from new foreign-currency swap facilities for FCNR(b), ECBs & overseas foreign-currency borrowings from Net Overnight Open Position in INR (NOP-INR) limits
- Policy measures – expected to attract $40-50 billion foreign capital inflows into Govt securities & banking channels
- In March, RBI directed banks to maintain ≤$100 million at the end-of-day in onshore deliverable market
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 101

- RBI – released draft "Commercial Banks - Interest Rate on Deposits Amendment Directions, 2026"
  - applicable to commercial, small finance, regional rural, payment, local area & urban co-operative banks
- Change 1 – Stricter transparency: Banks must disclose deposit interest rates on website before each business day
- Change 2 – Greater pricing flexibility: Commercial & Small Finance Banks may offer differential interest rates on rupee bulk deposits (domestic & NRO) based on deposit size, tenor & LCR treatment
- Bulk deposits: ≥₹3 Cr for SCBs & SFBs (excluding RRBs), & ≥₹1 Cr for Local Area Banks & RRBs
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 102

- RBI – recognised Sahamati Foundation as Self-Regulatory Organisation for Account Aggregator (SRO-AA)
  - 1st cross-sectoral SRO in India spanning RBI, SEBI, IRDAI & PFRDA
- Recognition – under RBI's Framework for Recognising SROs for AA Ecosystem | Applications invited via PRAVAAH portal
  - PRAVAAH portal – **P**latform for **R**egulatory **A**pplication, **V**alidation **A**nd **A**ut**H**orisation (Launched by RBI in May 2024)
- AA framework – introduced in September 2016 as pillar of DEPA
  - It enables secure sharing of financial data across regulated entities (banks, insurance, MFs, pension funds)
- HQs of Sahamati Foundation – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Chairman – R Gandhi | CEO – B G Mahesh | Founded in – 2019
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 103

- GoI unveiled reforms to expand FPI participation in G-Secs via tax exemptions, expansion of Fully Accessible Route (FAR) & streamlined General Route
- Under 'Income-tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026', FPIs/FIIs are fully exempt from interest income & capital gains on G-Secs (previously taxed 20% interest, 30% STCG, 12.5% LTCG)
- FAR – expanded to include new 15-year, 30-year, 40-year G-Secs & Sovereign Green Bonds in FAR-eligible tenors
- Under General Route, short-term investment limit, concentration limit & security-wise limit removed
- Overall ceilings remain unchanged at 6% of Central G-Secs, 2% of State G-Secs
- Existing FPI sub-categories 'General' & 'Long-Term' – merged into single investment limit

News - 104

- RBI – imposed a monetary penalty of ₹41.80 lakh on Canara Bank
  - for non-compliance with KYC & Unclaimed Deposits/Inoperative Accounts directions
- Separate penalty – ₹2.49 lakh on Canara Bank (June 6, 2026) for delayed reporting by its currency chest
- HQs of Canara Bank – Bengaluru | MD & CEO – Hardeep Singh Ahluwalia (interim)

Join us

News - 105

- Kerala – launched "Ashwas-2026", a 100-day One-Time Settlement (OTS) scheme for borrowers who have defaulted on loans availed from cooperative societies, w.e.f. Jun 1, 2026, running until Aug 31, 2026
- Penal interest on eligible loans is waived in full under this scheme
- Interest concessions of up to 15% may be granted, subject to conditions, in cases involving borrowers suffering from critical illnesses or those having critically ill family members
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 106

- RBI's Survey of Professional Forecasters – released alongside June 2026 bi-monthly Monetary Policy Committee meeting
- It projected India's real GDP growth at – 6.5% for 2026-27 (from 7.4% growth recorded in FY26)
- Headline retail CPI inflation – projected at 4.9% for FY27
- SPF – a bi-monthly survey of external professional forecasters conducted by RBI since Sep 2007
- RBI's MPC projected FY27 real GDP growth at – 6.6% (from 6.9%) & FY27 CPI inflation at 5.1% (from 4.6%)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 107

- RBI issued final amendment directions permitting commercial banks to lend to Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) & Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs)
  - While retaining key prudential safeguards on exposure limits, asset quality & repayment structures
- RBI said overseas branches of Indian banks may participate in REITs financing under syndication arrangements
  - Subject to a 20% cap on contribution & a 150% risk weight
- Requirement for an insolvency mechanism was replaced with a broader 'effective recovery mechanism' condition in overseas jurisdictions
- RBI mandated that at least 80% of underlying assets must generate positive cash flows for at least one year
- RBI retained restrictions on bullet & balloon repayment structures
- On exposure norms, aggregate bank exposure to REITs & InvITs & their underlying entities will remain capped at 49% of asset value
- Risk weights have also been revised, with REIT exposures set at 100% (or 125% if classified as capital market exposure)
- RBI said exposures will ultimately shift to the capital charge framework effective Apr 1, 2027
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 108

- RBI cancelled Certificates of Registration (CoR) of 135 NBFCs under powers conferred by Section 45-IA (6) of 'Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934'
  - With 125 of 135 entities registered in WB, 4 in Maharashtra, 2 in Delhi & 1 each in MP, Manipur, TN & Telangana
- These companies are barred from transacting business of an NBFC as defined under clause (a) of Section 45-I of 'RBI Act, 1934'
- Named entities among cancelled NBFCs include:
  - Akshay Fiscal Services Ltd | Alfa Tie-Up Private Limited | Arihant Enterprises Ltd | Destiny International Limited
  - Eastern Synthetics Pvt Ltd | ETL Infrastructure Finance Limited | Gateway Fincons India Ltd | Jupiter Finvest
  - Express Fincap House and Times Finance (P) Ltd (WB) | Essel Finance Business Loans Limited (Mumbai)
  - Citiwide Financial Services Limited (Hyderabad) | Kiranglobal Business Investment Limited (Chennai)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 109

- RBI consolidated regulatory instructions relating to risk management, compliance & internal audit functions for commercial banks through amended directions, w.e.f. Jan 1, 2027
- It requires all commercial banks to establish 3 dedicated & independent control functions
  - Headed by a Chief Risk Officer (CRO), Chief Compliance Officer (CCO) & Head of Internal Audit (HIA), respectively
  - 3 officials must be appointed from among senior officials not more than two levels below MD & CEO
- CRO, CCO & HIA – to be appointed for a fixed tenure of at least 3 years
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 110

- Department of Revenue (MoF) – issued notifications prescribing a nil rate of Central Excise Duty, nil Special Additional Excise Duty, nil Road & Infrastructure Cess and concessional treatment
  - Under Agriculture Infrastructure & Development Cess (AIDC) framework for petrol blended with 22%, 25%, 27% & 30% ethanol by volume
- Exemption is subject to compliance with BIS specifications & applies to ethanol-blended motor spirit
  - Meeting prescribed standards under Automotive Industry Standard (AIS) 171 framework
- India achieved its 20% ethanol blending (E20) target ahead of 2025 deadline
- Ethanol blending in petrol – reached to 20% currently (from 1.53% in 2014)

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News - 111

- India + Nepal = operationalised a peer-to-peer (P2P) cross-border remittance mechanism
- It will establish a direct digital payment link between India's UPI & Nepal's National Payments Interface (NPI)
- Technical integration was implemented through a partnership between – NIPL & Nepal Clearing House Limited (NCHL)
- UPI is now accepted in 9 countries – Singapore, UAE, France, Mauritius, Nepal, Bhutan, Qatar, Sri Lanka & Cambodia
- In July 2021, Bhutan was first to officially adopt UPI standards for QR deployment
- Nepal was first to fully deploy UPI as an active, operational payment platform outside India in early 2022
- Nepal – Kathmandu – Nepalese Rupee | President – Ram Chandra Poudel | PM – Balendra Shah

News - 112

- C S Setty (SBI Chairman) – presented a dividend cheque of ₹8,813 Cr for FY26 to Nirmala Sitharaman at MoF, New Delhi
- SBI Central Board – declared a dividend of ₹17.35 per equity share for FY26
- GoI holds approximately 56.92% stake in SBI as its largest shareholder
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 113

- RBI announced 2 special US dollar-rupee forex swap windows in early Jun 2026
- 1st window covers fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits (FCNR(B)) with tenors of 3-5 years
  - Mobilised by Authorised Dealer Category-I banks between Jun 8 & Sep 30, 2026
  - Swap window remains open until Oct 16, 2026 | Lock-in – 1-year
- FCNR(B) inflows – fallen to $946 million in FY26 (from $7.08 billion in FY25)
- 2nd window covers fresh External Commercial Borrowings by PSUs & Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings by banks
  - Eligible flows received up to Dec 31, 2026 | Access to window until – Jan 15, 2027
  - It may be swapped with RBI at a concessional fixed rate of 1.5% per annum (compounded semi-annually)
- RBI also excluded positions arising from both swap facilities from banks' Net Overnight Open Position (NOP) in rupees
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 114

- SEBI – introduced revised framework for exchange traded funds (ETFs), w.e.f. Sep 1, 2026
- Exchanges will use previous day's closing market price, calculated as last 30-minute volume weighted average price
- SEBI said exchanges & mutual funds should work towards using T-1 closing NAV as base price from Apr 1, 2027
- SEBI also replaced fixed 20% price band for equity & debt ETFs with dynamic price bands
  - It began trading within a 10% band, which can be expanded up to 20% after a cooling-off period if prices hit threshold
  - Overnight & liquid ETFs – continue to have a fixed 5% band

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- For gold & silver ETFs, initial price band – 6% | It can be widened in stages of 3% after cooling-off periods

- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 115

- RBI issued "Master Directions on Authorisation to Operate a Payment System under the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007"
  - Issued under – Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 (they apply to both new applicants & existing PSOs)
- A key change is the shift to perpetual validity of Certificates of Authorisation (CoA) for PSOs
  - Subject to compliance with regulatory conditions, absence of major supervisory concerns & satisfactory inspection reports
  - Existing operators that do not meet these conditions will receive one-year renewals until compliance is achieved
- RBI also strengthened governance standards through enhanced fit & proper criteria for promoters, directors & group entities
- On ownership, RBI tightened norms for investments from FATF non-compliant jurisdictions
  - It capped aggregate voting power at – below 20%
- It introduces a mandatory one-year cooling period for entities whose authorisation is revoked, not renewed, voluntarily surrendered or rejected
- RBI also laid out detailed procedures for voluntary surrender of authorisation, requiring entities to settle all customer & merchant liabilities
  - Unsettled claims – may remain valid for up to 3 years
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 116

- RBI permitted Authorised Dealer (AD) Category-I banks to open repatriable rupee accounts for overseas individuals investing in equity instruments of listed Indian companies
- It operationalizes Central Govt's amendment to Foreign Exchange Management (Non-Debt Instruments) Rules, 2019
  - It expanded direct equity investment access in listed Indian companies to all Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs)
- Each investor must designate a specific repatriable rupee account used exclusively for equity investments under this route
- RBI introduced a new reporting category – 'Individual Foreign Investor (IFI)'
- Under which AD Category-I banks will report purchases & transfers of equity instruments undertaken by overseas individuals
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 117

- BoB launched a new retail term deposit scheme called "bob Golden Goal Deposit Scheme"
- It is a special 555-day tenor deposit scheme offering an interest rate of:
  - 6.75% p.a. – for general public | 7.25% p.a. – for resident senior citizens
  - 7.35% p.a. – for resident super senior citizens, aged 80 years & above | Up to 7.40% p.a. – on Non-Callable Deposits
- It is applicable on retail term deposits below Rs 3 Cr
- Customers can access it through 'bob World' mobile app, net banking platform 'bob World Internet', or branch
- HQs of BoB – Vadodara, Gujarat | MD & CEO – Debadatta Chand | Tagline – "India's International Bank"

News - 118

- RBI relaxed capital requirements for banks on loans under "Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0"
- 75% of guaranteed portion will attract a 0% risk weight & remaining exposure will be assigned a 20% risk weight
- Zero-risk treatment applies to portion where banks expect settlement within 30 days of invoking guarantee
- ECLGS 5.0 – approved by Cabinet May 5, 2026
  - It aims to provide credit guarantee coverage of 100% for MSMEs & 90% for non-MSMEs, as well as airline sector
- It would apply to all loans sanctioned during period from date of issue of these guidelines by NCGTC up to Mar 31, 2027
- ECLGS provides for Guaranteed Emergency Credit Line (GECL) facility
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 119

- In a first-of-its-kind initiative, RBI, Thiruvananthapuram, launched "RBI Reelathon 2026"
  - A mass awareness campaign targeting college students to combat growing menace of cyber-enabled financial frauds
- It was inaugurated by – Ravada A Chandrasekhar (DGP) at a function held at RBI office in Thiruvananthapuram
- Following multiple rounds of evaluation, top 3 winners will receive cash prizes of Rs 75,000, Rs 50,000 & Rs 25,000
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 120

- YES Bank + Northern Arc Capital = partnered to expand credit access, scale digital lending & offer debt investment opportunities to customers
- Northern Arc Investment Managers – to offer AIFs & Portfolio Management Services to Yes Bank's retail, affluent & institutional clients
- Northern Arc's online bonds platform 'Altifi' – to also be integrate with bank's wealth management ecosystem
- HQs of Yes Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Vinay Muralidhar Tonse | Tagline – "Experience our Expertise"
- HQs of Northern Arc Capital – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Chairman – P S Jayakumar | MD & CEO – Ashish Mehrotra

Join us

News - 121

- 'Developments in India's Balance of Payments during the Fourth Quarter (Jan-Mar) of 2025-26' – released by RBI
- India's current account surplus (CAS) – $7.1 billion (0.7% of GDP) in 4th quarter (Jan-Mar) of FY26
  - From a surplus of – $13.7 billion (1.4% of GDP) in corresponding quarter of FY25
- Net services receipts – $60.4 billion in Q4 FY26 (from $53.3 billion in Q4 FY25)
- Merchandise trade deficit – $83.4 billion in Q4 FY26 (from $59.3 billion in Q4 FY25)
- For FY26, current account deficit (CAD) – $25.2 billion (0.6% of GDP) (from $22.9 billion (0.6% of GDP) in FY25)
- On capital account, net FDI inflows – rose to $4.2 billion in Q4 FY26 & to $6.9 billion for FY26 (from $1 billion in FY25)
- FPI recorded net inflows – $12 billion in Q4 FY26 & $16.4 billion for FY26 (from $3.6 billion in FY25)
- Foreign exchange reserves – increased by $7.2 billion on a Balance of Payments basis in Q4 FY26
- For FY26, reserves depleted by – $23.6 billion (from $5 billion in FY25)

News - 122

- NPCI launched "Drunix", an open-source blockchain platform to help enterprises build & scale tokenisation platforms, digital asset ecosystems & multi-organisation blockchain networks
- It marks NPCI's 2nd major open-source contribution in blockchain & tokenisation space, after 'Falcon'
- NPCI's other digital infrastructure initiatives include – 'Finance Model for India (FiMI)' & 'Vigil-AI'
- NPCI is also planning to establish a 4th subsidiary, 'NPCI Tech Solutions Ltd (NTSL)'
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

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News - 123

- NSE Indices Ltd – launched 11 new sector-specific indices under the Nifty umbrella
  - expanding the total count of sectoral indices from 23 to 34
- 11 newly introduced indices are: Nifty Power, Nifty Capital Goods, Nifty Telecommunications, Nifty Construction, Nifty Consumer Services, Nifty Commercial and Transport Services, Nifty Retail, Nifty Hospitals, Nifty NBFC, Nifty Housing Finance and Nifty Insurance
- HQs of NSE Indices Limited – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Mukesh Agarwal | Established in – 1998

News - 124

- Keki Mistry – extended as an interim part-time Chairman of HDFC Bank for 3 months until Sep 18, 2026
  - Her earlier took this role after abrupt resignation of Atanu Chakraborty
- He is currently a Director on Board of HDFC Life Insurance Company, HDFC ERGO General Insurance Company, TCS, HDFC Capital Advisors, The Great Eastern Shipping Company, KATB Consultant Pvt Ltd, Brookprop Management Services Pvt Ltd & Flipkart Internet Private Ltd
- HQs of HDFC Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sashidhar Jagdishan | Tagline – "We understand your World"

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News - 125

- PhonePe – introduced a 'wallet inactivity maintenance fee' of Rs 100 per quarter for inactive wallets
- If wallet balance is less than Wallet Maintenance Fee, then entire wallet balance will be debited
- A wallet will be marked as 'inactive' if a user has not made any financial transactions through it in past 365 days
- Users receive multiple alerts over 15 days before fee is applied
  - If a wallet transaction is made during this period, it becomes active again & no fee is charged
  - If no action is taken, fee will be deducted from wallet in 15 days
- HQs of PhonePe – Bangalore, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Sameer Nigam | Founded in – 2015

News - 126

- Axis Bank + BITS Pilani = an MoU to establish 'Axis Bank-BITS Industry Research, Technology and Innovation Park' at BITS Pilani's Hyderabad campus
  - Supported by a ₹100 Cr Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) grant from Axis Bank
- HQs of Axis Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Amitabh Chaudhry | Tagline – "Badhti ka Naam Zindagi"
- Location of BITS Pilani – Pilani, Rajasthan | Chairman & Chancellor – Kumar Mangalam Birla

News - 127

- Canara Bank, BoB, Federal Bank & IOB – launched "Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNR(B)" schemes
  - With attractive interest rates on US dollar deposits, offering attractive rates to attract NRI, OCI & POIs
- Govt will bear hedging cost on 3 to 5-year FCNR(B) deposits till Sep 30, 2026
- Canara Bank – offers up to 6.5% p.a. on USD deposits (3-5 years), w.e.f. Jun 11, 2026, with a lock-in period of 1 year
- Federal Bank (FCNR Max Deposit Scheme) – offers at 6.25% p.a. (3-5 years) with a lock-in period of 1 year
  - Premature closure after lock-in reduces interest by 1%
- BoB (bob Legend FCNR(B)) – offers 6% with maturities of 3 years to less than 4 years, 6.1% on tenures of 4 years to less than 5 years & 6.50% on 5-year deposits, w.e.f. Jun 17, 2026
- IOB – exclusively for NRIs, offering a 6.50% p.a. on US Dollar deposits, w.e.f. Jun 15, 2026 (till Sep 30, 2026)
- Under this scheme, premature withdrawal is not allowed for 1 year; after that, interest will be reduced by 1%

Tenure	Interest Rate on USD Deposits	Tenure
Canara Bank	Up to 6.50% p.a.	3 years to 5 years
Federal Bank	6.25% p.a.	3 years to 5 years
Bank of Baroda	6.00% p.a. (3 years to less than 4 years); 6.10% p.a. (4 years to less than 5 years); 6.25% p.a. (5 years)	3 years to 5 years
Indian Overseas Bank (IOB)	6.50% p.a.	3 to 5 years

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News - 128

- Rajendra Kumar Saboo – assigned additional charge of as MD & CEO of UCO Bank, w.e.f. Jun 19, 2026
- HQs of UCO Bank – Kolkata, WB | MD & CEO – Rajendra Kumar Saboo (add. charge) | Tagline – "Honours your Trust"

News - 129

- BSE Index Services Pvt Ltd – launched India's 1st Saatvik Index, "BSE Saatvik 100"
  - It can be used for passive investment strategies such as exchange-traded funds (ETFs) & index funds
  - It can also serve as a benchmark for portfolio management services, mutual fund schemes & investment portfolios
- Financial services sector – highest weight in BSE Saatvik 100 Index at 37.55%
  - Followed by – Consumer Discretionary & Energy
- Among individual stocks, HDFC Bank holds largest weight in index | Followed by – ICICI Bank & Reliance Industries
- HQs of BSE – Mumbai | Chairman – Subhasis Chaudhuri | MD&CEO – Sundararaman Ramamurthy | Founded in – 1875

News - 130

- IRDAI – constituted a Working Group on AI Governance in Insurance Sector (WG-AI)
  - To guide regulated entities in adopting, governing & overseeing AI technologies responsibly
- It is chaired by – Sandeep Shukla (Director of IIIT Hyderabad)
- It also comprises: Nandakumar Saravade (former CEO of ReBIT) | Ashutosh Bahuguna (Scientist at CERT-In)
  - Manoj Nayak (CISO at SBI Life Insurance) | Shivanath Somanathan (CISO at Star Health & Allied Insurance)
  - Steve D'Souza (CRO at ICICI Lombard General Insurance)
  - Deepak Gaikwad (General Manager & CISO at IRDAI) – to serve as Member-Convener
- It has been mandated to submit its recommendations to IRDAI's Member within 3 months of its constitution
- HQs of IRDAI – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Ajay Seth | Established in – 1999

News - 131

- PNB + Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Ltd = to launch biodegradable "PNB-Zaggle Co-branded Twin Credit Cards"
- Cards will be available through 'zagg.money' mobile application
- HQs of PNB – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Ashok Chandra | Tagline – "The Name You Can Bank Upon"
- HQs of Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Avinash Ramesh Godkhindi

News - 132

- PFRDA – launched "PFRDA Pension Sahayak", an AI-enabled grievance redressal platform
  - It allows subscribers to lodge complaints through voice commands & access services in 22 Indian languages
- It combines principles of accessibility, transparency & accountability envisioned under 'NextGen CPGRAMS' initiative
  - CPGRAMS – 'Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System'
- HQs of PFRDA – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sivasubramanian Ramann | Founded in – 2003

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News - 133

- RBI – amended its Credit Facilities Directions for commercial banks & SFBs
  - Pre-sanctioned credit lines linked to UPI & other payment instruments will continue to be governed by existing prudential norms applicable to underlying loan
- Banks designing credit products linked to a specific payment mode will be required to incorporate T&Cs governing such facilities in their board-approved credit policy
  - These products must also comply with all applicable regulatory requirements governing underlying credit facility
- Only those credit facilities that banks are already permitted to sanction under existing regulations can be linked to payment instruments
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 134

- RBI issued final "Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Directions, 2026" for Commercial Banks, SFBs, RRBs & Rural Co-operative Banks
  - It consolidated all existing KCC-related circulars into a single Master Direction & incorporated stakeholder feedback received on draft directions issued on Feb 12, 2026
- Implementation date has been deferred by 6 months from proposed Jul 1, 2026 to Jan 1, 2027
- KCC loans sanctioned before Jan 1, 2027, will continue to be governed by existing guidelines until maturity or next renewal
- It introduces a composite KCC facility with a 6-year tenure, covering short-term credit for crop cultivation
- Crop seasons have been standardised: Short-duration crops at 12 months & long-duration crops at 18 months
- Collateral security & margin requirements – waived for agricultural loans up to ₹2 lakh per borrower
  - For loans with tie-up arrangements, waiver extends to ₹3 lakh
  - Voluntary pledge of gold or silver as collateral does not constitute a violation of collateral-free norms
- For marginal farmers (landholding up to 1 hectare), a Flexi KCC facility with a flexible limit of ₹10,000 to ₹50,000 may be extended based on landholding & crop profile
- For short-term loans to small & marginal farmers, total interest debited to an account shall not exceed principal amount
- As of Mar 2024, ~7.75 crore KCC accounts existed with outstanding credit of ~₹9.81 lakh Cr
- KCC scheme – launched in 1998 on recommendation of an RBI Working Group implemented through NABARD
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 135

- RBI issued final revised directions on "Lead Bank Scheme (LBS)", replacing all earlier instructions governing scheme
- Lead banks are now mandated to appoint a Lead District Manager (LDM) exclusively for each district under their charge
- Block Level Bankers' Committee (BLBC) is formally established as foundation of credit-planning process

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- At state level, State Level Bankers' Committees (SLBCs) are directed

- Uniform timelines have been prescribed for meetings of BLBCs, DCCs, DLRCs & SLBCs
- It mandates banks to achieve a credit-deposit (CD) ratio of 60% for their rural & semi-urban branches on an all-India basis & to prioritise opening Core Banking Solution (CBS)-enabled banking outlets in Tier-5 centres
- Virtual participation in meetings has been permitted where physical attendance is not feasible
- Lead Bank Scheme – introduced in 1969 on recommendations of Gadgil Study Group
  - To address inadequate banking presence in rural areas
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 136

- Zerodha Fund House – became 1st AMC in India to launch "Lifecycle Mutual Funds" by filing & opening NFOs for 'Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2036' & 'Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2041'
  - It is a new mutual fund category introduced by SEBI in Feb 2026 for goal-based investing
  - NFO period running from Jun 19 to Jul 7, 2026
- Lifecycle Funds are open-ended funds structured around a specific target maturity year
- 2 funds invest across Equity, Debt, InvITs, ETCDs, Gold ETFs & Silver ETFs
- Fund Manager for Life Cycle Fund 2036 – Kedarnath Mirajkar | CEO of Zerodha Fund House – Vishal Jain
- Minimum subscription amount – ₹100 | No entry load is applicable
- Exit load for redemptions within 3 years is tiered (3% within 1 year, 2% within 2 yrs, 1% within 3 yrs, nil beyond 3 yrs)
- Target-date funds have AUM exceeding $4 trillion
- HQs of Zerodha – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Nithin Kamath | CFO – Nikhil Kamath | Established in – 2010

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News - 137

- RBI released draft Guidance on Regulatory Principles for Model Risk Management Framework (MRMF)
- Regulated entities will be required to put in place a board-approved MRMF covering all models, including AI/ML models
- RBI also sought to address risks arising from use of third-party AI models
- Regulated entities will be required to assess risks arising from behavioural characteristics of AI models & test their performance under atypical & stressed scenarios
- RBI further proposed mandatory human oversight for AI-driven decision-making
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 138

- SEBI approved "GARUDA (Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement)" mechanism
  - To transition AIF framework from pre-clearance model to a fast-track, accountability-driven disclosure model

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- Under new structure, SEBI categorised AIF schemes to streamline approvals based on investor sophistication
- Angel Funds & Accredited Investor-only (AI-only) schemes – now launch immediately once Private Placement Memorandum (PPM) is filed & SEBI acknowledges receipt
- Regular Schemes – to benefit from a vastly compressed 10-working-day approval window
- Large Value Funds (LVFs) – to operate under their pre-existing fast-track waivers
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 139

- MoF issued "Customs Notification No. 53/2026 - Customs (N.T.)", under Section 28A of 'Customs Act, 1962'
  - It grants retrospective customs duty exemption on all goods imported for nuclear power generation from Apr 1, 2019 to Jan 31, 2026
- It covers nuclear power generation goods falling under 'Tariff Item 8401 30 00'
- Section 28A of Customs Act empowers Centre to regularise situations where a practice of non-levy or short-levy of customs duty was generally prevalent
- In Union Budget 2026-27, govt further extended customs duty exemption on nuclear power project imports until 2035
  - Principal beneficiary – Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL)
- India has set a target of achieving 100 GW of nuclear power capacity by 2047 under 'Viksit Bharat' vision
- India also announced a dedicated 'Nuclear Energy Mission' in Union Budget 2025-26
- India's current operational nuclear capacity – ~8.78 Gigawatt (GW)

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News - 140

- RBI mandated that NBFCs with an asset size of Rs 1 trillion & above will be classified as upper-layer entities
  - They will be subjected to enhanced regulatory oversight
- These entities will be identified annually for scale-based regulation
  - Asset-size threshold for classification – to be reviewed every 3 years
- Govt-owned NBFCs will have to adhere to concentration limits based on whether they are classified in middle layer or upper layer under SBR framework
- Existing breaches of exposure limits will be allowed to run off until maturity
  - Fresh exposures to such obligors – to not be permitted
- Key proposals around classification of NBFCs with assets of Rs 1 trillion & above as upper-layer entities, as well as treatment of bank-owned NBFCs, remain unchanged
- RBI also introduced a new set of guidelines for NBFCs that are group entities of scheduled commercial banks
  - Such entities will be required to comply with norms on commercial banks in cases where both NBFC & its parent bank undertake same financial activity
  - These requirements will apply irrespective of an NBFC's classification under SBR framework
- RBI eased certain exposure norms for Infrastructure Finance Companies (IFCs)

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- Exposures backed by state govt guarantees would be treated as exposures to guaranteeing state govt & exempted from prudential exposure limits, subject to a 20% risk weight

- RBI raised exposure limit for a group of connected counterparties for NBFC-IFCs to 45%
  - It allowed IFCs to exceed prescribed exposure limit by up to 20% of their Tier-I capital for such exposures
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 141

- Skydo (Bengaluru) – secured an international payment licence in Canada under 'Retail Payment Activities Act (RPAA)'
  - It became 1st Indian cross-border payments platform to receive regulatory approval outside India
- Skydo now holds regulatory approvals in 3 jurisdictions:
  - An RBI Payment Aggregator - Cross Border (PA-CB-I) licence | A GIFT City licence | Canadian licence
- India-Canada bilateral trade – CAD 13.6 billion
- HQs of Skydo – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-founded by – Srivatsan Sridhar (CEO) & Movin Jain

News - 142

- RBI issued final directions to expand India's credit derivatives market, applicable from Jun 25, 2026
- They will enable resident Indian non-retail users to deploy instruments without any restrictions on purpose
- Retail resident users (except individuals) – may undertake credit default swaps only for hedging
  - A resident retail user (other than an individual) – allowed to buy protection only for purpose of hedging
- Credit derivative contracts with non-residents may be settled in Indian rupees or a foreign currency as per latest rules
- Insurance companies, pension funds, MFs, AIFs & FPIs – be eligible to act as protection sellers
- Before launching any CDS product, exchanges must obtain RBI approval for product design, changes in product design, eligible participants & other details of CDS contracts
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 143

- RBI released draft master directions on secondary market transactions in government securities
- Individuals holding demat accounts through depository participant banks that are direct members of NDS-OM – to be able to undertake transactions on platform
- It also incorporates participation through 'Stock Broker Connect' facility & transactions undertaken through 'RBI Retail Direct Scheme'
- RBI proposed that direct members of NDS-OM provide web-based access to constituent gilt account holders for undertaking transactions in government securities
  - Individual constituent gilt account holders & eligible demat account holders – to be provided such access on request

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- Transactions undertaken outside NDS-OM would continue to be reported to platform within 15 minutes of execution
  - Transactions would be settled on a delivery-versus-payment basis through CCIL or any other clearing agency approved by RBI
- Draft retains position limits for short-sale transactions & prescribes that such positions be covered within 3 months from date of transaction
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 144

- jUMPP – received approval from NPCI to operate as a Third Party Application Provider (TPAP) under UPI framework
  - It is India's 1st AI-powered conversational fintech platform focused on investing & wealth creation
- YES Bank – serving as its Payment Service Provider (PSP) Bank for banking & Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS) services
- Existing TPAPs include PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, Amazon Pay, BHIM & WhatsApp Pay
- UPI – operated by NPCI & processes over 18 billion transactions per month across India
- HQs of jUMPP – Mohali, Punjab | Founder & CEO – Sarvjeet Singh Virk | Established in – 2025

News - 145

- 'LEXI' – received in-principle approval from IFSCA to operate as a Payment Service Provider at GIFT-IFSC, Gandhinagar
- IFSCA in-principle approval covers 3 categories of regulated payment services:
  - Account issuance including e-money | Cross-border money transfer | Merchant acquisition
- HQs of LEXI – GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Co-founder & CEO – Dipender Bhamrah

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News - 146

- Paisabazaar + SBM Bank India = jointly launched "SBM Paisabazaar Paisa+ Credit Card"
  - Minimum FD requirement – ₹2,000
- SBM Bank India – 1st foreign bank to receive a universal banking licence from RBI to set up & operate as a Scheduled Commercial Bank under Wholly Owned Subsidiary (WOS) model
- HQs of Paisabazaar – Gurgaon, Haryana | CEO – Santosh Agarwal
- HQs of SBM Bank India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Ashish Vijayakar | Director & CFO – Amit Jagdhari

News - 147

- Jio Platforms – filed draft papers with SEBI for what could become India's biggest-ever initial public offering (IPO)
- This issue represents nearly 3% of post-issue share capital
- Brokerages estimate IPO could raise between Rs 33,000 Cr & Rs 38,000 Cr | Value of company – Rs 12-15 lakh Cr
- Reliance Industries – currently holds a 66.43% stake in Jio Platforms
- HQs of Jio Platforms – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Group CEO – Mathew Oommen

Join us

News - 148

- RBI issued final "Reserve Bank of India (Trade Receivables Discounting System) Directions, 2026" with immediate effect
  - It consolidates all existing TReDS instructions into a single Master Direction framework
  - 'Special Awareness Programme for MSME Entrepreneurs' – inaugurated by RBI Governor in Kochi, Kerala
- 5 key changes under final Directions are:

  (i) Removal of mandatory due diligence requirement for MSME sellers

  (ii) Expansion of eligible participant categories to include insurance companies & government-notified credit guarantee funds on TReDS platforms

  (iii) Financiers are now permitted to obtain guarantee cover for factoring units from any credit guarantee fund trust established by GoI

  (iv) Minimum net worth requirement for TReDS operators – ₹25 Cr

  (v) Greater operational flexibility for authorised TReDS entities
- All TReDS transactions continue to remain without recourse to MSME sellers
- TReDS – an RBI-regulated digital marketplace enabling MSMEs to auction invoices to banks, NBFC-Factors & other financiers for early payment
  - It is operating under – 'Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007'
- There are currently 5 authorised TReDS platforms: RXIL, M1xchange, Invoicemart, C2treds & DTX (KredX)
  - TReDS processed approximately $23.6 billion in transactions in FY25
- All companies with turnover exceeding ₹250 Cr & all CPSEs are mandatorily required to register on TReDS
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 149

- SEBI proposed a Common Advertisement Code (CAC) to replace multiple, separate advertising rules with a single set of guidelines for all market stakeholders
  - It will be incorporated into SEBI (Intermediaries) Regulations, 2008
- Regulated entities would be required to report advertisements within 24 hours of publication
- SEBI also proposed allowing regulated entities to engage celebrities for brand or entity-level promotion, subject to prescribed conditions
- SEBI also proposes allowing regulated entities to advertise ratings & rankings assigned by a 'Past Risk and Return Verification Agency (PaRRVA)', subject to prescribed conditions & disclosures
- SEBI proposed development of a common digital reporting portal by recognised supervisory bodies for advertisement reporting
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

Join us

News - 150

- RBI permitted Indian banks, including overseas branches, to extend loans to non-resident account holders or issue SBLC in favour of overseas lenders against FCNR(B) deposits mobilised under new swap facility & mark a lien on such deposits
  - SBLC – Standby Letters of Credit
- Lien – a legal claim or right over someone else's property until a debt or obligation is paid
- RBI announced special dispensation that allows banks to mobilise fresh 3-5-year FCNR(B) deposits until Sep 2026
  - It also permitted them to swap these deposits with RBI at a concessional rate
- RBI will be providing a forex swap for deposit received
- RBI will be allowed to undertake swaps for tenors of less than 3 years provided they have mobilised fresh eligible FCNR (B) deposits for a minimum original tenor of 3 years
- Interest rates on deposits – subject to compliance with paragraph 32(2) of Reserve Bank (Commercial Banks – Interest Rate on Deposits) Directions, 2025
- Banks will continue to offer regular FCNR (B) deposits, without availing swap facility, for customer deposits with a tenor of 3 years & above up to 5 years, without requirement of a minimum lock-in period of 1 year
- ECBs can be raised for any period, as permitted in terms of Foreign Exchange Management (Borrowing and Lending) (First Amendment) Regulations, 2026
  - ECBs of average maturity of 3 years & above – eligible for this facility
- Tenor of swap will be co-terminus with repayment schedule or maturity of ECB, subject to a maximum period of 5 years
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 151

- RBI – issued final revised directions under its Scale-Based Regulation (SBR) framework for NBFCs
- Only NBFCs with an asset size of ₹1,00,000 Cr & above – to be classified as NBFC-UL
  - Asset threshold reviewed every 3 years
- Eligible government-owned NBFCs – now included in NBFC-UL list
- Govt-owned NBFC-UL entities – exempt from mandatory stock exchange listing requirement
- All bank-owned NBFCs will be subject to NBFC-UL norms regardless of asset size but are exempt from listing requirement
- In Upper Layer, large exposure limit for a single group of connected borrowers – increased to 45% of Tier 1 capital
- RBI's SBR framework, introduced in Oct 2021, classifies all NBFCs across 4 layers – Base, Middle, Upper & Top
- As of Mar 2025, 15 NBFCs were classified as Upper Layer
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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Defence Affairs

News - 152

- "Shangri-La Dialogue" in Singapore – organized by International Institute for Strategic Studies (IISS)
- GoI + Vietnam = signed BrahMos cruise missile export agreement worth ~Rs 6,000 Cr ($629 million)
- Philippines – 1st foreign BrahMos buyer in 2022 ($375 million) | 1st batch delivered 2024, 2nd batch in April 2025
- BrahMos – Indo-Russian joint venture | Range – 290 km | Fastest cruise missile (Mach 2.8)
  - Multiplatform launch from – Land, Air & Sea | Named after – Brahmaputra (India) & Moskva (Russia)
- Vietnam – Hanoi – Vietnamese dong | PM – Pham Minh Chinh | President – To Lam

News - 153

- India issued Letter of Request (LoR) to France to finalise mega defence agreement | Worth – Rs 3.25 lakh Cr
  - For 114 Rafale fighter jets for Indian Air Force (IAF), under Multi-Role Fighter Aircraft (MRFA) project
- LoR – a formal government-to-government document used to initiate a defence procurement
- About 18 of multi-role fighters will be bought in fly-away condition & are expected to be added to IAF fleet by 2030
  - Rest will be manufactured in India under a Dassault-HAL collaboration
- Navy is separately procuring 26 Rafale Marine aircraft from Dassault for carrier operations
- Indian Air Force (IAF) currently operates 36 Rafales
- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu

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News - 154

- India received 4th squadron of Russian-made S-400 Triumf long-range surface-to-air missile system, designated 'Sudarshan' in IAF service, delivered by ship & confirmed on June 3, 2026
  - As part of $5.43 billion agreement signed between India & Russia in Oct 2018 for procurement of 5 S-400 squadrons
- S-400 Triumf – manufactured by Russia's Almaz-Antey
  - Effective engagement range – up to 400 km | Altitude coverage – from 5 metres to 30,000 metres
- DRDO's 'Project Kusha' is developing an indigenous long-range surface-to-air missile system comparable to S-400
- Under 'CAATSA', US previously threatened sanctions over India's S-400 purchase from Russia (no sanctions yet)
  - CAATSA – Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act

News - 155

- MoD officially ended exclusive production monopoly held by Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) for tactical missiles
  - Under newly notified Defence Acquisition Procedure (DAP) 2026
- Bharat Dynamics Limited – a Navratna DPSU headquartered in Hyderabad, established in 1970
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

Join us

News - 156

- Vladimir Putin (Russian President) – offered New Delhi Russia's 5th-generation stealth aircraft, "Sukhoi Su-57"
  - He also proposed its joint production in India | On sidelines of – St Petersburg Economic Forum
- India + Russia = earlier pursued a joint Fifth Generation Fighter Aircraft (FGFA) programme for years
  - New Delhi withdrew it in 2021
- India is developing an indigenous air defence system called 'Sudarshan Chakra'
  - Russian-origin S-400 missile systems – to be one of key components
- In Oct 2018, India signed a $5 billion deal with Russia to buy 5 units of S-400 air defence missile systems
- In Mar 2026, India cleared procurement of a fresh batch of 5 S-400 missile systems (taking total number to 10)
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

News - 157

- MoD + Accord Software & Systems Pvt Ltd (Bengaluru) = a contract for procurement of 20 'Enhanced Capability Global Navigation Satellite System (ECGNSS) Jammers' for Indian Navy
  - Total cost – Rs 449 Cr
- It adheres to minimum requirement of 75% indigenous content under Buy (Indian-Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured) category
- HQs of Accord Software & Systems – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Murali | Established in – 1991
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

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News - 158

- 1st Airbus C295 military transport aircraft manufactured in India – completed its maiden test flight
  - From Final Assembly Line (FAL) at Vadodara, Gujarat
  - It marks 1st instance of a military aircraft being manufactured in India by private sector
- Produced by – Tata Advanced Systems Limited (TASL) + Airbus Defence & Space
- It is 1st of 40 C295 transport aircraft to be built in India under ₹21,935 Cr contract signed in Sep 2021 between India & Airbus for procurement of 56 C295s for IAF
  - 16 aircraft – delivered directly from Airbus's facility in Seville, Spain
  - 40 aircrafts – being manufactured in India between 2026 & 2031 (to replace IAF's ageing Avro (HS 748) fleet)
- C295 – a tactical military transport aircraft powered by 2 Pratt & Whitney Canada PW127G turboprop engines
  - They will be fitted with indigenous electronic warfare suite developed by BEL & BDL

Join us

News - 159

- SMPP (Delhi) – completed delivery of 100 jet-based Peacekeeper drones, aka "Agniveg", operational drones & 6 training drones to Indian Army
- Agniveg – a turbojet-powered kamikaze drone system
  - Operational range – about 180 km | Speed – up to 450 kmph
- SMPP also offered next generation of kamikaze drone, which is capable of flying at 750 km/hour
  - Originally a Belarusian one manufactured by a company called KB Indela, which has partnered with SMPP
- HQs of SMPP Ltd – New Delhi | CEO – Ashish Kansal | CMD – Dr Shiv Chand Kansal

News - 160

- 1st batch of women cadets trained at NDA (Pune) – commissioned as officers across 3 Services in Jun 2026
  - With a total of 17 women completing their full pre-commissioning training pipeline & receiving their commissions
  - They joined NDA in Aug 2022 as part of 148th Course
- In Indian Army, 9 women officers were commissioned during 158th Regular Course Passing Out Parade at IMA, Dehradun
  - On Jun 13, 2026, reviewed by President Droupadi Murmu, with a total of 515 officer cadets commissioned
- In IAF, 5 women officers were commissioned during 217th Course Combined Graduation Parade at Air Force Academy (AFA), Dundigal, Hyderabad
  - On Jun 13, 2026, reviewed by Def. Min. Rajnath Singh, out of 231 cadets commissioned including 37 women
- In Indian Navy, 3 women officers were commissioned during Spring Term 2026 Passing Out Parade at Indian Naval Academy (INA), Ezhimala, Kerala
  - On May 28, 2026, reviewed by Vice Adm. Sameer Saxena, Flag Officer C-i-C, Southern Naval Command
- Lt Shanan Dhaka (AIR 1 among women candidates) – among 9 commissioned into Indian Army
  - She hails from Sundana village, Rohtak district, Haryana
- 148th Course Passing Out Parade – held at Khetarpal Ground, Pune, on May 30, 2025
  - 17 women became 1st women ever to graduate from NDA in its 71-year history

News - 161

- DRDO – conducted a successful flight test of Long Range Land Attack Cruise Missile (LRLACM) on Jun 15, 2026
  - From Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha | It is 2nd flight test of LRLACM (after Nov 12, 2024)
  - 1st flight test – conducted from a mobile articulated launcher at Integrated Test Range, Chandipur
- All test objectives were fully met as per data captured by tracking instruments of Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur
- LRLACM – an indigenously developed missile configured for launch in two modes: from ground & from frontline warships
- Nodal Laboratory for this programme – Aeronautical Development Establishment (ADE), Bengaluru
  - 2 Development Cum Production Partners – Bharat Dynamics Ltd (Hyderabad) & Bharat Electronics Ltd (Bengaluru)

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- LRLACM – a Defence Acquisition Council-approved, Acceptance of Necessity-sanctioned Mission Mode Project conceived as an advanced successor to Nirbhay subsonic cruise missile
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 162

- Indian Navy officially retired its Sea King Bravo helicopter fleet & 'number plated' Indian Naval Air Squadron 330 (INAS 330) after over 5 decades of service
- Sea King Mk 42B completed its final ceremonial flight from INS Shikra, Western Naval Command base in Colaba, Mumbai
- INAS 330 – commissioned on Apr 17, 1971, at INS Garuda, Kochi, under command of Commander MP Wadhawan
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 163

- MoD granted in-principle approval for a Rs 500 Cr National Military Drone Technology Hub at IIT Kanpur CoE
- Prepared by – Uttar Pradesh Expressways Industrial Development Authority (UPEIDA)
  - It is also principal nodal body for Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor
- Army Design Bureau (ADB) – designated as single point of contact for coordination
- Monitoring Committee – constituted under Additional Secretary & DG (Acquisition), Department of Defence
  - To ensure coordination between IIT Kanpur, UP govt & MoD
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

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News - 164

- "Exercise Khaan Quest 2026" – being held from Jun 20 to Jul 3 in Five Hills Training Area in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia
  - It is a multinational peacekeeping exercise
- It comprises 40 personnel & is being represented by troops from a battalion of Jat Regiment
- Previous edition of this exercise – conducted from Jun 14 to 28, 2025, in Mongolia
- Mongolia – Ulaanbaatar – Mongolian Togrog | President – Ukhnaa Khurelsukh | PM – Nyam-Osoryn Uchral

News - 165

- ICG inducted 1st indigenous Air Cushion Vehicle (ACV), "H-561", into service at Chowgule Shipyard, Goa
  - It marks India's 1st-ever indigenously designed & manufactured hovercraft
- H-561 – 1st of 6 ACVs being constructed by Chowgule & Company Pvt Ltd (Goa) under a ₹387.44 Cr contract
  - Contract was signed with Ministry of Defence on Oct 24, 2024, under Buy (Indian) procurement category
- ICG currently maintains a total fleet of over 160 ships, boats & aircraft
- HQs of ICG – New Delhi | DG – S Paramesh | Founded in – 1977

Join us

News - 166

- KSSL (subsidiary of BFL) + Paramount (South Africa) = unveiled 'Simha 4×4' at "Eurosatory 2026", held in Paris, France
  - A Light Armoured Multi-Purpose Vehicle (LAMPV)
- HQs of KSSL – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman – Rajinder Singh Bhatia | Established in – 2010
- HQs of Paramount Global – New York, US | Chairman & CEO – David Ellison | President – Jeff Shell

News - 167

- KSSL + AM General = partnered to jointly offer next-generation mounted artillery gun systems to global armed forces
  - At – 'Eurosatory 2026' defence exposition in Paris
- AM General proposed participation in US Army's Mobile Tactical Cannon (MTC) programme
  - Under which a 155mm MTC solution based on KSSL's MArG platform would be developed & delivered
- AM General – manufacturer of 'HUMVEE' (High Mobility Multipurpose Wheeled Vehicle) used by armed forces globally
- HQs of KSSL – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman – Rajinder Singh Bhatia | Established in – 2010
- HQs of AM General – South Bend, Indiana, USA | President & CEO – John Chadbourne | Established in – 1971

News - 168

- India tested heaviest indigenous 120-mm vehicle-mounted mortar system, "Garudastra" at Infantry School Mhow, MP
- Developed by – Nibe Ltd | Operated by a two-member crew, it is capable of firing 12 rounds in 60 seconds

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News - 169

- Rajnath Singh – inaugurated Advanced Weapon System Integration Complex constructed under DRDO's 'Project Kusha'
  - At – Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Missile Complex (DRDL), Hyderabad
- 'Project Kusha' – an indigenously developed Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile (LR-SAM) programme designed by DRDL
  - Estimated cost – ~₹21,700 Cr | It is designed to deliver capability comparable to Russia's 'S-400/S-500' systems
- It operates as a 3-tier layered interceptor architecture comprising interceptors:
  - M1 (~150 km range), M2 (~250 km range) & M3 (~350-400 km range)
  - Uttam AESA radar – provides a detection range of up to 500 km
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 170

- Indian Army selected Meprolight's "MEPRO X6" fixed 6x magnification telescopic daytime sight as dedicated optic for its in-service 'NEGEV NG-7' 7.62×51mm NATO light machine guns
- MEPRO X6 – provides a fixed 6x magnification with an effective range of up to 1,000 metres
- Initial procurement covers more than 10,000 MEPRO X6 units, with deliveries scheduled throughout 2026-27
- BEL – secured tender & will serve as prime contractor supplying Indian Army

Join us

- Meprolight + RRP Defense = signed a comprehensive Transfer of Technology (ToT) agreement enabling full in-India production, long-term support & technology absorption in advanced soldier-system optics
- Meprolight Ltd (Israel) – active in Indian defence market for ~25 years
- NEGEV NG-7 LMG (originally developed by Israel Weapon Industries) – being produced in India
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Upendra Dwivedi | Vice Chief – Lt. Gen. Dheeraj Seth

News - 171

- US DSCA – formally notified in Federal Register a combined estimated $482.2 million sustainment support package for India's in-service "M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzers" & "AH-64E Apache" attack helicopters
- 1st package ($230 million) – covers long-term sustainment support for India's 'M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzers (ULH)'
  - Principal contractor – BAE Systems (Cumbria, UK)
- 2nd package ($198.2 million) – covers sustainment support services for India's AH-64E Apache attack helicopters
  - Principal contractors – Boeing Company & Lockheed Martin
- Indian Army has operationalised 145 'M777A2' howitzers
- Indian Army operates 22 'AH-64E Apache Guardian' attack helicopters

Sports & Games

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News - 172

- India (Women team) – won 10 medals at 'Under-17 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026', Da Nang, Vietnam
- 10 medals:
  - 2 Gold – Diksha (43kg), Garima (73kg)
  - 3 Silver – Nikita (49kg), Antra (65kg), Taniya (69kg)
  - 5 Bronze – Palak (40kg), Anamika (46kg), Akshra (53kg), Sakshi (57kg), Manya (61kg)

News - 173

- Royal Challengers Bengaluru – won "TATA IPL 2026" final at Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad
  - Defeated – Gujarat Titans (captain Shubman Gill) | RCB captain – Rajat Patidar
- RCB became only 3rd franchise in IPL history to retain title (after Chennai Super Kings & Mumbai Indians)
- Virat Kohli played 75 off 42 balls (his fastest IPL fifty & highest playoff score)
- 'Player of the Match' – Virat Kohli
- 'Orange Cap', 'Most Valuable Player', 'Emerging Player of the Season', 'Super Striker' & 'Super Sixes' awards – Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (Rajasthan Royals)

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- He became youngest Orange Cap winner in IPL history & 1st player to win both 'MVP' & 'Emerging Player' in same season
- He struck 72 sixes, surpassing Chris Gayle's IPL record of 59 in a single season (set in 2011)

- Kagiso Rabada (Gujarat Titans) – won 'Purple Cap' (2nd Purple Cap)
- Manish Pandey – won 'Catch of the Season' | Mohammad Siraj (GT) – received 'Green Dot Ball'

News - 174

- Lionel Messi – awarded "2026 Princess of Asturias Award for Sports"
  - 1st individual footballer to receive the award since 1981
- He led Argentina to FIFA World Cup 2022 title
- Princess of Asturias Award – annually recognises distinguished contributions in Arts, Literature, Social Sciences, Scientific & Technical Research, International Cooperation, Concord, Communication, Humanities & Sports
- The recipients receive Joan Miró sculpture, diploma, badge & €50,000
- Previous Sports awardees – Rafael Nadal, Michael Schumacher, Serena Williams, Eliud Kipchoge

News - 175

- 22nd "Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026" – held in Hong Kong, China
- India – 2nd in overall medal standings with 19 medals (10 gold, 5 silver & 4 bronze) | 1st – China
- India was represented by – 48-member Indian squad (30 men & 18 women)
  - Selected by Athletics Federation of India based on performances at Junior Federation Cup in Tumakuru (Apr 2026)
- Notable silver medal winners include:
  - Nishchay Phogat – men's discus throw, junior national record
  - Women's 4×100m relay team of Kajal, Bhavana, Aarti & Nipam
- Men's 4×400m relay team of Piyush Raj, Sayed Sabeer, Ranjith Kumar S & Mohammed Ashfaq – bronze with a U20 national record
- Nipam – India's 1st medal-winner at championships, earning bronze in women's 100m in 11.62 seconds
- "World U20 Athletics Championships 2026" – to be held at Hayward Field, Eugene, Oregon, USA (Aug 5-9, 2026)
- 10 Gold medalists:

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Medal	Athlete (medal)	Event	Mark
Gold	Nitin Gupta	Men's 5000m race walk	19:47.49s
Gold	Amanat Kamboj	Women's discus throw	52.24m
Gold	Rahul Jakhar	Decathlon	7185 points
Gold	Pooja Singh	Women's high jump	1.93m
Gold	Nikhil Chandrashekar	Men's 3000m steeplechase	9:25.44s
Gold	Shahnavaz Khan	Men's long jump	7.84m
Gold	Basant	Men's high jump	2.20m
Gold	Muskan	Women's 5000m	16:53.08s
Gold	Mogali Venkatram	Men's 800m	1:48.27
Gold	Team India	Women's 4×400m relay	3.38.07s

News - 176

- India – retained strong presence in World Boxing Rankings
- Top-10 representation – in 9/10 women's weight categories & in 8/10 men's divisions
  - Overall: 3rd in top-10 athletes globally | 2nd in women's boxing worldwide
- Women:
  - Jaismine Lamboria (57kg) - World No.1
  - Minakshi Hooda (48kg) - World No.1
  - Priya Ghanghas (60kg) - among Top-3
  - Preeti (48kg) - World No.3
  - Arundhati Choudhary (70kg), Pooja Rani (80kg), Nupur (+80kg) - all World No.2
- Men:
  - Vishvanath Suresh (50kg) - Top-3
  - Jadumani Mandengbam (50kg) - 7th
  - Harsh Choudhary (90kg) - 10th
- The rankings are based on performances at – Olympic Games, World Boxing Cups & World Championships
- In World Boxing Cup Finals 2025, India won 9 golds, 2nd in overall medal tally behind Kazakhstan

News - 177

- R Praggnanandhaa – won "Norway Chess 2026" in 10th & final round at Deichman Bjorvika
  - Defeated – Vincent Keymer (Germany) | He became 1st Indian to win 'Norway Chess'
- 2nd – Wesley So | 3rd – Alireza Firouzja (France)

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- Bibisara Assaubayeva (Kazakhstan) – won "Norway Chess Women 2026" title
  - 2nd – Zhu Jiner (China) | 3rd – Anna Muzychuk (Ukraine)

News - 178

- Savitha Shri Baskar (IM, India) – won "Asian Women's Individual Chess Championship 2026" with 7.5/9
  - edging Afruza Khamdamova (Uzbekistan) on tie-break
- Bronze – Song Yuxin (China)
- Savitha – qualified for FIDE Women's World Cup 2027

News - 179

- India – topped medal tally at inaugural "World Yogasana Championship 2026", Ahmedabad, Gujarat
  - with 114 medals (102 gold, 9 silver, 3 bronze)
- 2nd – Japan (3 gold, 3 silver, 5 bronze) | 3rd – Argentina (2 gold, 3 silver)
- India contingent – 122 members across 6 age categories: sub-Junior (10-14), Junior (14-18), Senior (18-28), Senior A (28-35), Senior B (35-45), Senior C (45-55)
- Organisers – Yogasana Bharat, World Yogasana & Indian Olympic Association
- Disciplines – Traditional yogasana, Artistic single, Artistic pair, Artistic group, Rhythmic pair, & Specialised events
- Participants – 522 athletes from 79 countries

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News - 180

- India's women's football team ('Blue Tigresses') – won SAFF Women's Championship 2026 (defeating - Bangladesh)
  - at Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, Margao, Goa
- It is the 6th SAFF Women's Championship title for India (first since 2019) | Bangladesh had won 2022 & 2024 editions
- Top scorer – Aveka Singh (India) (4 goals) | Most Valuable Player – Sanfida Nongrum (India)
- Best Goalkeeper – Panthoi Chanu Elangbam (India) | Fair Play award – Nepal team
- HQs of SAFF – Dhaka, Bangladesh | President – Kazi Md. Salahuddin

News - 181

- Winners of French Open 2026:

Category	Winners	Runner up
Women's Singles	Mirra Andreeva (Russia)	Maja Chwalinska (Poland)
Men's Singles	Alexander Zverev (Germany)	Flavio Cobolli (Italy)
Women's Doubles	Katerina Siniakova and Taylor Townsend	Anna Danilina and Aleksandra Krunic
Men's Doubles	Marcel Granollers and Horacio Zeballos	Harri Heliovaara and Henry Patten
Mixed Doubles	Sara Errani and Andrea Vavassori	Gabriela Dabrowski and Evan King

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- Mirra Andreeva – became the youngest player to win French Open women's singles title (since Monica Seles in 1992)
- Rafael Nadal (14) – holds the record for most French Open titles
- French Open is officially called 'Roland Garros' | It is the only Grand Slam played on a 'Clay' surface

News - 182

- SAI + Uni. of Tsukuba (Japan) = 3-year MoU for cooperation in sports education, sports science & athlete development
- It builds on India-Japan sports cooperation framework signed in 2016 & renews 2018 SAI-UT MoU
- Partnership prioritises – athletics, archery, table tennis, swimming & judo
  - aligned with India's preparations for '2030 Commonwealth Games' & '2036 Olympic Games'
- HQs of SAI – New Delhi | DG – Sujata Chaturvedi | Established in – 1984

News - 183

- "Ulaanbaatar Open 2026" wrestling tournament – held in Mongolia
- India – finished with 17 medals (8 gold & 9 bronze)
  - Across men's freestyle, women's wrestling & Greco-Roman categories
- India's gold medal winners:
  - Men's freestyle category: Deepak (61kg), Sagar Jaglan (74kg) & Dinesh Dhankhar (125kg)
  - Women's freestyle category: Manisha Bhanwala (57kg), Neha Sangwan (59kg) & Kajal Dhochak (76kg)
  - Greco-Roman category: Sunil Kumar (87kg) & Nitesh Kumar (97kg)
- India's bronze medal winners:
  - Men's freestyle category: Sumit (57kg), Mohit Kumar (65kg), Jaideep (74kg) & Vicky (97kg)
  - Women's freestyle category: Neelam (50kg), Hansika Lamba (55kg), Mansi Ahlawat (62kg) & Priya Malik (76kg)
  - Greco-Roman category: Sahil (60kg)
- Ulaanbaatar Open – 3rd UWW Ranking Series event of season

News - 184

- "New Taipei City Athletics Open 2026", a World Athletics Continental Tour Silver-level event – held at Banqiao Stadium, Chinese Taipei (Jun 6-7, 2026)
- India – finished with 4 medals (2 gold & 2 silver)
- Shaili Singh – women's long jump gold (6.24m) | 2nd – Vietnam's Tran Thi Loan (6.23m) | 3rd – Australia's Zoe Chester
- Shaili's season-best – 6.58m (Federation Cup, May 2026)
  - Her personal best & U20 Indian national record – 6.76m (2023)
- SS Sneha, Srabani Nanda, Sudeshna Shivankar & Tamanna – clocked 44.07 seconds to win gold medal
- Tejas Shirse (holds Indian national record in men's 110m hurdles at 13.41 seconds) – silver with a time of 13.50 seconds
- Animesh Kujur – secured India's 4th medal with a 2nd silver at meet

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News - 185

- Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (Bihar) – became youngest player selected for Indian men's cricket team at 15 years & 71 days
  - Previous record was held by – Sachin Tendulkar (debut in 1989 against Pakistan at 16 years & 205 days)
- He was selected for India's T20 squad for tours of Ireland & England, as well as Asian Games 2026
- In IPL 2026 season, with Rajasthan Royals, he won 5 individual awards:
  - Orange Cap (776 runs in 16 matches) | Most Valuable Player | Emerging Player of the Season
  - Super Striker | Super Sixes (72 sixes, breaking Chris Gayle's IPL record of 59 in a single season set in 2011)
- He was youngest player to be signed at an IPL auction (age 13, for ₹1.10 Cr, IPL 2025) & youngest player to score a century in IPL history
- Washington Sundar – currently holds record for youngest Indian to play a T20 International match (18 years & 80 days)

News - 186

- 6th "Men's Hockey U18 Asia Cup 2026" – held in Kakamigahara, Japan
- India – won in Gold Medal match to clinch title for 3rd time in 6 editions & their 1st title in 10 years | Defeated – Japan
- Ashish Tani Purti – scored a hat-trick | Ketan Kushwaha (captain) – added India's 4th goal in 30th minute
  - Numada Gaku – scored Japan's lone goal
- 'Player of the Match' – Ashish Tani Purti | He finished as tournament's 'Top Scorer' with 13 goals
- 'Best Goalkeeper of the Tournament' – Ayush Rajak (goalkeeper)
- India's campaign included group-stage victories over Kazakhstan (13-0), Republic of Korea (4-1) & Chinese Taipei (13-1)
- Team is coached by – Sardara Singh (former Indian captain)
- Indian U18 Women's Hockey Team (captained by Sweety Kujur & coached by Rani Rampal) – won Bronze Medal match
  - Defeated – South Korea
- 'Player of the Match' – Sandeepa Kumari | 'Women's Tournament Top Scorer' – Nausheen Naz
- Hockey India announced cash awards for:
  - Men's gold-winning squad – ₹3 lakh per player & ₹1.5 lakh per support staff member
  - Women's bronze-winning team – ₹1 lakh per player & ₹50,000 per support staff member
- Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya (Sports Min.) – presented a cheque of ₹61.5 lakh to men's team & ₹21 lakh to women's team

News - 187

- Srishti Kiran (Bengaluru) – became world's No 1 in Under-13 category in International Tennis Federation (ITF) Junior World Rankings
  - After winning 5 straight ITF junior titles & finishing runner-up at 'ITF World Tennis Tour Juniors J100 Guatemala'
- She climbed to a career-high ITF junior ranking of No. 357, highest among Under-13 players globally

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News - 188

- Opening match of "2026 FIFA World Cup" – held at Mexico City Stadium (Estadio Azteca), Mexico City (Jun 11, 2026)
- Mexico (coach - Javier Aguirre) – won its 1st opening game in 8th attempt | Defeated – South Africa
- Opening match is a rematch of 2010 World Cup opener between same two teams at Johannesburg
  - It marks 1st time in FIFA World Cup history that an opening game matchup has been repeated
- Estadio Azteca (in Mexico) – became 1st stadium in world to host 3 FIFA World Cups (1970, 1986 & 2026)
- 2026 FIFA World Cup – jointly hosted by US, Canada & Mexico
  - It is 1st edition to feature 48 national teams, with 104 total matches (from 64), running from Jun 11 to Jul 20, 2026

News - 189

- Wanda Diamond League's Bauhaus-Galan meeting (5th stop of 2026 season) – at Stockholm Olympic Stadium, Stockholm
- In men's pole vault: Kurtis Marschall (Australia) – defeated Armand 'Mondo' Duplantis (Sweden)
  - Marschall cleared 5.90m on his final attempt to secure his 1st ever Diamond League victory
- Duplantis – set current world record of 6.31m on Mar 12, 2026, at Mondo Classic meet in Uppsala

News - 190

- "2026 Archery World Cup Stage-3" tournament – held in Antalya, Turkey
- Bommadevara Dhiraj (Indian archer) – won 2 gold medals
- He clinched his 1st individual Archery World Cup gold medal in men's recurve category
  - Defeated – Lee Woo Seok (South Korea)
- He also secured a gold medal in recurve mixed team event along with Kumkum Mohod
  - Defeated – Kim Je-deok & Oh Yejin (South Korea)
- Dhiraj – 3rd Indian man to win World Cup recurve gold (after Jayanta Talukdar & Atanu Das)
- Dhiraj & Kumkum – 3rd Indian recurve mixed team pair to clinch top honours at event
  - After Atanu Das/Deepka Kumari (2021) & Tarundeep Rai/Ridhi Phor in 2022

News - 191

- Kane Williamson (New Zealand) – announced his retirement from international cricket
  - He has played 110 Tests, scoring 9,515 runs at an average of 54.1 with a highest score of 251
- He made his Test debut against India in 2010
- Captaining in all 3 formats, Williamson led New Zealand to finals of 2019 World Cup & 2021 T20 World Cup

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News - 192

- TIME magazine's "100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026" list – released in June 2026
- Smriti Mandhana (Indian women's cricket vice-captain) – only Indian on list
- Temba Bavuma (South African cricket captain) – only other cricketer on list
- She is: 1st Indian woman to score a double century in a domestic one-day match
  - 1st to score a century in all three international formats
  - Joint holder (with 17) of most international women's cricket centuries
- She set record for most international runs across formats by a woman in 2024 & surpassed her own record in 2025
- She is currently representing India in – Women's T20 World Cup 2026 in England & Wales

News - 193

- Lionel Messi (Argentina) – scored a hat-trick against Algeria as Argentina opened 2026 FIFA World Cup with a 3-0 win
  - He matched Miroslav Klose's all-time mark of 16 World Cup goals
- This hat trick was 11th of Messi's international career but 1st at World Cup
- At 38, he became oldest player to score 3 goals in a game at tournament
- This match with Algeria was Lionel Messi's 200th with national team
- He also became 1st player to feature in 6 World Cups
- He broke record of 5 World Cups held by Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal); Antonio Carbajal, Andrés Guardado & Rafael Márquez (Mexico)

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News - 194

- AIFF launched inaugural edition of "AIFF U-17 Women's Youth League" – to kick off on Jul 18, 2026 (till Jul 29, 2026)
  - At – RKM Football Academy in Narainpur, Chhattisgarh
  - It is India's 1st structured national club football league for Under-17 women
- It features 16 clubs from across India, divided into 4 groups of 4 teams
- RKM Football Academy in Narainpur – previously hosted Rajmata Jijabai Trophy
- HQs of AIFF – New Delhi | President – Kalyan Chaubey | Established in – 1937

News - 195

- In 'FIFA World Cup 2026', Mexico became 1st country to qualify for knockout Round of 32 at Guadalajara Stadium, Mexico
  - Defeated – South Korea
- Top two teams from each group move on to knockout stage, along with best eight third-place teams
- A round of 32 is being played for 1st time at World Cup after it was expanded to 48 teams (16 more than Qatar 2022)
  - 48 teams are divided into 12 groups of 4
- Canada, Mexico & USA – hosting 2026 edition across 16 cities

Join us

News - 196

- 'Women's Under-19 One-Day Trophy' – organised by Bihar Cricket Association (BCA) in Bhagalpur
- Akshara Gupta (captain of Under-19 women's team) – scored an unbeaten 306 runs off just 126 balls
  - In her innings, she smashed 55 boundaries & 8 sixes
  - Her innings established a new record in BCA women's cricket
- In domestic cricket, this is one of biggest innings in women's cricket, 2nd only to Ira Gupta (Mumbai)
- She also became 1st woman cricketer from Bihar to play tournaments in all 4 age groups of BCCI in a single season
  - Under-15, Under-19, Under-23 & Senior Women's Team

News - 197

- Dr Saibal Chattopadhyay – appointed as Chairman of National Statistical Commission (NSC)
- Prof. Shubhabrata Das, Satyendra Bahadur Singh & Dr Madhavan Mukund – appointed as members of NSC
- NSC – set up in 2005 to serve as a nodal body for all core statistical activities of India
  - It consists of a part-time Chairperson, 4 part-time Members | An ex-officio Member – CEO, NITI Aayog
  - Secretary of Ministry of Statistics and Program Implementation (MoSPI) – Secretary to NSC
- HQs of NSC – New Delhi | Chairperson – Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay | Established in – 2005

News - 198

- Union constituted 'Search-cum-Selection Committee' for National Sports Board (NSB) to initiate process of selecting Chairperson & 2 Members of NSB
  - Under 'National Sports Board (Search-cum-Selection Committee) Rules, 2026'
  - As notified under 'National Sports Governance (NSG) Act, 2025'
- 5-member committee is chaired by – Dr. T.V. Somanathan (Cabinet Secretary)
- It is tasked to recommend a panel of candidates for posts of Chairperson & 2 Members of NSB
- NSG Act, 2025 – passed by Rajya Sabha on Aug 12, 2025

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News - 199

- "Doha Diamond League 2026" – held at Suhaim bin Hamad Stadium in Qatar
- Neeraj Chopra – finished 4th in men's javelin throw competition with a best throw of 85.69m
  - He breached 82.61m qualifying distance set by Athletics Federation of India (AFI) for 2026 Commonwealth Games
- 1st – Rumesh Tharanga (Sri Lanka-88.68m) | 2nd – Anderson Peters (Grenada-86.38m) | 3rd – Curtis Thompson (US-85.99m)
- It was Tharanga's 2nd Diamond League win this month (after 92.62m throw at Rome Diamond League)
- Neeraj Chopra – won Doha Diamond League in 2023 & finished 2nd in both 2024 & 2025
- In 2025, Neeraj produced a national record throw of 90.23m in Doha to finally breach coveted 90m barrier

Join us

News - 200

- 2nd edition of "Asian Relays Championships 2026" – held in Shangyu, China
- Indian women's 4x100m team – won gold medal by clocking 43.85 seconds
  - Indian team – Srabani Nanda, Sneha Shanuvalli, Sudeshna Shivankar & Tamanna
- Silver medal – China (44.09s) | Bronze medal – Thailand (44.11s)
- Tamanna & Sneha Shanuvalli – finished with 2 medals each
  - They helped India clinch bronze in mixed 4x100m event (alongside Animesh Kujur & Pranav Gurav)
- India's overall tally – 3 (1 gold, 1 silver & 1 bronze)
- India will host 'Asian Relays Championships 2027', 3rd edition of championship in Chandigarh

News - 201

- "FIH Women's Nations Cup 2025-26" – held at North Harbour National Hockey Centre in Auckland, New Zealand
- Indian women hockey team – won its 2nd FIH Nations Cup title | Defeated – New Zealand
  - India's 1st FIH Nations Cup title – in 2022
- 'Player of the Match' award – Lalremsiami Hmarzote | 'Player of the Tournament' award – Ashley Sessa
- Joint-top scorer in tournament – Deepika (shared with USA's Ashley Sessa)
- 'Goalkeeper of the Tournament' – Grace O'Hanlon (New Zealand)
- 'Young Player of the Tournament' award – Riana Pho (New Zealand)

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News - 202

- Inaugural "Indian Athletics Awards 2025" – honours various athletes
- Indian Athletics Awards 2025 Winners:
  - Best Male Athlete of the Year: Neeraj Chopra
  - Best Female Athlete of the Year: Parul Chaudhary (a national record-holder in 3000 m steeplechase)
  - Best Emerging Male Athlete of the Year: Shahnavaz Khan
  - Best Emerging Female Athlete of the Year: Pooja Singh
  - Best Coach of the Year: Parveer Singh
  - Lifetime Achievement Award: PT Usha, Gurbachan Singh Randhawa, Bahadur Singh Chauhan, Anju Bobby George
  - Best State Association of the Year: Tamil Nadu Athletics Association
  - Best State Supporting Athletics: State Government of Odisha
  - Best Technical Official of the Year: Dr Kuldeep Singh
  - Best Sponsor: Reliance Foundation

Join us

News - 203

- Cristiano Ronaldo – became 1st player to score in 6 different World Cup tournaments
  - After scoring a goal against Uzbekistan
- Ronaldo & Lionel Messi – became only men in history to play in 6 World Cup tournaments this year
- Rolando – became 1st player to score in 6 different World Cups (2006, 2010, 2014, 2018, 2022 & 2026)
- He is also now 2nd-oldest scorer in World Cup history (41 years, 138 days)
  - 1st – Roger Milla in 1994 for Cameroon against Russia (42 years, 39 days)
- Ronaldo now has 10 goals in World Cups & Messi has 18 goals
  - With 10 goals, Ronaldo surpassed Eusebio's record of 9 & became Portugal's all-time leading scorer in World Cup
- Rolando's match against Uzbekistan was 230th of his career (most in history)

News - 204

- FIE + FAI = an MoU to strengthen cooperation & support continued growth & promotion of fencing in India in lead-up to "Los Angeles 2028 Olympic Games"
- HQs of FIE – Lausanne, Switzerland | Interim President – Abdelmoneim ElHusseiny | Secretary General ad interim – Gulnora Saidova | Established in – 1913
- HQs of FAI – Delhi | President – Satej Dynandeo Patil | Secretary General – Rajeev Mehta | Established in – 1974

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Persons in News

News - 205

- PM Modi completes 4,399 consecutive days in office to become India's longest continuously serving democratically elected PM (on Jun 10, 2026)
  - Previous record – held by India's 1st PM Jawaharlal Nehru (4,398 continuous days)
- He was first sworn in as PM on May 26, 2014 & has since secured 3 consecutive Lok Sabha election victories
- Nehru remains India's longest-serving PM in terms of total years – 17 years
- On Mar 22, 2026, Modi also became India's longest-serving elected head of government overall
  - Combining his tenure as CM of Gujarat & as PM to cross 8,931 days
  - Previous record – Pawan Kumar Chamling (8,930 days as CM of Sikkim)
- Modi – the 1st leader since Nehru to win 3 consecutive Lok Sabha elections as an incumbent PM

Join us

News - 206

- Elon Musk – became the world's 1st trillionaire after his company, SpaceX, raised more than $75 billion through IPO
  - It listed on the Nasdaq Stock Exchange, New York, US
- IPO pushed the valuation of SpaceX to ~$2 trillion, placing it among 10 most valuable publicly traded companies in US
- Current Rankings by fortune:
  - Elon Musk ($1.1 trillion) | Larry Page ($292.7 billion) | Sergey Brin ($270 bn) | Jeff Bezos ($251.5 bn) | Larry Ellison ($230.1 bn)

Science & Technology

News - 207

- Scientists from PRL (Ahmedabad) – reported detection of possible subsurface ice deposits beneath 4 'doubly shadowed craters' in lunar South Polar Region
  - Using data from Dual Frequency Synthetic Aperture Radar (DFSAR) aboard Chandrayaan-2 orbiter
- DFSAR (operating in L- & S-band microwave frequencies) – 1st fully polarimetric Synthetic Aperture Radar instrument deployed to study Moon
- Chandrayaan-2 orbiter (launched on Jul 22, 2019) – carries 8 scientific payloads & continues operational data collection

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News - 208

- DRDO – successfully tested high-calibre bomb at Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (TBRL), Ramgarh, Panchkula, Haryana
- Test – conducted under IAF supervision with comprehensive security arrangements
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Samir V. Kamat | Established in – 1958

News - 209

- Dr Jitendra Singh – inaugurated India's 1st "SkyCast System" at IGI Airport, New Delhi
  - making India 19th country with integrated atmospheric remote sensing for aviation weather
- 2nd facility – planned at Jewar Airport, UP
- SkyCast System (under Mission Mausam) – integrates Radar Wind Profiler, SODAR, Microwave Radiometer, GFAS & CL61 Lidar Ceilometer for real-time atmospheric intelligence & advanced 3-hour alerts for aircrew
- Scientific foundation of SkyCast comes from the Winter Fog Experiment (WiFEX) – by IITM & IMD (under MoES)
- Mission Mausam – implemented by IMD, IITM & National Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasting
  - supported by INCOIS, NCPOR & NIOT
- Mission will be executed in 2 phases over 5 years: Phase-1 (2025 - March 2026) & Phase-2 (2026 onwards)

Join us

News - 210

- Hoverit – conducted operational demonstration of tactical loitering munition "Divyastra Mk-1" in Jodhpur, Rajasthan
- Divyastra Mk-1: indigenous tactical UAV for intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance & precision strike missions
- Specifications: flight endurance up to 5 hours, operational range 500 km, attack speed 300–400 km/h, payload 15 kg
- HQs of HoverIt – Lucknow, UP | Co-Founders – Saurav Singh, Ravinder Pal Singh, Pawan Pandey | founded in – 2022

News - 211

- DRDO + IAF = successfully flight-tested "RudraM-II" Air-to-Surface Missile from airborne platform at ITR, Chandipur
  - It is indigenously developed by – RIC, Hyderabad (in collaboration with DRDL, HEMRL, ARDE & ITR)
- Development is supported by DcPPs, HAL, Regional Centre for Military Airworthiness, Missile System Quality Assurance Agency & other industry partners
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh | Established in – 1958
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor

News - 212

- Microsoft – unveiled "Majorana 2", next-generation topological quantum chip
- Microsoft now expects to achieve a scalable quantum computer by 2029, halving original timeline
- Microsoft's approach to quantum computing relies on quasiparticles known as 'Majoranas'
  - Majorana 1 was introduced in 2025
- HQs of Microsoft – Washington, US | Chairman & CEO – Satya Nadella | Founded in – 1975

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News - 213

- HUL – inaugurated "Unilever Fragrance Hub" on campus of IIT Bombay, Mumbai
- It marks 3rd global centre under Unilever's €100 million investment programme
  - Other two hubs – located in United Kingdom & United States
- HQs of HUL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Priya Nair | Chairman – Nitin Paranjpe

News - 214

- Chandigarh University + Intel India = inaugurated "IndiaAI Data Lab" to improve employability of students
  - becoming India's 1st Private University to do so
- CU's University Institute of Computing (UIC) also launched MCA (Data Science) & BCA (Data Science) programs
  - In association with – Intel India
- CU also conducted Summer School Program – 'AI for Future Workforce' in collaboration with Intel India
- HQs of Intel – California, US | Chairman – Dr Craig H Barratt | CEO – Lip-Bu Tan | Funded in – 1968

Join us

News - 215

- G. Kishan Reddy & Yvette Cooper (UK) = launched "India-UK Critical Minerals Global Supply Chain Observatory (GSCO)"
- It is a joint initiative of – TEXMiN (TTRP), at IIT ISM Dhanbad, Jharkhand & University of Cambridge
- Aim: To create a data-driven platform for monitoring & analysing global critical mineral supply chains
- Minister of Coal & Mines: G. Kishan Reddy | Constituency – Secunderabad, Telangana
  MoS in Ministry of Coal & Mines: Satish Chandra Dubey

News - 216

- India joined "Project Glasswing", a cyber defence initiative of Anthropic
  - To use Claude Mythos AI model to find security vulnerabilities
- Other countries granting access to Mythos – Canada, Australia, New Zealand, France, Germany, Italy, Switzerland, Netherlands, Spain, Belgium, Sweden, Japan & South Korea
- NATO has also been given access, along with European Union Agency for Cybersecurity (ENISA)
- HQs of Anthropic – San Francisco, California, US | Co-founder & CEO – Dario Amodei

News - 217

- T-Hub (Hyderabad) – launched 3rd cohort of "ORBIT", spacetech accelerator programme under AIC T-Hub Foundation inducting 13 startups
  - Sanyark Space Technologies, Trishul Space, Kessler Dynamics, Velotrax, Zoove Space, Space OS, Humanity Space, Landlens, STAR Labs, Red Balloon Aerospace, Astro Voltaics, Orbit Grid & Nibiaa Devices
- With latest cohort, ORBIT supported 36 startups across 3 cohorts
- As per T-Hub, startups from previous ORBIT cohorts have collectively secured ~Rs 30 Cr in funding
- Among startups from earlier cohorts, Nalwa Aero became 1st Indian company to receive DGCA Design Organisation Approval for a five-seater eVTOL aircraft

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News - 218

- OpenAI's ChatGPT – crossed 1 billion global MAUs in May 2026, ~3 years after launch on Nov 30, 2022
- It becomes the fastest app in history to reach milestone, surpassing Google Maps, TikTok, Instagram & YouTube
- Q2 2026 – Anthropic Claude – 56 million global MAUs | YoY growth: Claude ~640% Vs ChatGPT's 62%
- HQs of OpenAI – San Francisco, USA | Chairman – Bret Taylor | CEO – Sam Altman | Established in – 2015
- HQs of Anthropic – San Francisco, USA | CEO – Dario Amodei | President – Daniela Amodei | Established in – 2021

News - 219

- NeGD (Ministry of Electronics & IT) – empanelled 6 companies for AI/ML services & skilled personnel across Central Ministries, government departments, State governments, PSUs & affiliated organisations for 2 years

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- Empanelled firms – TCS, NEC Corporation India, Kyndryl Solutions Pvt Ltd, Innefu Labs Ltd, CoRover Pvt Ltd (developer of BharatGPT, India's multilingual conversational AI), Cactus Technology Solutions Pvt Ltd
- Selection – from competitive bidding with 80+ participants including Deloitte, EY, PwC, KPMG, Fractal Analytics & Gnani AI (not shortlisted)
- NeGD – technology arm of MeitY, operating key Digital India platforms including UMANG & DigiLocker

News - 220

- India's space economy – currently valued at close to $9 billion | To expand to ~$45 billion over next 7-8 years
- IN-SPACe – established as a single-window interface between private industry & government agencies
- India's space budget – reached ₹13,705.63 crore in 2026-27 (from ₹5,615 Cr in 2013-14)
- India's upcoming major space missions include – Gaganyaan (crewed mission), Chandrayaan-4 (2027), Shukrayaan (2028) & Indian Space Station (2030)
- India became 1st country to land near Moon's south pole with successful landing of Chandrayaan-3's Vikram lander on Aug 23, 2023

News - 221

- NASA announced 4-member prime crew & backup for its "Artemis III" mission, targeted for launch no earlier than 2027
- Prime crew comprises – Commander Randy Bresnik (NASA), Pilot Luca Parmitano (ESA, Italy) and Mission Specialists Frank Rubio (NASA) & Andre Douglas (NASA)
  - Bob Hines – backup crew member
- Artemis III – a 2-week low Earth orbit (LEO) test mission (not a lunar landing)
- Artemis IV – 1st planned crewed mission to lunar South Pole, scheduled for 2028
- Artemis programme – began with uncrewed Artemis I mission in Nov 2022
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958

News - 222

- Anthropic – unveiled its "Fable 5", 1st from Mythos class & most advanced lineup of AI technology
  - To general public while restricting it from use in sensitive areas
- Launch of Fable 5 comes with a steep price tag – $10 per million input tokens & $50 per million output tokens
- HQs of Anthropic – San Francisco, California, US | Co-founder & CEO – Dario Amodei

News - 223

- India conducted 3 consecutive flight tests to demonstrate its multi-layered ballistic missile defence system capability
- DRDO tested 2 advanced interceptor missiles designed for Intermediate-Range Ballistic Missile (IRBM) defence
  - From – Integrated Test Range in Chandipur

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- A maiden flight-test of Naval Anti-Ship Missile-Medium Range (NASM-MR) was also carried out
- BMD system – an advanced network of radars, command centers & interceptor missiles
  - Endo-atmospheric missiles – that operate within Earth's atmosphere, which covers an altitude below 100 km
  - Exo-atmospheric missiles – capable of completing missions in uppermost region of Earth's atmosphere
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 224

- IN-SPACe selected 3 of India's space startups as 1st set of non-governmental entities (NGEs) for funding under its 'Technology Adoption Fund' scheme
  - Astrobase Space Technologies, SatSure Analytics India (Bengaluru) & TM2SPACE Technologies (Hyderabad)
- Astrobase – to develop a high-thrust closed-cycle liquid rocket engine for space launch vehicles
- SatSure – to build a large Earth observation model (LOM)
- TM2SPACE –to develop an indigenous AI-powered star tracker system for satellites
- Technology Adoption Fund – designed to promote innovation & drive commercialization of cutting-edge technologies in space sector | Total funding – Rs 500 Cr
  - Funding would be up to 60% for Startups/MSME & 40% for large industry of project cost
  - Maximum funding that can be offered to NGE for a project – capped at Rs 25 Cr
- HQs of IN-SPACe – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Dr. Pawan Goenka | Works under – Department of Space

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News - 225

- EY Global Delivery Services – launched "ey.ai Center for Reimagination" (CFR) at EY GDS, Bengaluru
- HQs of EY – London, England, UK | Global Chair & CEO – Janet Truncale | Established in – 1989

News - 226

- TCS + Anthropic = partnered to expand enterprise AI adoption at scale
- TCS – to establish a dedicated Business Unit (BU) to deliver joint industry solutions & enhanced customer value
- Anthropic – co-founded in 2021 by Dario Amodei, Daniela Amodei & other former OpenAI researchers
  - It is backed by – Google, Amazon & other major investors
- TCS generated consolidated revenues of over $30 billion in FY26
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968
- HQs of Anthropic – San Francisco, California, US | Co-founder & CEO – Dario Amodei

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News - 227

- Avataar – launched "Varya", a distilled video model to make frontier video AI affordable, accessible & relevant
- It can generate video at Rs 0.48 per second, making it up to 10x more cost-efficient than several leading global video models
- Avataar – to publish a technical report outlining Varya's model architecture, distillation methodology & benchmarks
- HQs of Avataar – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Sravanth Aluru | Co-Founder – Gaurav Baid | Established in – 2014

News - 228

- Sarvam AI – announced 1st close of its Series B funding round on Jun 15, 2026, raising $234 million
  - At a post-money valuation of $1.5 billion, making it India's 2nd 'AI' unicorn after Krutrim & overall 5th unicorn of 2026
- Total Series B target – $300 million | This round is led by – HCLTech | Bessemer Venture Partners – co-led this round
- Sarvam AI – also been selected under 'IndiaAI Mission' to build India's foundational AI models
- HQs of Sarvam AI – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-Founders – Pratyush Kumar & Vivek Raghavan

News - 229

- ISRO, in collab with DAE – developing an advanced artificial heating system for future lunar landers
  - that can operate for up to 200 Earth days on surface of Moon
  - It can survive & perform experiments for nearly 7 lunar days
- It will have artificial heaters that can survive harsh lunar nights when temperatures can plummet to -129°C on Moon
  - Currently, a lander can work on Moon for only about 14 Earth days (one lunar day)
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

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News - 230

- Drogo Aerospace (Hyderabad) – delivered 1st batch of 41 'JK 250e' drones to Indian Army under a Rs 72 Cr contract
  - Received by – Indian Army's Southern Command in Nasik, Maharashtra
- Drogo Aerospace aims to complete balance deliveries by August 2026
- Drogo Aerospace – setting up a drone manufacturing facility in Maheshwaram, Ranga Reddy district
  - Telangana govt allotted around 4.5 acres in Electronics Manufacturing Cluster to company for the project
- HQs of Drogo Aerospace – Hyderabad, Telangana | Founder & CEO – Yashwanth Bonthu | Established in – 2021

News - 231

- CSIR transferred 7 technologies to industry during an event jointly organised by CSIR-NPL & CSIR-CRRI
- CSIR also released 10 Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas covering 8 phytochemicals, 1 precious metal & 1 propane gas
- CSIR also handed over 5 vapour cells, developed by CSIR-NPL, to Solid-State Physics Laboratory (DRDO)

Join us

Technologies Transferred:

CSIR-NPL

1. Rydberg Systems Based Broad Band E-Field Sensing Technology to M/s Nostradamus Technologies Private Limited, Hyderabad, Telangana.
2. High-Volume $PM_{2.5}$ Impactor Sampler Technology to M/s Engineering and Environmental Solutions Private Limited, Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh.
3. Environment Friendly and Scalable Process for Recycling of Pharmaceutical Blisters (PBs) and Allied Packaging Wastes to M/s GM Industries, New Delhi.

CSIR-CRRI

1. VInSD-VAIU: Drone-Based NDT System for Bridges to M/s Dronix Technologies Private Limited (Aero360), Chennai, Tamil Nadu.
2. PAVE-SEAL: Air-Cleaning Nano Photocatalytic Pave Sealing Emulsion to M/s Ashita Renewables, Muzaffarnagar, Uttar Pradesh.
3. PATCHFILL: Pothole Repair Machine to M/s Petrochem Specialties, Muzaffarnagar, Uttar Pradesh.
4. CLARIVISOR: Glare Mitigation Device to M/s Intelligent Diagnosis LLP, Gurugram, Haryana.

Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas Released:

1. Phytochemicals BND
2. Precious Metals BND
3. Propane Gas BND

News - 232

- Indian Space Industry E-Catalogue – launched at 5th 'India Space Congress 2026', held in New Delhi (Jun 15-17, 2026)
  - It is India's 1st comprehensive digital repository of space-sector capabilities
- Developed by – Satcom Industry Association (SIA)-India
- SIA-India – also released 2 strategic reports on emerging opportunities in global space economy
  - 'Building India's On-Orbit Servicing and Refuelling Ecosystem: Policy, Partnerships and Pathways Forward' – developed in partnership with OrbitAID
  - 'India's Strategic Opportunity in Space-Based Compute Infrastructure' – developed in collab with TakeMe2Space
- India's space ecosystem comprises over 400 registered startups, with cumulative investment exceeding $500 million
- HQs of SIA-India – New Delhi | President – Dr Subba Rao Pavuluri | DG – Anil Prakash

News - 233

- Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre (IIT Madras) – released "ANCHOR" at 3rd 'BRICS Neuroscience Symposium 2026'
  - Symposium was held from Jun 5-7, 2026, at IIT Madras campus, Chennai
  - It is world's most detailed 3D atlas of human brainstem at cell resolution
  - ANCHOR – Atlas of Neurochemical Characterisation of the Human Brainstem with 3D Reconstruction
- SGBC previously released 'DHARANI' in 2024 (world's most detailed 3D atlas of human fetal brain)

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News - 234

- C-DOT + IIT Hyderabad = an MoU to establish a Centre of Excellence in Advanced Communication Technologies at IIT Hyderabad campus
- This is 4th CoE established by C-DOT at an IIT, following similar CoEs at IIT Kanpur, IIT Gandhinagar & IIT Roorkee
- HQs of C-DoT – New Delhi | CEO – Rajkumar Upadhyay | C-DoT works under – DoT (Ministry of Communications)
- Director of IIT Hyderabad – Prof. Budaraju Srinivasa Murty

News - 235

- DAE inaugurated world's 1st Hydrogen Production Facility based on Copper-Chlorine (Cu-Cl) Thermochemical Cycle
  - It utilises nuclear process heat from Fast Breeder Test Reactor (FBTR) at Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu
- Inaugurated by – Dr. Ajit Kumar Mohanty, Secretary, DAE & Chairman of Atomic Energy Commission (AEC)
- Cu-Cl thermochemical process – developed indigenously by Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), Mumbai
  - It was jointly designed, fabricated, installed & commissioned by BARC & IGCAR
- FBTR is aligned with India's National Green Hydrogen Mission, Nuclear Energy Mission & Viksit Bharat 2047 vision
- IGCAR – established in 1971 & is nodal national research centre for India's 2nd stage nuclear power programme

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Appointments & Resignations

News - 236

- VAdm Ajay Kochhar – assumed charge as 48th Vice Chief of Naval Staff (succeeding - VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan)
- His awards: Nau Sena Medal, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (2022) & Param Vishisht Seva Medal (2026)
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 237

- Rajesh Kumar Singh (Defence Secretary) – assigned additional charge of Secretary (Department of Defence Research & Development) & Chairman (DRDO), w.e.f. May 31, 2026
  - Succeeding – Dr. Samir V. Kamat
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh | Established in – 1958

News - 238

- VAdm Vineet McCarty – assumed charge as 20th Commander-in-Chief of Andaman & Nicobar Command (ANC)
- He has been awarded – Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM)
- ANC – India's only integrated tri-service operational command, comprising personnel from Army, Navy, IAF & ICG

Join us

News - 239

- Major General Rachel Thomas – appointed as Additional Director General (ADG), Military Nursing Service (MNS)
  - Succeeding – Major General Lissamma PV
- Major General Lissamma PV – conferred 'National Florence Nightingale Award' for 2026 by President Droupadi Murmu
  - At Rashtrapati Bhavan
- Military Nursing Service – an integral component of Armed Forces Medical Services

News - 240

- Janez Janša (Slovenian Democratic Party) – appointed as Prime Minister of Slovenia for 4th term
  - Succeeding – Robert Golob (Freedom Movement)
- Slovenia – Ljubljana – Euro | PM – Janez Janša | President – Nataša Pirc Musar

News - 241

- Khalilur Rahman (Bangladesh) – elected as President of 81st UNGA with 99/190 votes (defeating - Andreas S. Kakouris)
- Term – 1-year starting from Sep 2026 | He succeeds – Annalena Baerbock, Germany
- UNGA presidency – allocated to Asia-Pacific Group as per regional rotation
- Bangladesh – last held UNGA presidency in 41st session (1986-87)
- HQs of UNGA – New York, US | 80th Session's President – Annalena Baerbock (Germany) | Members – 193

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News - 242

- Lokhande Prashant Sitaram – appointed as Chairperson of CBSE (succeeding - Rahul Singh)
- Varun Bhardwaj – appointed as Secretary in CBSE (succeeding - Himanshu Gupta)
- HQs of CBSE – New Delhi | Chairman – Lokhande Prashant Sitaram | Established in – 1962

News - 243

- D. K. Shivakumar (Congress) – sworn in as 25th CM of Karnataka on Jun 3, 2026, in a ceremony at Lok Bhavan, Bengaluru
  - Oath was administered by – Thawar Chand Gehlot (Governor) | Succeeding – Siddaramaiah
- G. Parameshwara – sworn in as Deputy CM of Karnataka
- Shivakumar – previously served as 9th Deputy CM of Karnataka from May 20, 2023 to Jun 3, 2026
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 244

- Mette Frederiksen (Social Democratic) – sworn in as Prime Minister of Denmark for 3rd consecutive term
- New coalition – Social Democrats, Social Liberals, Left Greens & centrist Moderates
- Frederiksen – 2nd woman PM of Denmark (after Helle Thorning-Schmidt) | She is youngest person ever to hold the office
- Denmark – Copenhagen – Danish krone | PM – Mette Frederiksen

Join us

News - 245

- Vipul – appointed as India's Ambassador to Saudi Arabia
- Previously – serving as India's Ambassador to Qatar since August 2023
- Other roles – Joint Secretary, MEA (2014-2017); CGI, Dubai (2017-2020); Joint Secretary (Gulf), MEA (2020-2023)
- Saudi Arabia – Riyadh – Saudi Riyal | PM – Mohammed bin Salman Al Saud | King – Salman bin Abdulaziz

News - 246

- Kona Srikar Bharat – announced his retirement from international cricket
- He made his debut against Australia in Nagpur in Feb 2023 & his last Test was against England in Visakhapatnam
- He became 1st wicketkeeper-batter to score a triple century in Ranji Trophy, representing Andhra Pradesh
- He played for Royal Challengers Bengaluru in IPL 2021 & for Delhi Capitals in IPL 2022

News - 247

- Neelkanth Mishra – appointed as India's next Executive Director at World Bank in Washington DC, for 3 years
  - Replacing – Parameswaran Iyer
- He currently serves as Chief Economist at Axis Bank & Head of Global Research & Whole-Time Director at Axis Capital
  - He is a part-time member of Economic Advisory Council to Prime Minister (EAC-PM) & TRAI
  - He also serves as part-time Chairperson of UIDAI
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

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News - 248

- ACC – approved 1-year extension for Tarun Kapoor as Advisor to the Prime Minister in PMO
- Kapoor – first appointed May 2, 2022 | Current extension valid till – June 10, 2027

News - 249

- Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit – appointed as Vice Chief of Air Staff (VCAS), IAF (succeeding - Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor)
- Currently, he is the Chief of Integrated Defence Staff (CISC) since May 1, 2025
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor (From July'1 - Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit)

News - 250

- Saurabh Vijay – additional charge as CEO of "India AI Mission", along with CEO of UIDAI (succeeding - Abhishek Singh)
- Abhishek Singh – assumed charge as Director General (DG) of National Testing Agency (NTA)
- Priyank Bharti – appointed as chairperson of Online Gaming Authority
  - He is also serving as Director General of National Informatics Centre (NIC)

Join us

News - 251

- Han Seong-sook (Min. of SMEs) – nominated as next PM of South Korea by Lee Jae Myung (President of South Korea)
  - To succeed – Kim Min-seok
- She would become Lee government's 1st female PM & South Korea's 2nd female PM (after Han Myeong-sook)
- South Korea – Seoul – Korean Republic won | President – Lee Jae-myung

News - 252

- Kumar Shanker (MD of MNGL) – assumed charge as MD of Indraprastha Gas Ltd (succeeding – Kamal Kishore Chatiwal)
- IGL – India's largest City Gas Distribution company
  - It operates CGD networks across 33 districts in 12 geographical areas across Delhi, UP, Haryana & Rajasthan
  - It is a JV between GAIL (India) Ltd & BPCL, with Government of NCT of Delhi holding a 5% equity stake
- HQs of Indraprastha Gas Limited – New Delhi | Chairman – Shri Subhankar Sen | Established in – 1998

News - 253

- Sanjay Lohiya (Secretary, DFS, MoF) – nominated as a Director on central boards of both RBI & SBI
  - Succeeding – Nagaraju Maddirala
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

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News - 254

- LG Dhiraj Seth (Vice Chief of Army Staff) – appointed as next Chief of Army Staff, w.e.f. Jun 30, 2026
  - Succeeding – General Upendra Dwivedi
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Upendra Dwivedi | Vice Chief – Lt. Gen. Dheeraj Seth

News - 255

- Prof. (Dr.) Bimal N. Patel – elected as a Judge of International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for 2026-2035 term
  - At 36th "Meeting of States Parties to the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS)" – held at New York (Jun 15-19, 2026)
  - He will assume office on Oct 1, 2026 | Succeeding – Justice Neeru Chadha
- Of 2 seats allocated to Asia-Pacific group, Patel (India) & Nguyen Lan-Anh Thi (Vietnam) were elected
- 7 newly elected judges for 2026-2035 term represent India, Vietnam, Ghana, Tunisia, Russia, Brazil & Netherlands
- Prof. Patel – currently a Member of UN International Law Commission (ILC) & serves as Vice-Chancellor of Rashtriya Raksha University, Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  - He is also a Member of India's National Security Advisory Board (NSAB) under National Security Council Secretariat
- ITLOS – established in 1996 under UNCLOS (Annex VI) & headquartered in Hamburg, Germany
  - It comprises 21 independent judges elected for 9-year terms by UNCLOS States Parties (currently 172)

Join us

- UNCLOS – adopted on Dec 10, 1982 & entered into force on Nov 16, 1994
- HQs of ITLOS – Hamburg, Germany | President – Judge Tomas Heidar | Established in – 1982

News - 256

- Tushar Mehta – reappointed as Solicitor-General (SG) of India for 3 years, w.e.f. July 1, 2026
- ACC also reappointed 5 Additional Solicitors-General (ASGs) for Supreme Court for 3 years terms:
  - Vikramjit Banerjee & K.M. Nataraj, Suryaprakash V. Raju, N. Venkataraman & Aishwarya Bhati
- Chetan Sharma – reappointed as Additional Solicitor General for Delhi High Court for 6 months, w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026

News - 257

- Pradeep Singh Kharola – appointed as Executive Advisor to Chairman & a full member of Air India's management committee with immediate effect
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Campbell Wilson (subsidiary of Tata Group)

News - 258

- Meta Platforms announced a $900 million strategic investment in CRED, acquiring ~20% minority stake & valuing fintech company at $4.5 billion post-money
- Kunal Shah (CRED founder) – appointed as new Global Head of WhatsApp (succeeding – Will Cathcart)
- Miten Sampat – assume role of Interim CEO with immediate effect
- CRED – founded by Shah in 2018
- Shah co-founded Freecharge in 2010 & has angel-invested in ~298 startups
- HQs of Meta – California, US | CEO – Mark Zuckerberg | Founded in – 2004

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News - 259

- LG Rajiv Ghai – appointed as Military Adviser (MA) to National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS)
  - He became 1st serving three-star officer to hold this position since | Succeeding – LG N. S. Raja Subramani (Retd.)
  - He is currently serving as – Deputy Chief of Army Staff (Strategy) of Indian Army
- He has been awarded with: Sarvottam Yudh Seva Medal (for Operation Sindoor)
  - Uttam Yudh Seva Medal (2025) | Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (2023) | Sena Medal with two bars
- Military Adviser to NSCS – serves as principal military voice in National Security Council framework
- HQs of NSCS – New Delhi | National Security Advisor – Ajit Doval | Established in – 1998

News - 260

- Abiy Ahmed Ali – reappointed as PM of Ethiopia for 2nd consecutive term for 5 years
- Ethiopia projects GDP growth of over 10.2% for FY26 (fastest in Africa)
- Ethiopia – Addis Ababa – Ethiopian Birr | President – Taye Atske Selassie | PM – Abiy Ahmed Ali

Join us

Awards, Rewards, Recognition & Prizes

News - 261

- Valluvan Vadavalli Thangavel (Pollachi) – received 3rd Prize in 'World Soil Day 2024 Farmer Contest'
  - Awarded by – FAO/Global Soil Partnership | He is associated with 'Cauvery Calling' initiative of Isha Foundation
- His work included in WOCAT (World Overview of Conservation Approaches and Technologies) database

News - 262

- Indian Haj Mission (Ministry of Minority Affairs) – won 2 "Labbaytum Awards" for Best Haj Coordination & Communication at 2026 Khitamahu Misk ceremony, Saudi Arabia
- The Indian Hajj mission 2026 was led by – Ambassador Dr Suhel Ajaz Khan & Consul General Suri
- ~175,000 Indian pilgrims performed Haj in 2026
- Labbaytum Awards – annual recognition by Saudi Haj Ministry for excellence in pilgrim services
- Saudi Arabia – Riyadh – Saudi Riyal | PM – Mohammed bin Salman Al Saud | King – Salman bin Abdulaziz

News - 263

- Deendayal Port Authority (Kandla) – received "Sagar Aankalan Award" for best-performing port in Container Cargo handling (<0.5 million TEUs) FY 2024-25
- Paradip Port Authority – topped in Dry Bulk Cargo category (>5 million tonnes) & ranked 3rd in India for Container Cargo
- Sikka Port & Terminals – topped in Liquid Bulk Cargo category | 2nd – Visakhapatnam Port Authority (>5 million tonnes)
- Mundra Port – topped in Container Cargo (>0.5 million TEUs) | 2nd – Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority

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News - 264

- Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (India) – won "Food Planet Prize 2026" ($1.5 million) in Sweden
  - For leading world's largest transition to natural farming
- Implemented by – Rythu Sadhikara Samstha | Launched in 2016 by Andhra Pradesh Govt
  - implemented across 8,168 villages with ~18 lakh farmer families
- The model is being replicated in 21 Indian states and countries including Sri Lanka, Indonesia & Zambia
- Other finalists – Conscious Kitchen (US), NoPalm Ingredients (Netherlands), Savanna Institute (US)

News - 265

- Idris Elba (British actor aged 53) – conferred honour of "Knight Bachelor", by King Charles III
  - At an investiture ceremony at Windsor Castle, as part of UK New Year Honours 2026 list
- Other notable recipients include: Actress & author Meera Syal (Damehood) – for services to literature, drama & charity
  - Jayne Torvill (Damehood) & Christopher Dean (Knighthood) – for services to sport & voluntary service

Join us

News - 266

- Major Prabhat Mishra (Indian Army) – received "Birrer-Brookes Award for Outstanding Master of Military Arts and Science Thesis" & "General Douglas MacArthur Military Leadership Writing Award"
  - During graduation ceremony of US Army Command &b General Staff College's Command & General Staff Officer Course (CGSOC), Fort Leavenworth, US
- Major Aleksander Granberg (Norway) – received 'General Dwight D. Eisenhower Award' & 'Arter-Doniphan Award'
- Lt Col Taleh S F H H Alrashid (Kuwait) – received 'Major General Hans Schlup Award'

News - 267

- DARPG selected 17 projects & initiatives for 29th "National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) 2026" across 7 categories
  - To be conferred at – 29th National Conference on e-Governance in Jaipur, Rajasthan
- 7 award categories are:

  (I) Government Process Re-engineering by Use of Technology for Digital Transformation (4 awards)

  (II) Innovation by Use of AI & Other New Age Technologies for Providing Citizen Centric Services (3 awards)

  (III) Best e-Gov Practices/Innovation in Cyber Security (3 awards)

  (IV) District Level Initiatives in e-Governance (2 awards)

  (V) Grassroots Level Initiatives by Gram Panchayats or Equivalent Traditional Local Bodies for Deepening/Widening of Service Delivery

  (VI) Replication & Scaling of Nationally Awarded & Mission-mode e-Governance Projects by States/UTs/Districts

  (VII) Digital Transformation by Use of Data Analytics in Digital Platforms by Central Ministries/States/UTs
- Category V (Gram Panchayats) – a new addition to NAeG scheme for 2026
- Notable selected projects include: 'AgriStack' – by MoA&FW | 'Mahakumbh 2025' – by Prayagraj Mela Authority, UP
  - 'Blood Bag Traceability & Citizen Interaction Portal' – by Kerala Development & Innovation Strategic Council (K-DISC)
  - 'TRINETRA' – AI-based video surveillance system for Mahakal Rudrasagar Integrated Development Area (MRIDA) & Mahakaleshwar Temple by Mahakaleshwar Temple Trust, Ujjain
  - 'Panchayat Advancement Index' – by Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- Along with trophies & certificates, award money: Gold Award – ₹10 lakh | Silver Award – ₹5 lakh
- List of 10 Gold Awardees and 6 Silver Awardees of NAeG 2026:

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Name of the Project	Organisation Name
Agri Stack	Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
e-jagriti	Ministry of Consumer Affairs
Mahakumbh 2025	Prayagraj Mela Authority, Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh
Blood Bag Traceability and Citizen Interaction portal for promoting speedy, safe and voluntary blood donation	Kerala Development and Innovation Strategic Council (K-DISC)
AI-enabled Clinical Decision Support system in eSanjeevani telemedicine service	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
District Court Case Management System (DCMS)	High Court of Kerala
ICMR's Multistate Implementation Research Study on Integration of Screening and Management of Mental and Substance Use Disorders with other Non-Communicable Diseases (ICMR-MINDS)	Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
Security Product for Threat Intel Distribution and DNS Filtering Service	Space Application Centre-ISRO, Ahmedabad
E Nagar Palika with cyber security	Urban Development and Housing Department M.P.
Integrated Cyber Security framework for a resilient Digital Banking Ecosystem	Bank of Baroda
E – Aarogya Dhamni – Transforming Healthcare through E - Governance	Health Department Zilla Parishad, Nandurbar, Maharashtra
Pune 360	Pune Municipal Commission, Maharashtra
Kadepur Gram Panchayat	Sangli District, Maharashtra
Bijoy Nagar Gram Panchayat	West Tripura District, Tripura
TRINETRA – AI based Video Surveillance system for Mahakal Rudrasagar Integrated Development Area (MRIDA) including Mahakaleshwar Temple	Mahakaleshwar Temple Trust, Samrat Vikramaditya Prashasnik Sankul Bhawan, Ujjain
Panchayat Advancement Index - Data Driven Governance for Viksit Bharat	Ministry of Panchayati Raj

- Jury Award of NAeG 2026:

Name of the Project	Organisation Name
Real Time Precise Positioning Services through CORS Network	Survey of India

News - 268

- e-Jagriti (MoCAFP) – awarded Silver Award under Category I 'Government Process Re-engineering by Use of Technology for Digital Transformation' at National Awards for e-Governance 2026
- Category I – received 341 nominations from Central Ministries, Departments & State Governments
- 'e-Jagriti': Launched on Jan 1, 2025 | Unified 4 legacy apps (OCMS, e-Daakhil, NCDRC CMS & CONFONET) into One

Join us

- Achievements: facilitated filing of 2.29 lakh cases & disposal of 2.07 lakh cases | Overall disposal rate 90.75%
- NAeG 2026 – 29th edition | Total 17 awards across 7 categories – 10 Gold, 6 Silver, 1 Jury Award

News - 269

- GRASA Millets & Foods Pvt Ltd – received "Rashtriya Ratna Samman 2026" in category 'Emerging HealthTech & Nutrition Innovation Startup of the Year'
  - Award presented by – Kangana Ranaut (Padma Shri awardee)
- GRASA – India's 1st food-led metabolic recovery system based on millets, fermentation & gut health
  - It's a precision nutrition arm of MediCAPS, incubated within IDC India through COSMINNOX
- Clinical outcomes & food science – documented by IDCIJST (peer-reviewed International Journal of S&T)
- Rashtriya Ratna Samman 2026 – awarded across sectors including Technology, Real Estate, Education, Healthcare, Pharmaceuticals, Professional Services, Hospitals, Clinics, Products & Service Providers
- HQs of GRASA Millets & Foods – New Delhi | Director & Co-Founder – Deepti Anand

News - 270

- President Droupadi Murmu – conferred 51 Gallantry Awards during Phase-I of 'Defence Investiture Ceremony 2026'
  - 7 Kirti Chakras (2 posthumous) – India's 2nd-highest peacetime gallantry award after 'Ashok Chakra'
  - 15 Vir Chakras (3 posthumous) – India's 3rd-highest wartime gallantry award after Param Vir & Maha Vir Chakra
  - 29 Shaurya Chakras (1 posthumous) – India's 3rd-highest peacetime gallantry award
- Full List of Awardees:

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KIRTI CHAKRA (7)
(including 2 posthumous)

	NAME	SERVICE
1.	Captain Anshuman Singh	Indian Army
2.	Major Yogesh Kumar (Posthumous)	Indian Army
3.	Naib Subedar Mandeep Singh	Indian Army
4.	Subedar Sanjay Kumar	Indian Army
5.	Subedar Major Hoshiar Singh	Indian Army
6.	Lance Naik Dinesh Singh (Posthumous)	Indian Army
7.	Flying Officer Avani Chaturvedi	Indian Air Force



VIR CHAKRA (15)
(including 3 posthumous)

	NAME	SERVICE
1.	Lieutenant Colonel Neetesh Bharti Shukla	Indian Army
2.	Major Rohit Kumar Sharma	Indian Army
3.	Major Pawan Kumar	Indian Army
4.	Major Vikram Singh	Indian Army
5.	Major Amit Sharma (Posthumous)	Indian Army
6.	Captain Deepak Singh	Indian Army
7.	Captain Gurvinder Singh	Indian Army
8.	Naib Subedar Satnam Singh	Indian Army
9.	Havildar Praveen Kumar	Indian Army
10.	Rifleman Ravi Kumar	Indian Army
11.	Subedar Balwinder Singh (Posthumous)	Indian Army
12.	Sepoy Sanjay Singh	Indian Army
13.	Sailor Bhanu Pratap	Indian Navy
14.	Flight Lieutenant Arpit Saxena	Indian Air Force
15.	Sergeant Ajay Kumar (Posthumous)	Indian Air Force



SHAURYA CHAKRA (29)
(including 1 posthumous)

	NAME	SERVICE
1.	Inspector Laxman Kewat	Chhattisgarh Police
2.	Inspector Rameshwar Prasad Deshmukh	Chhattisgarh Police
3.	Commandant Rakesh Kumar	CRPF
4.	Deputy Commandant Rahul Singh	CRPF
5.	Assistant Commandant Manoj Kumar	CRPF
6.	Head Constable Gopal Singh	CRPF
7.	Constable Ratan Kumar	CRPF
8.	Havildar Surender Singh	BSF
9	Havildar Mahendra Singh	BSF
10.	Constable Pawan Kumar	BSF
11	Sub Inspector Ramesh Kumar	ITBP
12.	Assistant Sub Inspector Tsering Dorje	ITBP
13.	Head Constable Dorje Namgyal	ITBP
14.	Naib Subedar Jaswinder Singh	Indian Army
15.	Havildar Vikash Kumar	Indian Army
16.	Lance Naik Suraj Singh	Indian Army
17	Rifleman Amit Kumar	Indian Army
18.	Rifleman Sunil Yadav	Indian Army
19	Sepoy Rohit Yadav	Indian Army
20.	Sepoy Ajay Singh	Indian Army
21.	Sepoy Vishal Kumar	Indian Army
22.	Sepoy Manoj Kumar	Indian Army
23.	Sepoy Imtiyaz Ahmed	Indian Army
24.	Corporal Ganesh Ram	Indian Army
25.	Corporal Bharat Singh	Indian Army
26.	Leading Aircraftsman Sachin Kumar	Indian Air Force
27.	Sergeant Mahesh Kumar	Indian Air Force
28.	Corporal Vikram Singh	Indian Air Force
29.	Corporal Abhishek Tiwari	Indian Air Force



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News - 271

- Gautam Dey – awarded "EMBO Gold Medal 2026" for exceptional contribution to life sciences in Europe
  - He is an Indian-origin scientist working with European Molecular Biology Laboratory at Heidelberg in Germany
- He shared award with Omaya Dudin from University of Geneva in Switzerland
- Dey has been awarded medal in recognition of his work on evolutionary origins of nuclear organisation & cell division
- Dudin has been recognised for his work shedding light on evolutionary origins of multicellularity
- EMBO Gold Medal – awarded by European Molecular Biology Organisation (EMBO) annually
- One of the recipients of EMBO Gold Medal in 2025, Tanmay AM Bharat, is also a scientist of Indian origin

News - 272

- National Academy of Music, Dance & Drama (General Council of Sangeet Natak Akademi) – elected 7 eminent personalities in field of performing arts as 'Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna)'
  - Ramlal Bareth, A.V. Anand, Rita Ganguly, Puru Dadheech, Chittaranjan Jyotishi, Pasumarthi Rattaiah Sarma & Sudharani Raghupathy
- Fellowship of Akademi – restricted to 40 at any given time

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- It also selected 108 artists from field of Music, Dance, Theatre, Traditional / Folk / Tribal / Music / Dance / Theatre / Puppetry & Overall Contribution / Scholarship & others in Performing Arts for Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards (Akademi Puraskar) for 2024 & 2025
- It also selected 106 young artists for 'Sangeet Natak Akademi', 'Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar' for 2024 & 2025
- These awards will be conferred by – Chairman of Sangeet Natak Akademi
- Akademi Awards – conferred since 1952
- Prize money of: Honour of Akademi Fellow – Rs 3,00,000
  - Akademi Award – Rs 1,00,000, besides a Tamrapatra & Angavastram
  - Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar – Rs 25,000 besides a Tamrapatra & an Angavastram
- Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship & Awards – to be conferred by President of India
- Akademi, National Academy of Music, Dance & Drama – India's apex national body for performing arts
  - Established in – 1953 | Functioning under – Ministry of Culture

News - 273

- 'II International Festival of Sand Sculpture' – held in Kaliningrad region of Russia
- Sudarsan Pattnaik (Odisha) – won "Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026"
  - For 3m tall sculpture on theme of global warming | He became 1st Indian to receive this honour
- Presented by – Alena Aleksandrovna (festival's General Director)
- In 2014, GoI honoured Sudarsan Pattnaik with Padma Shri, India's 4th-highest civilian award
- In 2017, he set a Guinness World Record at Puri beach for tallest sand castle

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News - 274

- Lt Vishal Kumar – conferred "Sword of Honour" & "President's Gold Medal" by President of India, Droupadi Murmu
  - During passing out parade for 158th Regular Course at Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun
- Captain Yogender Singh Thakur – conferred 'Shaurya Chakra'
  - He is an officer of 6th Battalion, The Parachute Regiment (Special Forces)
- Major Akhilesh Bhatt – feat of scaling Mount Everest while leading a 12-member National Security Guard team
- Cadet Captain Sahil Sharma – awarded President's Bronze Medal
  - At Passing Out Parade of 150th Course of National Defence Academy, Khadakwasla, Pune, Maharashtra
- Sub Lieutenant Sachin Kumar – commissioned into Indian Navy & received Chief of Naval Staff Silver Medal
  - For securing 2nd position in overall order of merit at Indian Naval Academy, Ezhimala, Kerala

News - 275

- PM Modi – conferred with "Order of the White Double Cross (1st Class)", highest state decoration of Slovak Republic
  - Conferred by – Peter Pellegrini (Slovak President) | In a ceremony at Bratislava on Jun 16, 2026
  - It marks his 33rd international award from a foreign government (since May 2014)

Join us

- PM Modi's visit to Slovakia – 1st by an Indian PM since Slovakia's independence on Jan 1, 1993
- Notable international awards previously received by PM Modi include:
  - Order of the Druk Gyalpo (Bhutan, 2021) | Order of St Andrew the Apostle (Russia, 2019)
  - Grand Cross of the Legion of Honour (France, 2023) | Grand Commander of the Order of the Niger (Nigeria, 2024)
  - Grand Commander of the Order of the Star and Key of the Indian Ocean (Mauritius, Mar 2025)
  - Grand Cross of the Order of Makarios III (Cyprus, Jun 2025) | The Great Honour Nishan of Ethiopia (Dec 2025)
  - Order of the Most Ancient Welwitschia Mirabilis (Namibia, Jul 2025)
- Slovakia – Bratislava – Euro | President – Peter Pellegrini | PM – Robert Fico

News - 276

- "Prix Versailles World's Most Beautiful Airports List 2026":
- Indian airports recognised by Prix Versailles – Adani Airport Holdings Limited (AAHL), Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) Terminal 1 & Terminal 2 of Lokapriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport (LGBIA), Guwahati
- Prix Versailles award – presented annually at UNESCO Headquarters, Paris, since 2015
- Three airports or terminals from 2026 list will receive World Titles (Prix Versailles Interior or Exterior)
- Other airports featured in list are located in – Guangzhou (China), Frankfurt am Main (Germany), Kandal Stueng (Cambodia), Pittsburgh (USA) & San Diego (USA)

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News - 277

- Jainendra K Jain – received "2025 Wolf Prize in Physics" for his discovery of composite fermions
  - He shared this prize with James P. Eisenstein & Mordehai Heiblum for advancing understanding of 2D electron systems in strong magnetic fields
- He is 1st person of Indian origin to receive this award since its inception in 1978
- Award was presented by – Isaac Herzog (Israeli President) at a state ceremony in Knesset, Jerusalem
- He is Founding Director of Lodha Theoretical Physics Institute (LTPI)
- Wolf Prize in Physics – awarded annually by Wolf Foundation since 1978
  - It is also awarded in agriculture, chemistry, mathematics, medicine & arts
- Indians previously awarded with Wolf Prize:
  - Wolf Prize in Agriculture – Dr Gurdev Singh Khush & Dr Venkatesan Sundaresan
  - Wolf Prize in Music – Conductor Zubin Mehta

News - 278

- Osmania University (Hyderabad) – became 1st university in India to be awarded 4 internationally recognised ISO Management System Certifications simultaneously by BIS
- 4 certifications awarded to Osmania University are:
  - IS ISO 21001:2018 - Educational Organizations Management System (EOMS)

Join us

- IS ISO 14001:2015 - Environmental Management System (EMS)
- IS ISO 50001:2018 - Energy Management System (EnMS)
- IS ISO 22000:2018 - Food Safety Management System (FSMS)

- Osmania University – established in 1918 in Hyderabad, Telangana

News - 279

- 7 students of CSE at Chandigarh University – received "IndiaAI Fellowship" for 2025-26 of Rs 1 lakh each from MeitY
  - Recipients – Shreyam Sinha, Harpreet Singh, Ashirvad Satyendra Singh, Kriti Upadhyay, Muskan, Saurav Yadav & Shubham Bajaj
- Chandigarh University has 56 govt-funded research projects & 12 research projects involving international collaboration

News - 280

- Harsh Vardhan – conferred "Global Prestige Award" at House of Lords, UK Parliament, London
  - Theme of ceremony – 'Visionaries of Change: Charting the Course to Viksit Bharat 2047'
- Bihar's cricket ecosystem gained national prominence through players including Vaibhav Sooryavanshi & Akshara Gupta
- Viksit Bharat 2047 – GoI's vision to transform India into a fully developed nation by 2047
  - It is built on 4 pillars: Yuva (Youth), Garib (Poor), Mahilayen (Women) & Annadata (Farmers)
  - It targets a GDP of $30-40 trillion & per capita income of $15,000-18,000 by 2047

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News - 281

- GRSE Ltd – conferred with coveted "Navratna" status by Department of Public Enterprises, MoF
  - GRSE – became 29th Navratna amongst CPSEs
- Now, it will have financial independence to invest up to Rs 1,000 Cr without seeking approval from central government
- It will also be allowed to invest up to 15% of their net worth on a single project, or 30% of their net worth in a given year, subject to a cap of Rs 1,000 Cr
- To qualify as a Navratna, a CPSE having a Miniratna-I status must obtain an 'Excellent' or 'Very Good' MoU rating in 3 out of last 5 years & have a composite score of 60 or more in 6 selected performance indicators
  (i) net profit to net worth | (ii) manpower cost to total cost of production | (iii) profit before depreciation
  (iv) interest and taxes (PBDIT) to capital employed | (v) profit before Interest and taxes to turnover, earnings per share
  (vi) inter-sectoral performance
- GRSE – already delivered 8 warships during year, including 3 on Mar 30, 2026
- It delivered largest number of warships to Indian Navy, ICG & friendly foreign nations
  - Out of 118 warships delivered by GRSE, 80 have been inducted into Indian Navy
- HQs of GRSE – Kolkata, West Bengal | Chairman & MD – P. R. Hari | Founded in – 1884

Join us

News - 282

- PM Modi – conferred with "Guardian of the Blue Horizon", Seychelles' highest distinction for leadership in environmental conservation & sustainable development
  - It is his 34th international honour from a foreign nation
- India & Seychelles announced 19 key outcomes: An Extradition Treaty
  - An MoU on Cooperation in Peaceful Uses of Outer Space
  - An NIPL - Central Bank of Seychelles agreement to deploy UPI-based digital payments in Seychelles
  - An Umbrella Line of Credit Agreement with Exim Bank of India
  - An MoU for Preliminary Preparations for New Seychelles National Hospital
  - An HLL Lifecare Ltd - Seychelles Ministry of Health agreement under Jan Aushadhi Scheme
  - An ICAR - Seychelles Agriculture Department MoU & Work Plan 2026-2031
  - A Sushma Swaraj Institute of Foreign Service - Seychelles Ministry of Foreign Affairs MoU on diplomatic training
  - An MoU on recognition of Indian seafarers' training & certification for Seychelles-flagged vessels
- Developmental deliverables included: Gifting of Made-in-India Fast Patrol Vessel PS Lespwar (built by Goa Shipyard Ltd)
  - 'Lespwar' to Seychelles Coast Guard | Completion of refit of PS Zoroaster | 6 ambulances
  - 10 utility vehicles & 5 Laser Radial class boats to Seychelles Defence Force (SDF) | 500 metric tonnes of rice
  - Upgrade of a Dornier aircraft with a glass cockpit | 8,500 metric tonnes of cement
  - A virtual ground-breaking ceremony for a Professional & Technical Education Centre
- In Seychelles' 50th National Day Golden Jubilee Parade, India was represented by:
  - A 32-member Indian Army marching contingent from Assam Regiment (led by Captain Aryan H. Deolekar)
  - An Indian Navy marching contingent from frontline warship INS Tarkash & Survey Vessel Large INS Ikshak
- Seychelles – Victoria – Seychellois Rupee | President – Dr. Matthew Antonio Patrick Herminie

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Schemes & Initiatives

News - 283

- 'Pradhan Mantri Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi)' scheme – launched on Jun 1, 2020, by MoHUA
  - Cumulative disburse (over 6 years) –1.12 crore loans worth more than ₹17,800 Cr
- It provides collateral-free working capital loans in 3 progressive tranches of ₹15,000, ₹25,000 & ₹50,000
- Vendors successfully repaying 2nd tranche are eligible for UPI-linked RuPay Credit Cards with limits up to ₹30,000
- 'SVANidhi se Samriddhi' (SSS) sub-component link beneficiaries with 8 selected Central Government welfare schemes
- It has been extended until Mar 31, 2030, with an implementation structure jointly overseen by MoHUA & DFS

Join us

News - 284

- ANRF + Ministry of Jal Shakti = launched "MAHA Water Mission" with Rs 200 Cr outlay to support startups in water sector
- It provides up to Rs 20 Cr to selected multidisciplinary consortia including universities, national labs, etc.
- The mission will focus on 5 priority themes:
  - Water resource assessment & sustainable management
  - Drinking water
  - Water quality & ecological health
  - Water use efficiency & circular economy
  - Climate resilience & adaptation
- ANRF – already launched MAHA in strategic sectors including EVs, drones, medical tech., 6G communications & water
- HQs of ANRF – New Delhi | CEO – Shivkumar Kalyanaraman | Established in – 2023
- Minister of Jal Shakti: C R Patil | Constituency – Navsari, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Jal Shakti – V. Somanna & Raj Bhushan Choudhary

News - 285

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan (Min. for A&FW & RD) – launched nationwide "Khet Bachao Abhiyan" (Jun 1-30, 2026)
  - From Ramasiya village in Raisen, MP
- Minister of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Ram Nath Thakur & Bhagirath Choudhary

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News - 286

- DHE (MoE) invited applications for "Prime Minister Research Chair (PMRC) Scheme 2026"
- PMRC Scheme – to focus on 13 priority sectors
  - AI, quantum computing, semiconductors, cybersecurity, healthcare, biotechnology, space & defence
  - Advanced materials, climate change, next-generation communications, manufacturing
  - Agriculture technologies, blue economy and atomic energy
- It is structured around 3 pillars – Lead Institutions, Host Institutions & PMRC Fellows
- Empowered Committee (chaired by PSA to GoI) – to oversee selection of participating institutions & fellows
- It offers 3 categories of engagement:

  (i) Young Research Fellows for early-career researchers

  (ii) Senior Research Fellows for experienced researchers

  (iii) Research Chairs for globally recognised research leaders
- Eligible applicants include Indian nationals working abroad, OCI cardholders & Persons of Indian Origin
- Eligible host institutions include government higher educational institutions ranked among top 100 in NIRF Overall or Engineering categories, or among top 50 in NIRF Research category

Join us

- 7 premier institutions have been identified as lead Institutions – IIT Delhi, IIT Bombay, IIT Madras, IIT Kanpur
  - IIT Hyderabad, IIT (Indian School of Mines) Dhanbad & Indian Institute of Science (IISc) Bengaluru

News - 287

- Cabinet approved a 2-year scheme for replacement of old trucks & buses in Delhi-NCR area
  - Funded through National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB) under MoHUA
- It is implemented by – MoRTH & MoPNG in collaboration with Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan & Uttar Pradesh
- Total financial outlay – ₹9,585 Cr
  - ₹5,041 Cr – from Central Government | ₹1,601 Cr – in tax concessions from participating states
- For BS-III or older vehicles, scrapping at Registered Vehicle Scrapping Facilities is mandatory
- Central Government will provide: A 5% interest subvention on loans for 5 years
  - Monthly fuel vouchers of up to ₹4,800 per vehicle category
  - Lump-sum benefits for EV purchases or Certificate of Deposit trading
- It will be monitored by an Empowered Committee chaired by Cabinet Secretary

News - 288

- 'Two Years of PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana: Scaling the Solar Home to 1 Crore Rooftops' – held in New Delhi
  - On Jun 4, 2026
- Pralhad Joshi (Min. for NRE) – announced a new interim target of 75 lakh rooftop solar installations under 'PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana' by Dec 2026
- As of May 2026, 33 lakh+ rooftop systems have been installed across India, adding over 12 GW of capacity
- Rooftop solar accounts for ~45% of residential solar capacity
- He launched 'Utility-Linked Aggregation (ULA) Model' to accelerate adoption among underserved households

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News - 289

- Rapido + MoRTH = partnered to support nationwide awareness & citizen participation for GoI's "Rahveer Scheme"
- 4 lakh+ Rapido captains took 'Rahveer Pledge' through company's platform, creating a Guinness World Record
- Aim: To promote road safety awareness & encourage citizens to assist accident victims without hesitation
- HQs of Rapido – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-founder & CEO – Aravind Sanka | Established in – 2015
- Minister of Road Transport & Highways: Nitin Gadkari | Constituency – Nagpur, Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: Ajay Tamta & Harsh Malhotra

News - 290

- Piyush Goyal (Min. of C&I) – launched "Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana (BHAVYA)" Portal to operationalise BHAVYA scheme
- BHAVYA Portal – developed by National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation (NICDC)
- BHAVYA scheme – to develop 100 investment-ready industrial parks across India over next 6 years

Join us

- Outlay – Rs 33,660 Cr

- In hilly regions, smaller UTs & Northeastern states, parks could begin at 25 acres
  - Mid-sized states – ranging from 100 to 500 acres
  - Locations near major urban centres could accommodate industrial zones of up to 1,000 acres
- Land for these projects will be provided by state governments
- Infrastructure development – to be supported by GoI through NICDC (in 51:49 partnership model with states)
- Minister of Commerce & Industry: Piyush Goyal | Constituency – Mumbai (North), Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Commerce & Industry: Jitin Prasada

News - 291

- GoI approved extension of 'Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0 (CGSMFI-2.0)'
  - Extended until Aug 31, 2026, or until guarantees amounting to ₹20,000 Cr are issued, whichever is earlier
  - It was originally introduced on – Mar 20, 2026
- Mximum loan amount capped for Large Sized NBFC-MFIs/MFIs – increased to ₹1,000 Cr (from ₹300 Cr)
  - Subject to an overall ceiling of 20% of borrower's Assets Under Management (AUM)
- Aim: To provide guarantee cover to Banks & Financial Institutions through NCGTC
- Guarantee coverage under scheme is differentiated by MFI size: 80% of amount in default for Small NBFC-MFIs/MFIs
  - 75% for Medium & 70% for Large
- Guarantee fee – 0.50% per annum on sanctioned amount in 1st year & on outstanding amount thereafter

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News - 292

- Jagat Prakash Nadda (Min. of H&FW) – launched nationwide celebrations to commemorate 10 years of "Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA)" under theme '10 Years of PMSMA - A Decade of Care' in New Delhi
- He also released a 75-rupee commemorative Coin & a 5-rupee postal stamp to celebrate 10-year milestone of PMSMA
- PMSMA – launched in Jun 2016, by MoH&FW
- In Jan 2022, MoH&FW introduced 'Extended PMSMA' to strengthen follow-up care for high-risk pregnancies (HRPs)
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 293

- As of Jun 9, 2026, total number of guarantees issued under "Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme 5.0 (ECLGS 5.0)" – reached 1,06,549 (total amount of guarantees - Rs 48,484.26 Cr)
- Out of total coverage, 96% of guarantees issued by number & 86% of total guaranteed amount belong to MSME sector
- Guarantee coverage provided: 100% – to MSME sector | 90% – to non-MSME sector
- It aims to infuse additional credit of Rs 2,55,000 Cr to existing borrowers to tide over liquidity challenges
- ECLGS 5.0 – approved by Union Cabinet on May 5, 2026

Join us

- It aims to provide credit guarantee coverage of 100% for MSMEs & 90% for non-MSMEs, as well as airline sector
- It would apply to all loans sanctioned during period from date of issue of these guidelines by NCGTC up to Mar 31, 2027

News - 294

- MSDE marked 12 years of Skill India Mission under theme "Skills, Scale and Transformation" on June 11, 2026
  - Led by – Jayant Chaudhary (MoS (I/C) for SD&E and Education)
- Number of it is – grown to over 13,888 (from 9,776 in 2014)
- Over 1.64 crore candidates have been trained under Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)
- Skill India Digital Hub (SIDH) – launched in Sep 2023 as a Digital Public Infrastructure for skilling
- MSDE – established in July 2014 as a dedicated ministry
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship: Jayant Chaudhary | Constituency – Mathura, UP

News - 295

- Cabinet, on Mar 25, 2026, approved launch & implementation of 'Regional Connectivity Scheme - Modified UDAN'
  - For 10 years from FY27 to FY36 | Total outlay – ₹28,840 Cr | UDAN – 'Ude Desh Ka Aam Nagrik'
  - PM Modi is scheduled to formally unveil scheme at a launch event in Kolkata on Jun 20, 2026
- It provides Operations and Maintenance (O&M) support for 3 years capped at:
  - ₹3.06 Cr per annum per airport | ₹0.90 Cr per annum per heliport or water aerodrome
- UDAN scheme – launched on Oct 21, 2016, under National Civil Aviation Policy (NCAP) 2016
  - 1st UDAN flight inaugurated by PM Modi on Apr 27, 2017, from Shimla to Delhi

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News - 296

- Kerala – launched "Priyadarshini" free travel scheme for all women & transgender persons on ordinary buses operated by Kerala State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC)
- V.D. Satheesan (CM) – inaugurated this scheme at Thampanoor Central Bus Station
- Women & transgender persons can travel free of charge on 7 categories of KSRTC ordinary services:
  - Ordinary, city ordinary, limited-stop ordinary, fair-stage ordinary, town-to-town, point-to-point & Gramavandi services
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – Pinarayi Vijayan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 297

- Arjun Ram Meghwal (MoS (I/C) for L&J) – approved continuation of Central Sector Scheme 'Designing Innovative Solutions for Holistic Access to Justice (DISHA)' restructured as "DISHA 2.0" for 5 years (Apr 1, 2026 to Mar 31, 2031)
- Total approved financial outlay – Rs. 255 Cr (to be funded entirely through 100% gross budgetary support of GoI)
- DISHA 2.0 – recommended by Standing Finance Committee meeting
  - It was chaired by – Niraj Verma (Secretary, Department of Justice, MoL&J)

Join us

- DISHA 2.0 comprises 4 components & will be implemented across all states & UTs:

  (i) Tele-Law (Reaching the Unreached)

  (ii) Nyaya Bandhu (Pro-Bono Legal Services) Programme

  (iii) Legal Literacy and Legal Awareness Programme (LLLAP)

  (iv) VIDHI (Vision for Integrated Delivery of Harmonized Legal Initiatives) Sanjeevani
- DISHA Scheme (2021-26), with a financial outlay of Rs 250 Cr, was implemented by Department of Justice
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Law & Justice: Arjun Ram Meghwal | Constituency – Bikaner, Rajasthan

News - 298

- MoPNG approved ₹150 Cr in financial assistance under 'Pradhan Mantri JI-VAN (Jaiv Indhan-Vatavaran Anukool fasal awashesh Nivaran) Yojana'
  - Through Centre for High Technology (CHT) to Spray Engineering Devices Ltd (SED), Mohali, Punjab
  - For establishment of India's 1st private-sector commercial-scale Hybrid Second Generation (2G) Ethanol Biorefinery of 91 KLPD (Kilo Litres Per Day) capacity at Wave Sugar, Dhanaura, UP
- It integrates two distinct advanced technologies in a thermally combined configuration:
  - LanzaTech's globally established gas fermentation platform
  - Ankur Scientific Energy Technologies' indigenous oxygen-enriched biomass gasification technology
- PM JI-VAN Yojana, notified by GoI in Mar 2019, provides financial support to integrated bio-ethanol projects for setting up 2G ethanol biorefineries using lignocellulosic biomass & other non-food renewable feedstocks
- Maximum financial assistance per commercial project – ₹150 Cr
  - Channelled through – Centre for High Technology (CHT) under MoPNG
- Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Hardeep Singh Puri | Constituency – Uttar Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Suresh Gopi

News - 299

- PM Modi released 23rd instalment of 'Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi' (PM-KISAN) scheme
  - He transferred more than ₹18,880 Cr directly into bank accounts of over 9.44 crore eligible farmer families
  - During "Paschimbanga Divas" (West Bengal Day) celebrations at Tarakeswar, Hooghly, West Bengal
- In West Bengal, over ₹907.21 Cr was transferred to over 45.35 lakh beneficiaries
  - Cumulative PM-KISAN disbursements in state – ₹15,055 Cr
- Total disbursements under PM-KISAN – crossed ₹4.46 lakh Cr (one of world's largest DBT initiatives)
  - Union Budget 2026-27 allocated ₹60,000 Cr for this scheme
- PM Modi also launched:
  - Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana & Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme – extending crop insurance coverage with an insured value of ~₹28,140 Cr
  - AgriStack – as part of Digital Agriculture Mission, Kisan Credit Cards, DBT & MSP procurement

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Join us

- National Mission on Natural Farming (NMNF) – covering 346 natural farming clusters

- PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana – initiated in 4 districts of West Bengal
- PM-KISAN provides ₹6,000 per year in 3 annual instalments to all landholding farmer families with cultivable land
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R. N. Ravi

News - 300

- MHI extended timelines for global tenders under "Rare Earth Permanent Magnet" (REPM) scheme
- Bid due date – extended to Jul 29, 2026 (from Jun 29, 2026)
- Opening of technical bids – rescheduled to Jul 30, 2026 (from Jun 30, 2026)
- Global tender – invited by Ministry on Mar 20, 2026
- On Nov 26, 2025, Cabinet approved REPM scheme to promote manufacturing of 'Sintered Rare Earth Permanent Magnet' with a financial outlay of Rs 7,280 Cr
  - Aim: To establish a total capacity of 6,000 MTPA of integrated REPM manufacturing facilities in India
- Minister of Heavy Industries: H. D. Kumaraswamy | Constituency – Mandaya, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Heavy Industries: Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa Varma

Meetings, Conferences and Summits

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News - 301

- India – to host 13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum on Jun 11-12, 2026, in New Delhi (India is hosting Forum for 4th time)
  - Theme – "Cities for People: BRICS Cooperation for Inclusive and Resilient Urban Futures"
  - India's Chairship theme – "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"
- BRICS Urbanisation Forum – inaugurated by India in New Delhi in Feb 2013
- BRICS Members (11): Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia & Indonesia
  BRICS Chairmanship 2026 – India

News - 302

- 2nd Technical Meeting of BRICS Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) Working Group – commenced on Jun 3, 2026
  - At – Taj Puri Resort, Puri, Odisha, under India's BRICS Chairship in 2026
  - Organised by – National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) of India
  - Theme – "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"
- This is 1st in-person technical meeting of BRICS DRR Working Group under India's Chairship
  - 1st technical meeting – held virtually on Apr 29-30, 2026 (chaired by NDMA)
- Odisha – selected as host state in recognition of its internationally acknowledged cyclone management expertise

Join us

- BRICS Members (11): Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia & Indonesia
  BRICS Chairmanship 2026 – India

News - 303

- PM Modi chaired 11th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog at Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi
  - On – Jun 11, 2026 | Theme – "Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat @2047"
- 'Inclusive Human Development Framework' is anchored around 4 core pillars:
  (i) Foundational Human Capital & Future-Ready Skills
  (ii) Productive Employment, Entrepreneurship & Decentralised Growth
  (iii) Health, Nutrition & Wellbeing
  (iv) Equity & Dignity for All
- 10th Governing Council Meeting – held on May 24, 2025, at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
  - Theme – 'Viksit Rajya for Viksit Bharat @2047'
- Governing Council of NITI Aayog comprises CMs of all States & UTs with Legislatures & LGs of other UTs, with PM as Chairperson
- Minister of Road Transport & Highways: Nitin Gadkari | Constituency – Nagpur, Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: Ajay Tamta & Harsh Malhotra

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News - 304

- Shobha Karandlaje (MoS (I/C) for L&E and MSME) – led Indian delegation at 114th Session of International Labour Conference (ILC), held in Geneva, Switzerland from June 1-12, 2026
- Organised by – ILO with participation from Govt, Employer & Worker representatives of all 187 ILO Member States
- HQs of ILO – Geneva, Switzerland | DG – Gilbert F. Houngbo | Founded in – 1919

News - 305

- 16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers' Meeting – convened on Jun 12-13, 2026, in Indore, MP
- BRICS Agriculture Ministers' Joint Declaration – adopted unanimously at meeting, delivering 4 major new outcomes
  - 1st – to establish 'BRICS Network of Centres of Excellence on Agroecology and Regenerative Agriculture'
    - Initial coordination by – ICAR-IIFSR, Modipuram (Centre of Excellence on Natural Farming in India)
  - 2nd – to establish a 'Network on Digital Agriculture among BRICS Countries', with initial coordination by IIT Delhi
  - 3rd – to launch a 'Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems'
    - Initial coordination by – Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority (PPV&FRA), New Delhi
  - 4th – to establish 'BRICS AGRIN (Agro-Inputs, Genetic Resources and Information Network) Framework'
- Members also agreed to transform existing BRICS Agricultural Research Platform into a 'Knowledge-to-Action Hub'
  - They also held a Special Dialogue on BRICS Grain Exchange, hosted by India

Join us

- BRICS Members (11): Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia & Indonesia
  BRICS Chairmanship 2026 – India

News - 306

- 52nd "G7 Summit" – held, from Jun 15-17, 2026, at Évian-les-Bains, Haute-Savoie, France
  - Theme – "Working Together to Address Major International Challenges"
- India participated as a 'partner country', marking India's 13th appearance at G7 as a partner nation & PM Modi's 7th consecutive G7 participation
- PM Modi addressed Outreach Session on 'Reviving a Balanced, Shared and Sustainable Economic Growth for All'
- Key outcomes of summit include:
  - A 'Leaders' Declaration on Tackling Migrant Smuggling'
  - A 'G7 Leaders' Declaration on Securing Supply Chains for Critical Minerals'
  - A 'Leaders' Call on a Safer Digital Space for Minors'
  - A 'Leaders' Declaration on the Fight Against Drug Trafficking'
- Japanese PM – formally presented 'Partnership On Wide Energy and Resources Resilience (POWERR Asia)' framework
- G7 presidency rotates to United States for 53rd G7 Summit in 2027

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Ranks, Reports & Surveys

News - 307

- NITI Aayog – released "Future of India's Semiconductor Industry" roadmap report outlining sector vision till 2035
- India imports 90-95% of semiconductors | Spent ~$150 Bn (FY2017-25) | Projected import cost ~$240 Bn by 2035
- Semiconductor demand – projected CAGR 19% | ~$90 billion by 2030 & >$200 billion by 2035
- Roadmap: India to build semiconductor value chain worth $120-150 billion by 2035 (10-13% of global market)
  - Self-sufficiency – 35-50% of domestic chip demand
- 5 strategic pillars – Pioneering, Policy & Investment, Production, People, Partnership
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Nidhi Chhibber | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 308

- India's seafood exports – reached 19,72,018 metric tonnes (MT) in FY26 | Valued at – ₹73,890.46 Cr
  - Year-on-year growth of: 16.13% – in volume | 18.4% – in rupee value | 13.44% – in dollar value
  - Unit value per kg declined 2.31% in dollar terms
- Leading export item – Frozen shrimp (7,92,647 MT valued at ₹49,037.93 Cr)
  - It accounts for: 40.19% – of total export volume | 66.52% – of total dollar earnings
  - 2nd – Frozen fish (₹5,658.37 Cr, with volume growing 4.68% to 3,55,581 MT)

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- Fastest-growing segment – Dried seafood, with exports surging 62.25% in volume to 4,10,410 MT & 69.46% in dollar terms to $577.44 million
  - It is also 2nd-largest product group by quantity
- By market, top destination by value – United States (₹20,263.27 Cr)
  - Frozen shrimp – comprise 93.55% of US export earnings
- Top destination by volume – China

News - 309

- "State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026" report – released by ICRIER-Prosus Centre for Internet & Digital Economy
- India – 5th most digitalized economy globally on "CHIPS-Combined Index" (up from 8th in 2025)
  - Behind – US, China, Singapore & UK
- India – ranked 4th on "CHIPS-AI Index" | Behind – US, China & Singapore
- CHIPS framework – measures countries across 5 pillars: Connect, Harness, Innovate, Protect & Sustain
  - It covers 71 economies

News - 310

- MoSPI released 1st press release of revised All India Index of Industrial Production with new base year of 2022-23=100
  - Quick Estimate of IIP – 4.9% growth in Apr 2026, with index standing at 118.9 (from 113.4 in Apr 2025)
- Revised series was developed under Technical Advisory Committee for Base Year Revision of IIP (TAC-IIP)
- Key structural change in new series – expansion from 3 sectors to 4 sectors
  - Mining & Quarrying (weight: 11.053%) | Manufacturing (weight: 76.062%)
  - Electricity & Gas Supply (weight: 10.865%) | Water Supply, Sewerage & Waste Management (weight: 2.020%)
- Sector-wise growth rates for Apr 2026 (over Apr 2025):
  - Manufacturing – 6.2% | Electricity & Gas Supply – 4.9%
  - Water Supply, Sewerage & Waste Management – 6.6% | Mining & Quarrying – (-) 5.1%
- Within Manufacturing sector, top 3 contributors:
  - Manufacture of Electrical Equipment (19.2%) | Manufacture of Machinery & Equipment n.e.c. (12.9%)
  - Manufacture of Motor Vehicles, Trailers & Semi-trailers (12.7%)
- Under Use-Based Classification, highest growth – Capital Goods (16%)
  - Top 3 contributors – Intermediate Goods, Capital Goods & Infrastructure/Construction Goods
- IIP – published monthly by Central Statistical Organisation (CSO)
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

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News - 311

- "World's Top 10 Richest People 2026" – released by Forbes
- World's richest person – Elon Musk (CEO of Tesla & SpaceX) with an estimated net worth of $835 billion
  - 2nd – Larry Page (co-founder of Alphabet Inc.) with an estimated net worth of $309 billion
  - 3rd – Sergey Brin (co-founder of Alphabet Inc.) with an estimated net worth of $285 billion
- Wealthiest non-American on list – Bernard Arnault (France)
  - He holds 9th position with an estimated net worth of $148 billion
- Youngest amongst 10 wealthiest individuals in world – Mark Zuckerberg (41 years)
  - He holds 7th position with an estimated net worth of $217 billion
- Wealth held by top 10 billionaires – nearly $2.9 trillion

Top 10 richest people in the world

Rank	Name	Net Worth (in USD)	Source
1.	Elon Musk	835 billion	SpaceX, Tesla
2.	Larry Page	309 billion	Google
3.	Sergey Brin	285 billion	Google
4.	Jeff Bezos	277 billion	Amazon
5.	Larry Ellison	276 billion	Oracle
6.	Michael Dell	244 billion	Dell Technologies
7.	Mark Zuckerberg	217 billion	Meta (Facebook)
8.	Jensen Huang	182 billion	Semiconductors
9.	Bernard Arnault	148 billion	LVMH
10.	Steve Ballmer	141 billion	Microsoft

News - 312

- India's equity markets slipped to 7th place globally in terms of market capitalisation on June 2, 2026
  - It is 2nd drop in rankings within 2 weeks, following India's earlier slip behind Taiwan in May 2026
- Combined market value of companies listed on S. Korea's KOSPI, KOSDAQ & KONEX exchanges – reached $5.01 trillion
  - Surpassing $4.85 trillion market capitalisation of firms listed on India's NSE
- India's benchmark indices declined 10.1% (Nifty 50) & 12.5% (BSE Sensex) in 2026, with Nifty IT index falling 19%
- Foreign investors pulled out $26.4 billion from Indian stocks in 2026
- India's share in MSCI Global Standard index – shrank to 12.3% (from 21% in Sep 2024)
- Global ranking as of Jun 2, 2026, places US, China, Japan, Taiwan & South Korea ahead of India, respectively

Join us

News - 313

- As per IRENA report, India became world's 2nd largest solar growth market in 2025 in annual solar capacity additions
  - 1st – China (adding nearly 315 GW of solar capacity in a single year)
- India added more than 37 GW of solar capacity in calendar year 2025, compared with 34 GW in US
- India's installed solar capacity – increased to 135.5 GW in 2025 (from 98.5 GW in 2024)
- US's installed solar capacity – increased to 211.6 GW in 2025 (from 177.6 GW in 2024)
- Globally, solar power capacity grew by 512 GW over the year, rising to 2,392 GW in 2025 (from 1,880 GW in 2024)
- As per MNRE, India surpassed Japan to become world's third-largest solar power producer in 2025
  - India generated 108,494 GWh of solar power during 2025 (compared with 96,459 GWh generated by Japan)
- In FY26, India recorded its highest-ever annual solar capacity addition of 44.6 GW (compared with 23.8 GW in FY25)

News - 314

- As per "Global Justice Report: A Plan for Equality & Prosperity Within Planetary Boundaries":
- India – to surpass China in its share of global GDP measured in Purchasing Power Parity (PPP) terms by around 2060
  - Under a 'Sustainable Convergence Scenario' modelling faster growth in developing economies
- China's share of world GDP – stands at ~20% in PPP terms
- China's share of global population – declined to ~17% in 2025 (from 23% of world population in 1945)
  - It is projected to fall below 8% by 2100
- At market exchange rates, India's nominal GDP – stands at ~$4.15 trillion in 2026
  - Behind – US ($32.38 trillion) & China ($20.85 trillion)
- India currently ranked world's 4th-largest economy by nominal GDP after US, China & Germany

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News - 315

- "Yearbook 2026: Armaments, Disarmament and International Security" – released by SIPRI
- As of Jan 2026, India expanded its nuclear arsenal to around 190 warheads (from 180)
  - Currently, India 12 deployed nuclear warheads & 178 stored warheads
- Other countries warheads: Pakistan – 170 | China – 620
- As of Jan 2026, 9 nuclear powers collectively have 12,187 warheads (9,745 were held in military stockpiles)
  - 9 nuclear powers – US, Russia, UK, France, China, India, Pakistan, North Korea & Israel
- India retained its position as world's 5th-largest military spender in 2025
  - Top 4 – US ($954 billion), China ($336 billion), Russia ($190 billion) & Germany
- India's military expenditure – $92.1 billion (an increase of 8.9% over previous year)
- India also remained world's 2nd-largest importer of major arms during 2021-25 period (8.2% of global arms imports)
- 5 largest arms importers – Ukraine, India, Saudi Arabia, Qatar & Pakistan
  - They collectively account for 35% of global imports
- Global military expenditure – surged for 11th consecutive year to $2.9 trillion in 2025 (2.5% of world's GDP)
- HQs of SIPRI – Stockholm, Sweden | Chair – Stefan Lofven

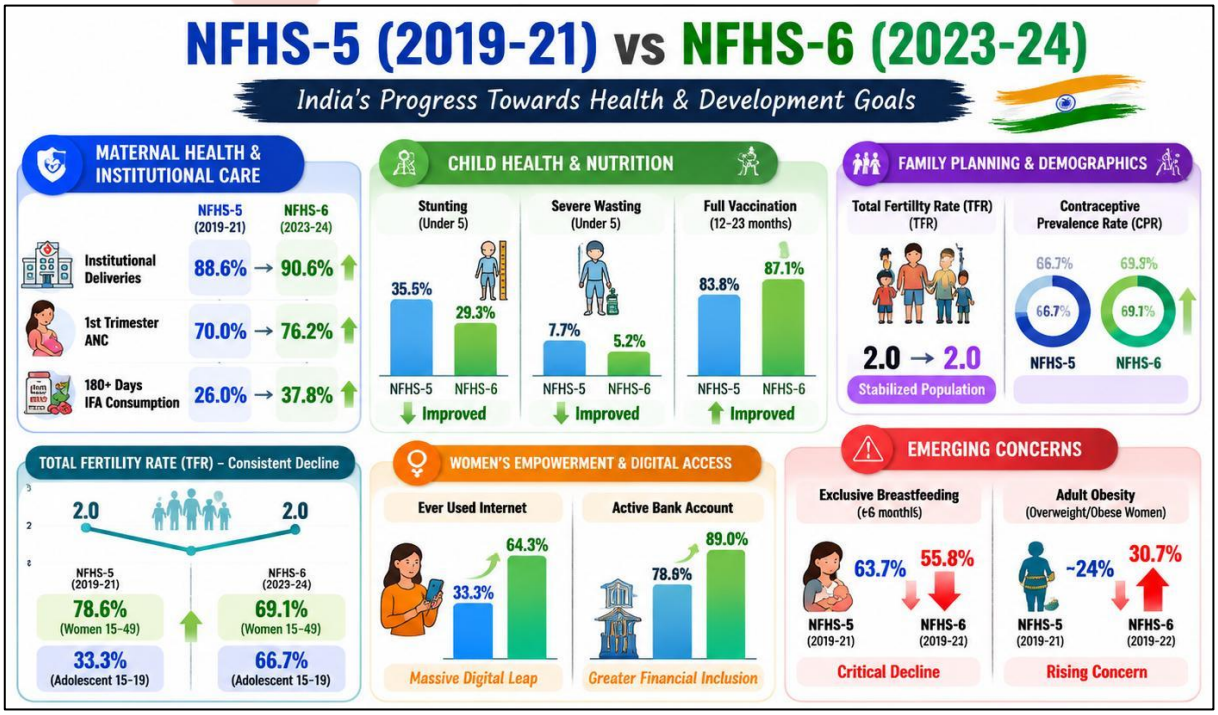
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News - 316

- "Immigrants and US Billion-Dollar Companies" – authored by Stuart Anderson
  - Published by – National Foundation for American Policy (US)
- India – leading country of origin for immigrant founders of US billion-dollar startups (unicorns)
  - With entrepreneurs born in India having founded or co-founded 96 US unicorns
- Followed by – Israel (60), UK (47), China (41), Canada (30), Russia (23), France (21), Germany (18), Ukraine (16), Australia (14), Pakistan (10) & Romania (10)
- Perplexity AI – among 96 India-linked unicorns & ranks 12th among highest-valued immigrant-founded US unicorns
  - Co-founded by – India-born Aravind Srinivas | Valued at – $20 billion
- Six India-origin founders have each founded 2 or more unicorns
  - Mohit Aron (Nutanix & Cohesity), Jyoti Bansal (AppDynamics & Harness), Ashutosh Garg (Bloomreach & Eightfold.ai), Arvind Jain, Sachin Nayyar & Ajeet Singh (Nutanix & ThoughtSpot)
- Immigrants founded or co-founded 59% of America's privately held startup unicorns
- Highest-valued US unicorns with at least one immigrant founder include SpaceX ($1.5 trillion), Anthropic ($965 billion) & OpenAI ($852 billion)

News - 317

- MoHFW released data for "National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6)" for period 2023-24
- NFHS-6 – conducted during 2023-24 by MoHFW
  - Nodal agency – International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai



Join us

News - 318

- India's social security coverage – expanded to 64.3% in 2025 (from 19% in 2015), covering 94.3 crore people
  - Under at least one social protection benefit
- India – 1st country globally to update its 2025 social protection coverage data on ILOSTAT platform
- In terms of beneficiary count, India ranks 2nd in world in social protection coverage (after China)
- Key contributing schemes (with beneficiary counts as of early 2026) include:
  - Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY) – 80.67 crore
  - Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY – 39.94 crore Ayushman Cards issued
  - PM Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY) – 58.09 crore
  - PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY) – 27.43 crore
  - e-Shram Portal – 31 crore unorganised workers (53.68% women) registered
  - Atal Pension Yojana (APY) – 9.04 crore

News - 319

- "Container Port Performance Index (CPPI)" for 2025 – published by World Bank and S&P Global Market Intelligence
- Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (Maharashtra) – India's best-performing container port at 22nd place globally
- JNPA has also featured among top 20 most improved ports globally over past 6 years
- APM Terminals-owned Pipavav Port (28th) – became best-performing private container port in India
  - It overtook Adani Ports & Special Economic Zone-owned Mundra Port (30th)
- Visakhapatnam Port – 104th position in 2025
- Overall, as per CPPI, 4 of world's 5 best-performing container ports in 2025 were in China

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News - 320

- 'Solar PV Potential of India (Floating Solar)' report (1st comprehensive national assessment) – NISE (under MNRE)
- India's reservoirs can host about 102 GW of floating solar capacity
- Floating solar plants – estimated to cost about 25% more upfront than ground-mounted ones
- Ground-mounted solar systems – dominate India's roughly 100 GW of installed solar capacity
- Land acquisition – continues to be a chokepoint as India pursues 500 GW of non-fossil capacity by 2030
- Bulk potential is in – Maharashtra (16.28 GW), MP (14.89 GW), Karnataka (13.69 GW), Odisha (12.81 GW) & Telangana (10.72 GW)
- Omkareshwar floating solar park on Narmada River Khandwa, MP – India's largest at 278 MW
- Globally, floating solar reached – 9.6 GW by 2024 (90% in Asia) | Leading countries – China, Singapore & Netherlands

Join us

News - 321

- "Global Peace Index 2026 (GPI 2026)" – released by Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)
- World's most peaceful country – Iceland (for 19th consecutive year)
  - Followed by – New Zealand, Switzerland, Slovenia & Ireland
- Lowest-ranked countries – Russia, Sudan, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Ukraine & Israel
- Country with highest improvement – Poland by securing 22nd place globally
- India – 127th position (from 115th in 2025)
- Most peaceful country in South Asia – Bhutan (ranked 16th globally)
  - Followed by – Sri Lanka (67th), Nepal (111th), Bangladesh (117th), India (127th), Pakistan (152nd) & Afghanistan (157th)

News - 322

- DAFW released 2nd Advance Estimates of Area & Production of Horticultural Crops for 2025-26
- Total horticulture production – 3,777.76 lakh tonne over an area of 301.51 lakh hectares
  - It is a growth of 1.90% in production & 0.05% in area over FY25 final estimates
- Production increases are projected across – Fruits, Vegetables, Flowers & Aromatic & Medicinal Plants
- Fruit production – 1,214.75 lakh tonne (up 3.25% from 1,176.49 lakh tonne in 2024-25)
- Growth in area of: Vegetable area – 0.75% to 118.79 lakh ha | Onion – 2.31% to 20.14 lakh ha
  - Flower – 4.00 lakh ha (+0.66%) | Plantation crops – 46.56 lakh ha | Spices – 50 lakh ha

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News - 323

- "Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT)" rankings for 2025 – released by World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO)
- Jio Platforms – climbed 320 places to break into global top 20
- JPL filed 6,817 patents cumulatively as of Mar 31, 2026
  - Of these, 2,393 patents have been filed in India & 4,424 across foreign jurisdictions
- Total 1,009 patents have been granted globally, comprising 538 grants in India & 471 in international markets
- HQs of Jio Platforms – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Group CEO – Mathew Oommen

News - 324

- As per data released by MoSPI, India's retail inflation – rose to 3.93% in May 2026 (from 3.48% in Apr 2026)
- CPI Inflation rates in May (compared from April):
  - Food Inflation – 4.78% (from 4.20%) | Food & beverages inflation – 4.55%
  - Rural inflation – 4.25% | Urban inflation – 3.53% | Rural food inflation – 4.85% | Urban food inflation – 4.66%
- Highest inflation among key items – Silver jewellery at 155.23%
- As per data released by MoC&I, WPI-based inflation – surged to 9.68% in May 2026 (from 8.26% in Apr 2026)
  - Under revised WPI series with new base year of 2022-23=100 (replacing earlier base year of 2011-12)
- WPI All Commodities Index – 109.9 in May (from 108.8 in Apr)

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- Highest WPI increase – Fuel & Power inflation to 30.33% in May (from 24.89% in Apr)
- Crude petroleum inflation – 61.51% (from 56.31% in Apr)
- Primary Articles inflation – 4.99% (from 3.78%) | Manufactured Products inflation – 7.48% (from 6.68%)
- WPI Food Index inflation – 4.49% (from 3.11%)

News - 325

- 3rd Annual Review of State Finances – released by CAG of India
- 18 of India's 28 states – exceeded fiscal deficit ceiling of 3% of GSDP in FY25
- Meghalaya – recorded steepest fiscal deficit at 8.69% of GSDP | Followed by – Nagaland (6.14%) & Sikkim (5.59%)
- 14 states – recorded an increase of more than 25% in fiscal deficit in FY25 over FY24 in absolute value terms
- Number of states recording a revenue surplus – declined to 13 in FY25 (from 16 in FY24)
- Bihar, Mizoram & Telangana – moved from revenue surplus to revenue deficit in FY25
- Total liabilities of states as on Mar 31, 2025 – ranged from 15.79% of GSDP (Odisha) to 52.84% of GSDP (Arunachal)
- Combined total liabilities of all states as a percentage of GSDP – increased to 27.89% in FY25 (from 24.19% in FY16)
- Indicative debt ceiling target – 32.8% of GSDP (set by 15th Finance Commission)
  - 13 states – recorded total liabilities exceeding this ceiling
- CAG – a Constitutional authority established under Article 148 of Indian Constitution

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News - 326

- "QS World University Rankings 2027" – released by QS Quacquarelli Symonds
- India's highest-ranked institution: IIT Delhi – climbed 5 places to 118th globally (from 123rd in QS 2026)
  - 2nd – IIT Bombay, slipped 5 places to 134th globally (from 129th in QS 2026)
- India – world's 4th most represented higher education system globally with 52 Indian universities
  - Top 3 – United States, United Kingdom & China
- India's representation in QS rankings – grown 271% since 2015, to 52 institutions (fastest among G20 nations)
- University of Delhi – ranked 322nd globally, retaining its position as 1st among Indian Universities (non-IITs)
  - It ranked 7th overall among all Indian higher education institutions
- Other top Indian institutions in QS 2027 include – IIT Madras, IIT Kharagpur, IISc Bangalore & IIT Kanpur
- Top institute globally – Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- HQs of QS – London, UK | CEO – Jessica Turner | Founded in – 1990

Join us

News - 327

- 14th "Global Startup Ecosystem Report (GSER) 2026" – released by Startup Genome at VivaTech, Paris
- Bengaluru (Karnataka) – ranked 15th among top 40 global startup ecosystems (from 14th in GSER 2025)
  - It also emerged as Asia's 2nd best AI-native cluster after Beijing (China) & 6th best startup ecosystem in Asia
  - Bengaluru's ecosystem value – stands at ~$152.8 billion, ranking it 4th in Asia by ecosystem value
- Top 3 positions – Silicon Valley, New York City & London
- It assesses ecosystems across 6 key success factors – Performance, Funding, Market Reach, Talent & Experience, AI-native Cluster and R&D Engine
- Among Indian ecosystems in Global Top 40, Bengaluru ranks 15th & Delhi ranks 31st
- Mumbai (not in Global Top 40) – debuted as #1 Emerging Startup Ecosystem globally in GSER 2026

News - 328

- 16th "Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026" – released by World Economic Forum
- Top 3 – Sweden, Finland & Denmark
  - Germany – 9th | France – 10th | UK – 11th | China – 14th | Brazil – 17th | US – 19th
- Singapore – one of biggest climbers, rising 10 places to 42nd
- India – ranked 70th with a 1.9% year-on-year score improvement
- HQs of WEF – Geneva, Switzerland | Co-Chairs (Board) – Laurence D. Fink & André Hoffmann | President & CEO – Alois Zwinggi | Established in – 1971

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News - 329

- 8th edition of "Trade Watch Quarterly" for Quarter 4 of FY2025-26 – released by NITI Aayog
- India's trade: Total merchandise & services trade – expand by 5.4% y-o-y to reach $1.84 trillion
  - Services trade – grown by 9.0%
- India retained its position as world's 8th-largest services exporter in 2025
  - With services exports recording a CAGR of 10.3% during 2015-2025
- Overall, India's total trade – reached $1.84 trillion during FY26, with exports growing by 4.2% & imports by 6.5%
- Global pharmaceutical & Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs) demand – estimated at ~$1.3 trillion in 2025
  - India exported pharmaceutical & API products worth $35.8 billion
- Telangana, Gujarat & Maharashtra – emerged as key pillars of India's pharmaceutical industry
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Nidhi Chhibber | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

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News - 330

- "QS World Future Skills Index 2027" – released by QS Quacquarelli Symonds
- India secured 13th position globally in AI-economy readiness, with an overall score of 89.4 out of 100
  - India emerged as highest-ranked country in South Asia & among lower-middle-income economies
- India's global ranks:
  - 5th – on 'Future of Work' indicator with an overall score of 96 out of 100
  - 14th – on 'Economic Transformation' with an overall score of 93.3 out of 100
  - 18th – on 'Skills Alignment' with an overall score of 82.7 out of 100
  - 22nd – on 'Academic Readiness' parameter with an overall score of 85.7 out of 100
- Top country globally – US (99.2) | Followed by – Australia (97.5) & UK (96.6)

QS World Future Skills Index 2027 — Top 15 Nations

Rank	Economy	Overall Score (/100)	Primary Strength
1	United States	99.2	Skills Alignment
2	Australia	97.5	Academic Readiness
3	United Kingdom	96.6	Academic Readiness
4	Germany	95.5	Future of Work
5	Canada	95.7	Academic Readiness
6	South Korea	95.4	Economic Transformation
7	China	92.5	Economic Transformation
8	Netherlands	91.9	Academic Readiness
9	Spain	91.7	Academic Readiness
10	Switzerland	91.6	Academic Readiness
11	France	91.2	Academic Readiness
12	Singapore	91.1	Economic Transformation
13	**India**	**89.4**	**Future of Work**
14	Sweden	89.2	Economic Transformation
15	Japan	89.0	Skills Alignment

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News - 331

- "State of World Fisheries and Aquaculture (SOFIA) 2026" report – released by FAO at 11th Our Ocean Conference in Mombasa, Kenya
- India – world's 2nd largest producer of aquatic animals (9% of global aquatic animal production in 2024)
  - 1st – China
- India – 1st in inland capture fisheries, producing 2.2 million tonnes
- India accounts for ~5% of global marine capture fisheries
- In aquaculture, India ranked 2nd globally, contributing 12% of total farmed aquatic animal output (after China)
- China, Indonesia, Vietnam, Bangladesh & India – together produce 82% of all farmed aquatic animals globally
- Total fisheries & aquaculture production (globally) – 235 million tonnes in 2024

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- Aquaculture production surpassed 100 million tonnes of aquatic animals for 1st time, valued at $371 billion at farm gate
- Trade in aquatic animal products – reached $184 billion
- Biologically sustainable marine fish stocks – declined to 62.4% in 2023 (from 64.5% in 2021)
- India's total fish production for FY25 – 197.75 lakh tonnes
- India's flagship fisheries scheme – 'Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)'
  - It was launched in 2020 with an investment of ₹20,050 Cr
- HQs of FAO – Rome, Italy | DG – Dr. Qu Dongyu | Founded in – 1945

News - 332

- 20th edition of "Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026" – released by IEP (Sydney)
- India – ranked 127th with an overall score of 2.409 (from 115th in GPI 2025)
- South Asia – recorded largest regional deterioration among all world regions | Average score – worsened by 2.3%
- South Asia rankings: Bhutan – 16th (most peaceful in South Asia) | Sri Lanka – 67th (region's biggest improvement)
  - Nepal – 111th (region's biggest decliner) | Bangladesh – 117th | India – 127th
  - Pakistan – 152nd | Afghanistan – 157th
- Top country – Iceland (for 19th consecutive year) | Followed by – New Zealand, Switzerland, Slovenia & Ireland
- World's least peaceful country – Russia | Followed by – Sudan, Democratic Republic of Congo, Ukraine & Israel
- Global peacefulness – declined for 12th consecutive year
  - 99 countries – registered deterioration | Active state-based conflicts – 61
  - Global economic impact of violence – rose 3.2% to $21.81 trillion
  - Global military expenditure – reached $2.9 trillion
- Ranks of: USA – 134th | China – 118th
- GPI – conceived by Steve Killelea AM & has been published annually since 2008

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News - 333

- 'International Supercomputing Conference (ISC 2026)' – held in Hamburg, Germany
- 67th "TOP500 List of the World's Most Powerful Supercomputers" – topped by 'LineShine', a system installed at National Supercomputing Centre in Shenzhen (NSCS), China
  - Built by – Shenzhen Cloud Computing Center
- It makes China world's top supercomputing nation for 1st time since Sunway TaihuLight held No. 1 position in 2017
- LineShine achieved 2.198 Exaflop/s on High Performance Linpack (HPL) benchmark
  - 1st system on TOP500 to exceed 2 Exaflops of sustained performance using CPUs, with no GPUs or AI accelerators
- LineShine – also holds No. 1 position on HPCG benchmark & ranks 4th on HPL-MxP benchmark
- TOP 10 for June 2026:
  - 1st – LineShine (China) with 2.198 Exaflop/s | 2nd – El Capitan (US) with 1.809 Exaflop/s
  - 3rd – Frontier (US) with 1.353 Exaflop/s | 4th – Aurora (US) with 1.012 Exaflop/s

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- 5th – JUPITER Booster (Germany/EuroHPC) with 1.000 Exaflop/s | 6th – HPC7 (Italy) with 571.5 Petaflop/s
- 7th – Eagle (US) with 561.2 Petaflop/s | 8th – HPC6 (Italy) with 477.9 Petaflop/s
- 9th – Fugaku (Japan) with 442 Petaflop/s | 10th – Alps (Switzerland) with 434.9 Petaflop/s

- LineShine – 5th system globally to reach Exascale
- On HPL-MxP (mixed-precision) benchmark, El Capitan retains No. 1 at 16.7 Exaflop/s | LineShine – 4th
- TOP500 – published biannually (June & November) | It was 1st compiled in June 1993

Amount & Agreements

News - 334

- ADB + Standard Chartered Bank = signed agreements to strengthen supply chain finance in India
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69
- HQs of SCB India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – P. D. Singh

News - 335

- IFC – committed $50 million to Hygenco Green Energies Pvt Ltd, Gurugram, as part of $105 million equity investment
- Consortium includes – IFC, Siemens Financial Services, CTF, Frontier Opportunities Fund & Fullerton Carbon Action Fund
  - It is the first direct green hydrogen equity investment in India by IFC, Siemens & Fullerton
- Consortium – aims to pioneer 'Hydrogen-as-a-Service' model | projects creation of 1,000+ direct jobs over 5 years
- India's National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM) launched Jan 2023 with ₹19,744 Cr outlay
  - It targets 5 million MT green hydrogen annually by 2030
- HQs of IFC – Washington, U.S. | MD – Makhtar Diop | IFC India's Head – Wendy Werner (an arm of World Bank)

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News - 336

- Ethereal Machines – raised $28.5 million in a Series B funding round led by Avataar Ventures
- Ethereal Machines – currently operates a fully automated smart manufacturing unit in Peenya, Bengaluru
- Ethereal Machines + Karnataka = an MoU to establish a 300,000-square-foot mega factory in Bengaluru
- Manufacturing sector – contributes roughly 17% of India's GDP
- HQs of Ethereal Machines – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Kaushik Mudda | Established in – 2014

News - 337

- ADB + SIL = a $10 million financing package to improve learning outcomes for 4.5 million students
  - It is ADB's 1st private sector financing for a digital education project in India
- Financing package comprises: $5 million loan – from ADB's private sector operations
  - $5 million – from LEAP 2 (an infrastructure fund managed by ADB & co-funded by JICA)
- Under this project, at least 1,000 schools will receive computer labs & 58,000 digital classrooms will be established

Join us

- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69
- HQs of Schoolnet India Ltd – Noida, UP | MD & CEO – RCM Reddy | Established in – 1997

News - 338

- World Bank's Board of Executive Directors approved $1.5 billion in financing to support India's structural reforms
  - To boost private sector-led job creation & economic growth under Boosting Job Creation in Private Sector Development Policy Financing (DPF) Operation
- DPF Operation – aligned with World Bank Group's Country Partnership Framework for India for FY26-31
- In Nov 2025, government consolidated 29 labour laws into 4 comprehensive Labour Codes
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

News - 339

- IFC announced a sustainability-linked financial package of INR equivalent of $371 million for Sify Infinit Spaces Ltd (SISL)
  - To support development of AI-ready, energy-efficient digital infrastructure in India
- It comprises a direct IFC investment of $71 mn & IFC-supported debt mobilisation of up to $300 mn from other investors
- SISL will use financing to develop 2 next-generation data centers in Navi Mumbai & Chennai
  - Combined capacity – 103 MW
- AI is projected to contribute up to $500 billion to India's economy by 2030
- HQs of IFC – Washington, U.S. | MD – Makhtar Diop | IFC India's Head – Wendy Werner (an arm of World Bank)

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News - 340

- Amazon – raised its 2026-2030 India investment plan from $35 billion to $48 billion
  - With over $21 billion earmarked for AI & cloud infrastructure
  - Additional $13 billion – to strengthen AWS's Mumbai & Hyderabad regions
- Amazon also launched 'Sammaan' programme for delivery associates
- HQs of Amazon – Seattle, US | CEO – Andy Jassy | Incorporated in – 1994

Join us

Ordinance, Bills & Acts

News - 341

- MHA – notified "Immigration and Foreigners (Amendment) Rules, 2026", effective immediately
  - Under Section 30 of 'Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025'
- It is the parent legislation passed by Parliament in Apr 2025 that consolidated & replaced four earlier laws:
  - 'Passport (Entry into India) Act, 1920' | 'Registration of Foreigners Act, 1939'
  - 'Foreigners Act, 1946' | 'Immigration (Carriers' Liability) Act, 2000'
- This amendment introduces four key changes to 'Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025'
  - Foreigners on visas valid for 180 days or less who wish to extend their stay must now complete registration at any time before expiry of 180-day period
  - Foreigners on long-term visas that carry a condition that each stay shall not exceed 180 days & who wish to remain beyond that limit on any single visit or in aggregate in an FY must register before expiry of 180-day period
  - For 1st time, a person affected by any immigration order may file an online appeal with Commissioner of Bureau of Immigration within 30 days of receiving order
  - Requirement to inform registration officer within 30 days of a child's birth in India has been removed in cases where at least one parent is an Indian citizen & family wishes to retain child's Indian citizenship
    - However, if child subsequently acquires foreign citizenship while residing in India, either parent must notify registration officer within 30 days of that acquisition
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

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News - 342

- MIB – published draft "Telecommunications (Television, Radio and Associated Services) Rules, 2026"
  - For public & inter-ministerial consultation | Comments to be invited by – Jul 27, 2026
- Draft rules are framed under 'Telecommunications Act, 2023' & have been prepared by MIB
- It consolidates 6 separate standalone guidelines into a single unified regulatory framework:
  (1) Policy Guidelines for Uplinking & Downlinking of Satellite Television Channels in India (Nov 9, 2022)
  (2) Guidelines for Direct-to-Home (DTH) Broadcasting Services (Mar 15, 2001, as amended)
  (3) Guidelines for Headend-in-the-Sky (HITS) Broadcasting Services (Nov 26, 2009)
  (4) Policy Guidelines for Expansion of FM Radio Broadcasting Services through Private Agencies, Phase III (Jul 25, 2011, as amended up to Sep 10, 2024)
  (5) Revised Policy Guidelines for Community Radio Stations (Feb 13, 2024)
  (6) Guidelines for Internet Protocol Television (IPTV) Services (Sep 8, 2008)
- Key features of draft rules include: 'Change with Continuity' & 'Ease of Doing Business'

Join us

- They will replace all 6 existing guidelines governing television & radio broadcasting sector
- Minister of Information and Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships

News - 343

- TCS + Mistral AI (France) = partnered to build frontier-grade AI models using proprietary enterprise knowledge & domain-specific data
  - TCS became 1st global systems integrator partner for Mistral Forge
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968
- HQs of Mistral AI – Paris, France | CEO – Arthur Mensch | Established in – 2023

News - 344

- NISM + Galgotias University (Greater Noida) = collaborated to strengthen professional learning opportunities in securities markets, financial services, derivatives, investment ecosystems, fintech & risk management
- Galgotias University houses a School of Business & a Centre for Capital Market Simulation
- HQs of NISM – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Director – Sashi Krishnan

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News - 345

- Odisha + Intel Corporation + 3DGS Inc. (USA) = an MoU establishing a framework to set up an "Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility" in Bhubaneswar-Khurda region of Odisha
  - Estimated investment – $3.3 billion
- It will be implemented in phases over 5-6 years
- The project builds on existing approved project of 3D Glass Solutions Inc. (3DGS) in Info Valley, Khordha
- Odisha – emerged as only Indian state hosting both a commercial compound semiconductor fabrication unit & an advanced 3D glass substrate packaging facility under Semiconductor Mission
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati
- HQs of Intel – California, US | Chairman – Dr Craig H Barratt | CEO – Lip-Bu Tan | Funded in – 1968
- HQs of 3DGS Inc. – Albuquerque, USA | President & CEO – Mark Popovich | Established in – 2005

News - 346

- Centre signed MoUs with Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland & Puducherry under 'JJM 2.0' to enhance safe drinking water supply in rural India
- JJM 2.0 – gram panchayat-led, service-based, community-centred rural water governance

Join us

- Aim: Tap water connections to all 19.36 Cr rural households by Dec 2028

- Cabinet approved extension of JJM till Dec 2028 with enhanced outlay Rs 8.69 lakh Cr

News - 347

- Meesho + BSE Ltd = an MoU to launch "Project Shikhar"
- Under this programme, over next year Meesho & BSE will screen & onboard eligible sellers on BSE SME platform
- HQs of BSE – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Subhasis Chaudhuri | MD & CEO – Sundararaman Ramamurthy
- HQs of Meesho – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Vidit Aatrey | CTO – Sanjeev Barnwal | Established in – 2015

News - 348

- DPIIT + DIBD = an MoU to strengthen multilingual digital access across India's investment & business ecosystem
- Aim: To enhance access to government information, startup services, policy communication & citizen-centric services
  - In all 22 languages listed in Eighth Schedule of Constitution through BHASHINI platform
- Agreement was signed under 'BHASHINI Seva/Sanchalan - A BHASHINI Sahayogi Program'
- BHASHINI (BHASHa INterface for India) – India's AI-led language translation platform
  - It is a part of – 'National Language Translation Mission'
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)

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News - 349

- Telangana + Thuringia (Germany) = signed MoU on cooperation in technology, skill training, startups & life sciences
- Thuringia will support reshaping skilling curriculum under Young India Skills University (YISU), Advanced Technology Centres (ATCs) & polytechnic institutes
  - German language training centre will be established in Hyderabad
- Telangana + South Africa = agreed to cooperate in skilled workforce & medical tourism sectors
- Telangana: Capital – Hyderabad | CM – A. Revanth Reddy | Governor – Shiv Pratap Shukla

News - 350

- West Bengal Legislative Assembly – becomes 33rd Legislature to join National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)
  - Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs + West Bengal Govt + West Bengal Legislative Assembly = a tripartite MoU
- 21 Legislatures have fully transitioned to digital functioning via NeVA
- NeVA – a mission-mode project to digitise & modernise Legislature functioning across India via common digital platform
- Minister of Parliamentary Affairs: Kiren Rijiju | Constituency – Arunachal West, Arunachal Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs: Arjun Ram Meghwal & L. Murugan

Join us

News - 351

- Tamil Nadu + L&T = MoU to implement 3 projects, with an investment of Rs 18,600 Cr & employment for 8,200 persons
- Projects covered under MoU include:
  - A Hyperscale & Edge AI data centre in Kancheepuram with an investment of Rs 15,000 Cr
  - An electronics manufacturing hub in Coimbatore with an investment of Rs 2,500 Cr
  - An offshore wind infrastructure at Kattupalli in Tiruvallur with an investment of Rs 1,100 Cr
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar
- HQs of L&T – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO & MD – S. N. Subrahmanyan | President – R Shankar Raman

News - 352

- Himachal Pradesh + UNDP = an MoU to promote climate-resilient, inclusive & sustainable development across state
- Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (CM of HP) – launched 'Safai Mitra Scheme'
  - To empower informal waste management workers & enhance their dignity, safety & socio-economic well-being
- HP: Capital – Shimla & Dharamshala | CM – Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu | Governor – Kavinder Gupta

News - 353

- West Bengal + NHA = an MoU for implementation of 'AB PM-JAY'
  - making West Bengal 36th & final State/UT to join this central scheme
- With inclusion – all 28 States & 8 UTs now implementing 'AB PM-JAY'
- West Bengal – previously operated 'Swasthya Sathi' (2016) and had declined AB PM-JAY under prior Govt
- Delhi – 35th State/UT joined in March 2026
- AB PM-JAY – launched Sep 23, 2018 from Ranchi, Jharkhand | provides free treatment up to ₹5 lakh per family per year
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi
- HQs of NHA – New Delhi | CEO – Sunil Kumar Barnwal | Founded in – 2018

News - 354

- Air India + Riyadh Air = an MoU to establish foundation for a partnership to boost global connectivity for travellers flying between India, Saudi Arabia & beyond
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Campbell Wilson (subsidiary of Tata Group)

News - 355

- DDWS (MoJS) + Sikkim = an MoU to strengthen rural water supply infrastructure under "Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0"
- Cabinet approved, in Mar 2026, extension of JJM period up to Dec 2028 | Enhanced total outlay – Rs 8.69 lakh Cr
- JJM 2.0 aims for certification of all Gram Panchayats as 'Har Ghar Jal' by provisioning tap water connections to all
- Sikkim: Capital – Gangtok | CM – Prem Singh Tamang | Governor – Om Prakash Mathur

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Join us

News - 356

- RIL + Meta = an agreement for a data centre project in Jamnagar, Gujarat
- RIL – to develop a data centre with 168 MW capacity to be delivered within 2 years
  - It will be powered by renewable energy & cooled with desalinated seawater
- In 2020, Meta invested $5.7 billion to buy a 9.98% stake in Jio Platforms
- Jamnagar will also be connected to Meta's 'Project Waterworth'
- HQs of Reliance Industries Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Mukesh Ambani | Founded in – 1973
- HQs of Meta – California, US | CEO – Mark Zuckerberg | Founded in – 2004

News - 357

- CSIR-CRRI + Haryana = a Memorandum of Agreement (MoA) for implementation of project titled "The Implementation of the Standard Framework for Paving and Greening of Urban Roads (Haryana State)" at CSIR-CRRI, New Delhi
- To be implemented jointly by – CSIR-CRRI + School of Planning & Architecture (New Delhi), in collab. with Haryana govt
  - Under guidance of Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)
- CAQM issued 'Standard Framework and Detailed Guidance Document for Paving and Greening of Urban Roads'
  - Based on recommendations developed by CSIR-CRRI
- It will focus on 4 major work packages:

  (i) Development of space standards & road cross-sections

  (ii) Mitigation of road dust through greening measures within right-of-way

  (iii) Improvement of road maintenance practices through a Road Asset Management System (RAMS)

  (iv) Adoption of innovative technologies for road construction & maintenance
- HQs of CSIR-CRRI – New Delhi | Director – Dr. Chalumuri Ravi Sekhar | Established in – 1952
- Haryana: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Nayab Singh Saini | Governor – Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh

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News - 358

- BSNL + IIT Kanpur = an MoU for joint research, development, testing, deployment & commercialisation of next-generation telecom technologies
- HQs of BSNL – New Delhi | CMD – Robert Jerard Ravi (additional charge)
- Director of IIT Kanpur – Prof. Manindra Agrawal

News - 359

- TCS + Canada Life = a multiyear transformation & managed services agreement
  - To modernise Canada Life's IT infrastructure services across its European businesses
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968
- HQs of Canada Life – Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada | President & CEO – Fabrice Morin | Established in – 1847

Join us

News - 360

- GoI + Assam + Nagaland = a tripartite MoU for exploration & production of crude oil & natural gas in these states
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya
- Nagaland: Capital – Kohima | CM – Neiphiu Rio | Governor – Nand Kishore Yadav

News - 361

- OIL + PTRC (Canada) = a collaboration framework to jointly explore carbon capture, utilisation & storage (CCUS), geothermal energy, subsurface energy technologies & innovation-led research
- HQs of OIL – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | CMD – Arvinder Singh Sahney | Founded in – 1959

News - 362

- QCI + FDDI = an MoU to strengthen quality, testing, accreditation & skilling ecosystem in Bharat's leather & footwear sector
- QCI – a premier autonomous body established by Government of India | Nodal department for QCI – DPIIT
- HQs of QCI – New Delhi | Chairman – Jaxay Shah | Secretary General – Chakravarthy T Kannan | Established – 1997
- HQs of FDDI – Noida, UP | Chairman – Ashish Dikshit | Director – Arun Kumar Sinha | Established in – 1986

News - 363

- NLCIL + CSIR-CECRI = an MoU for collaboration in critical & strategic minerals beneficiation & extraction technologies
- HQs of NLCIL – Neyveli, Tamil Nadu | CMD – Prasanna Kumar Motupalli
- HQs of CSIR-CECRI – Karaikudi, Tamil Nadu | Director – Dr. K. Ramesha | Established in – 1953

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News - 364

- Indian Army + Bharti Airtel = pact to strengthen mobile network infrastructure in remote areas of West Kameng (Ar. P)
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Upendra Dwivedi | Vice Chief – Lt. Gen. Dheeraj Seth
- HQs of Bharti Airtel – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Shashwat Sharma | Chairman – Sunil Bharti Mittal

News - 365

- DIBD + GeM = an MoU to strengthen multilingual digital capabilities across India's public procurement ecosystem
  - Through BHASHINI Platform, India's National Language Digital Public Infrastructure
  - Under framework "BHASHINI for Seva/Sanchalan - A BHASHINI Sahayogi Program"
- It will advance 'Voice First' language technology infrastructure
- BHASHINI – currently powers over 800 government websites, processes more than 15 million inferences daily
  - Supports 36 Indian text languages, 23 Indian voice languages & 35 international languages
  - Through National Hub for Language Technology (NHLT)
- HQs of Bhashini – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag
- HQs of GeM – New Delhi | CEO – Mihir Kumar | Established in – 2016

Join us

News - 366

- IIT Hyderabad + CEEPL India + Dassault Systèmes = a tripartite MoU to establish 'CODENE', India's 1st dedicated nuclear engineering design centre
  - CODENE – Centre of Design Excellence in Nuclear Engineering
  - At – "Bharat Innovates 2026" conclave in Nice, France
- CODENE will leverage Dassault Systèmes' "3DEXPERIENCE" platform & simulation-based digital twin technologies
- Director of IIT Hyderabad – Prof. Budaraju Srinivasa Murty
- HQs of CEEPL India – Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh | CEO – H.V. Sreekanta Babu | Established in – 2000
- HQs of Dassault Systèmes – Vélizy-Villacoublay, France | Chairman & CEO – Pascal Daloz

News - 367

- Underwater Archaeology Wing (ASI) + 'National Museum of Denmark: Njord - Center for Maritime and Underwater Cultural Heritage' (Copenhagen) = an MoU to undertake a collaborative underwater archaeological project
  - To locate & document remains of Danish ship "Oresund", wrecked off coast near Karaikal, Puducherry, in 1619 CE
- It marks 1st collaborative archaeological project undertaken by ASI's Underwater Archaeology Wing with an international organisation
- ASI's Underwater Archaeology Wing – established in 2001 under Ministry of Culture
- HQs of ASI – New Delhi | Director General – Yadubir Singh Rawat | Established in – 1861

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News - 368

- HP + Uttarakhand + Haryana + Delhi + UP + Rajasthan = an MoU for long-pending 422MW Kishau Dam project
- Ratio of cost sharing of water component between Centre & participating 6 states = 90% : 10%
- HP's share of water will be allocated to Delhi & Rajasthan in return for sharing cost of HP's portion of power component
  - It amounts to – ~Rs 2,000 Cr
- Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project – planned on Tons River, along border of Uttarakhand & Himachal Pradesh
  - Height – 236-metre | It will generate 660 MW of hydroelectric power
- HP: Capital – Shimla & Dharamshala | CM – Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu | Governor – Kavinder Gupta
- Uttarakhand: Capital – Dehradun & Gairsain | CM – Pushkar Singh Dhami | Governor – Lt. Gen. Gurmit Singh
- Haryana: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Nayab Singh Saini | Governor – Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel
- Rajasthan: Capital – Jaipur | CM – Bhajan Lal Sharma | Governor – Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde

Join us

News - 369

- Ashok Leyland + Switch Mobility + MoRTH = an MoU to implement a major commercial vehicle (old trucks & buses) replacement scheme in Delhi-NCR region
- Ashok Leyland & Switch Mobility – become 1st OEMs to partner with government for implementation of scheme
- Companies will provide an 8% discount on ex-showroom price of eligible trucks & buses purchased under scheme
  - For EVs, discount will be capped at discount applicable to an ICE vehicle of equivalent Gross Vehicle Weight category
- Centre will provide 5% interest subvention & fixed monthly fuel vouchers for 5 years
- Participating state governments will provide up to 100% concession on motor vehicle tax for 10 years & waiver of registration fees for eligible beneficiaries under scheme
- HQs of Ashok Leyland – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Chairman – Dheeraj G Hinduja | MD & CEO – Shenu Agarwal
- Minister of Road Transport & Highways: Nitin Gadkari | Constituency – Nagpur, Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: Ajay Tamta & Harsh Malhotra

News - 370

- Jeh Aerospace (Hyderabad) + Solestra Group = signed a multi-year, multi-million-dollar manufacturing agreement
  - They also inaugurated a dedicated Global Manufacturing Center (GMC) at Jeh Aerospace's facility in Hyderabad
- Solestra-Jeh partnership is company's 2nd major dedicated manufacturing arrangement
  - After a similar agreement with GS Precision (US) in May 2024
- HQs of Jeh Aerospace – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Vishal R. Sanghavi | Established in – 2022
- HQs of Solestra Group – North America (Multi-site Operations) | CEO – Joe DeMartino | Rebranded in – 2025

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News - 371

- Gujarat + HUDCO = an MoU for long-term financial assistance of up to Rs 1 Lakh Cr over 2 yrs, starting from May 2026
  - To accelerate infrastructure development across state
- Gujarat + IIM Ahmedabad= an MoU to undertake pre-feasibility studies, feasibility assessments, preparation of Detailed Project Reports (DPRs) & impact evaluations for various projects envisioned under Viksit Gujarat 2047 initiative
- HUDCO – a Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise under MoHUA (with 75% Government of India equity)
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat
- HQs of HUDCO – New Delhi | CMD – Sanjay Kulshrestha | Established in – 1970

News - 372

- MoRTH + OEMs = two MoUs for implementation of GoI's scheme for replacement of old trucks & buses in Delhi-NCR
  - 1st MoU – with Ashok Leyland & Switch Mobility (1st OEMs to partner with Govt for scheme's implementation)
  - 2nd MoU – with Tata Motors
- Under both MoUs, OEMs will provide an 8% discount on ex-showroom price of eligible trucks & buses purchased under scheme

Join us

- Central Government – to provide 5% interest subvention & fixed monthly fuel vouchers for 5 yrs to eligible beneficiaries
- Participating State Governments – to provide up to 100% concession on Motor Vehicle Tax for 10 yrs & waiver of registration fees
- Minister of Road Transport & Highways: Nitin Gadkari | Constituency – Nagpur, Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: Ajay Tamta & Harsh Malhotra

News - 373

- GeM + CSC-SPV = an MoU to expand government procurement access in rural & underserved regions
- As a pilot, 50 'GeM Suvidha Kendras (GSKs)' – to be established through CSC network across 9 states & UTs
  - Delhi-NCR, Maharashtra, UP, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, Telangana & West Bengal
- HQs of GeM – New Delhi | CEO – Mihir Kumar | Established in – 2016

News - 374

- Maharashtra School Education Department + 'Google for Education' = an MoU to provide AI & digital technology training to more than 4 lakh teachers
- It will provide localised training content in – Marathi, Hindi & English
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma

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News - 375

- IITM (Pune) + ARIES (Nainital) = an MoU (valid for 50+ years) to establish a "Climate Observation Station"
  - At – ARIES' Devasthal campus in Uttarakhand's Himalayan region, as part of Bharat Climate Observation Network
- Its data will serve as critical validation input for Earth System Models, including IITM Earth System Model (IITM-ESM)
  - IITM-ESM – India's 1st Earth System Model
- BCON – a national observational programme conceptualised & implemented by IITM under MoES
- ARIES (Nainital) – a research institute under Department of Science & Technology (DST)
  - It houses Asia's largest optical telescope – 3.6-metre Devasthal Optical Telescope (DOT) at its Devasthal campus
- HQs of ARIES – Nainital, Uttarakhand | Director – Dr. Manish Kumar Naja | Established in – 2004

News - 376

- NHAI + NCAER = an MoU to establish NHAI Centre for Economics of Transportation, Mobility & Logistics
- An Advisory Committee will guide it | NHAI's Member (Finance) & DG of NCAER will also be part of committee
- HQs of NHAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Santosh Kumar Yadav | Founded in – 1988
- HQs of NCAER – New Delhi | Director General – Suresh Goyal

Join us

News - 377

- CAG of India & Supreme Audit Institution (Israel) = an MoU to enhance cooperation in public sector auditing
- CAG of India – K. Sanjay Murthy

News - 378

- Safran Electronics & Defence (France) + SatSure = an MoU to collaborate on geospatial intelligence (GEOINT) solutions for Indian market
- HQs of SatSure – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-founder & CEO – Prateep Basu

News - 379

- DIBD (MeitY) + AISF (Assam) = an MoU to promote language technology, Generative AI solutions & governance in vernacular languages across Assam
- DIBD & AISF will collaborate under 'BHASHINI Rajyam' initiative to facilitate multilingual access to AISF's programmes
- BHASHINI (BHASha INterface for India) – India's national AI-driven multilingual digital inclusion initiative
  - Under MeitY's National Hub for Language Technology (NHLT)
- HQs of Bhashini – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag

News - 380

- NSE + BME = an MoU to jointly promote development, awareness & adoption of non-ferrous metal derivatives in India
  - To strengthen price risk management across country's copper, aluminium, zinc, lead & nickel ecosystem
- India is one of world's largest consumers of industrial metals including copper, aluminium, zinc, lead & nickel
- HQs of NSE – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Girish Chandra Chaturvedi | MD & CEO – Ashishkumar Chauhan
- HQs of Bharat Metal Exchange Ltd – Mumbai | Chairman – Rikab Mehta | President – Sushil Kothari

News - 381

- AP + Google = to establish a special joint task force to collaborate on AI, cloud computing & digital governance
- Andhra Pradesh's technology-led healthcare initiative, 'Sanjeevani Project' – seeks to deliver accessible & efficient healthcare services through digital technologies
- CM met Anacláudia Rossbach (Ex. Dr.) UN-Habitat & invited organisation to establish a CoE in Andhra Pradesh
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

News - 382

- ASSOCHAM + ACCI (Afghanistan) = an MoU to boost bilateral trade, investment & business cooperation
  - On sidelines of 'Bharat Buildcon International Exhibition' in New Delhi
- It focuses on 5 sectors – Mining, Food Processing, Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare, Oil & Gas, and Sugar Manufacturing
- Aim: To expand current bilateral trade, which stands at ~$1 billion

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- India & Afghanistan – members of South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA)
- India also reactivated Joint Working Group on Trade, Commerce & Investment with Afghanistan
- HQs of ASSOCHAM – New Delhi | President – Nirmal K. Minda | SG – Manish Singhal | Established in – 1920

News - 383

- BharathCloud + ICSI (Pune) = an MoU to extend purpose-built, India-hosted cloud solutions to Company Secretaries & ICSI members across India
- Special pricing arrangement will remain available for 2 years from date of MoU
- ICSI – a statutory professional body established under 'Company Secretaries Act, 1980'
- HQs of BharathCloud – Hyderabad, Telangana | Co-Founders – Rahul Takkallapally & Padma Reddy Sama
- HQs of ICSI – New Delhi | President – CS Pawan G Chandak | Established in – 1980

News - 384

- MoSPI + GRAAM = signed a Statement of Intent (SoI) for engagement of two Fellows
- Aim: To leverage Fellows' skills for benefit of Ministry while providing Fellows with practical experience in public policy & governance
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana
- HQs of GRAAM – Mysuru, Karnataka | Founder – Dr. R. Balasubramaniam | Chairman – Arjun Ranga

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❖ Important Obituaries in June 2026:

- **Dr. Bashir Badr** – a Renowned Urdu Poet
  (Awards: Padma Shri in 1999, Sahitya Akademi Award (Urdu) in 1999)
- **Dhanendra Kumar** – Former Bureaucrat & 1st Chairman of Competition Commission of India (CCI)
- **Suman Kalyanpur** – Veteran Indian Playback Singer
  (Padma Bhushan in 2023)
- **Subhash C. Kashyap** – Eminent Constitutional Expert, Author, and Former Lok Sabha Secretary-General
- **Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal** ("Baba Dhaliwal'') – Legendary Indian Shot Putter
  (Arjuna Award in 1987, Maharaja Ranjit Singh Award in 1983)
- **Salim Kumar –** a Malayalam Actor
  (National Film Award for Best Actor in 2010)
- **Pahlaj Nihalani** – Veteran Producer
  (He served as the Chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification from January 2015 to August 2017)
- **Jaspal Rana** – Indian Shooting Legend & Coach
  (Awards: Arjuna Award in 1994, Padma Shri in 1997)

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- **Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol** – Princess of Thailand
  (She served as Thailand's Ambassador to Austria and Slovakia, and was recognized as a prominent UN Goodwill Ambassador.)
- **Bharathiraja** ("Iyakkunar Imayam'') – Veteran Tamil Filmmaker & Actor
  (Padma Shri in 2004)
- **Gavri Devi** (Rajasthan) – Renowned Mand Folk Singer
  (Mand music - one of the oldest folk musical styles of Rajasthan)
- **Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi** – Former Vice Chief of Army Staff
  (He was the founder-director of the Centre for Land Warfare Studies (CLAWS).)
  (Awards: Param Vishisht Seva Meda in 1998, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM), Vishisht Seva Medal, Sena Medal (SM))
- **Robert A.F. Thurman** (USA) – a renowned scholar of Tibetan Buddhism, Author, Translator, Educator
  (He received India's Padma Shri (Literature and Education) in 2020)

❖ Important One-liner Meetings, Conferences & Summits in June 2026:

- 4th India-Africa Forum Summit – New Delhi
  (Theme - "IA SPIRIT: India-Africa Strategic Partnership for Innovation, Resilience, and Inclusive Transformation.")
- Global Business Research Conference (GBRC) 2026 – IIFT, New Delhi
  (Theme - "Managing Business Amidst Worldwide Turbulence")
- 8th India-Indonesia Joint Commission Meeting (JCM) – New Delhi
- BRICS Agriculture Conference – Indore, Madhya Pradesh
- West African Hydrographic Summit (WAHS) 2026 – Abuja & Lagos, Nigeria

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❖ Some Important Species found in June 2026:

- "Mesalina bishnoi", a new species of lizard – discovered in Bikaner, Rajasthan
  (It marks the first confirmed record of the genus Mesalina in India)
- "Caracal", a rare wild cat – spotted in Kuno National Park in Sheopur, Madhya Pradesh
- "Hamataliwa mawlyngot", a new species of Lynx Spider – discovered by ZSI & University of Calcutta in Meghalaya
- "Antaram idukki" & "Mimeusemia kali", new species of moth – discovered in Western Ghats (Kerala & Karnataka)

❖ Appointments of some Important Brand Ambassadors in June 2026:

- Shah Rukh Khan – Brand Ambassador of 'Infinitely More' campaign of Visa Inc.

❖ Grand Prix Winners in June 2026:

- Monaco Grand Prix 2026 – Andrea Kimi Antonelli (Italian - Mercedes)

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(He became the youngest Monaco Grand Prix winner in history.)

- Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix 2026 – Lewis Hamilton (British - Ferrari)

❖ Some Important Acquisitions & Mergers in June 2026:

- American investment firm GQG Partners sold a 1.85% stake worth Rs 1,906 crore in GMR Airports Infrastructure Limited (GAL) to Fidelity International Limited (FIL).

- SoftBank Group has divested a 3.25% stake in eyewear retailer Lenskart Solutions for ₹2,873.30 crore ($300.2 million) through an open market block deal. This strategic secondary market transaction was executed on the National Stock Exchange (NSE) via SoftBank's affiliate, SVF II Lightbulb (Cayman) Ltd.

- CCI approved the acquisition of a 2.80% stake in Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited (SLIC) by Sanlam Emerging Markets (Mauritius) Limited (SEMM) for a total consideration of ₹220.88 crore.

- CCI approved the acquisition of a 29.06% stake in Germany-based global sportswear giant PUMA SE by Ancat Holding GmbH, an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary and dedicated acquisition vehicle of China-based ANTA Sports Group.

- CCI officially approved the acquisition of a 2.80% stake in Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited (SLIC) by Sanlam Emerging Markets (Mauritius) Ltd (SEMM).

- An investment arm of the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust, is set to sell 2.3% equity stake in Lenskart Solutions through a secondary block deal valued at approximately ₹1,944 crore ($204 million).

- Oman India Joint Investment Fund II (OIJIF II) has offloaded a 3.65% stake in Jalandhar-based Capital Small Finance Bank for approximately ₹36.79 crore through a bulk block deal on the National Stock Exchange (NSE).

- The Government of India launched an Offer for Sale (OFS) to divest up to a 3% equity stake in state-run mining and power generation firm NLC India Limited. The transaction, overseen by the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM), aimed to raise up to ₹1,263.51 crore.

- The President has approved the merger of REC Ltd with Power Finance Corporation, nearly 7 years after PFC acquired the government's majority stake in REC. In March 2019, state-owned PFC completed the acquisition of the government's majority stake of 52.63% in REC Ltd for Rs 14,500 crore.

- The CCI officially approved the acquisition of PGIM India Asset Management Pvt. Ltd. and PGIM India Trustees Pvt. Ltd. by TVS Emerald Ltd. and TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Pvt. Ltd. The acquirers will buy 100% of the issued, subscribed, and paid-up share capital of both target entities.

- CCI approved the acquisition of a stake in Nxtra Data Limited by Alpha Wave Ventures II, LP. Alpha Wave Global will invest $435 million as part of a larger $1 billion funding round. The remaining capital will be infused by Carlyle, Anchorage Capital, and parent company Bharti Airtel. Following the completion of this transaction, Nxtra Data will be valued at approximately $3.1 billion.

- CCI approved the acquisition of an additional 21% voting interest in Astemo Ltd. by Honda Motor Co., Ltd. from Hitachi, Ltd. for approximately ¥152.3 billion (~$941.7 million).

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❖ Do not miss to study our "Smart Topic-wise PDF" that includes following topics:

- National Parks / Wildlife Sanctuaries / Tiger Reserves
- Miscellaneous News & Current Static GK
- Books & Authors
- Appointments in One-liner form
- Awards & Recognitions in One-liner form
- India's Ranks in various Reports/Indexes
- Venues & Themes of All Important Meetings/Summits/Conferences (It includes some extra events too.)
- MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships in One-liner form
- Important Days & Themes
- Latest GDP Predictions by various organisations

Important Books & Authors	
"Better Never Stops: Leadership insights from Life's Unscripted Moments''	Shyam Srinivasan (Former CEO of Federal Bank)
"When Audit Matters: CAG Interventions That Made a Difference''	Vinod Rai (Former CAG)
"Giorgia's Vision''	Giorgia Meloni
"Zubeen Garg - The voice that Bridged Worlds''	Prosenjit Nath
"Agatthiyar – The Unifier'' (Released by - C. P. Radhakrishnan, Vice President of India)	O Shama Bhat & Dr. M. N. Sudha
"IIT: The Story of India's Most Prestigious Educational Ecosystem" (Launched by - Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla | Published by - HarperCollins India)	Prabhat Kumar

Important Days	
June 1	World Milk Day (Theme - "Celebrating Women Farmers")
	Global Day of Parents
June 2	International Sex Workers' Day (since 1975)
	12th Foundation Day of Telangana (Telangana was officially as India's 29th state in 2014, following the bifurcation of undivided Andhra Pradesh.)
June 3	World Bicycle Day (Theme - "Cycling for a Greener Future")
June 4	UN International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression
	International Seaweed Day
June 5	World Environment Day (Theme - "Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.")
	International Day for the Fight against Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated Fishing
	International Level Crossing Awareness Day (Slogan - "Alert Today, Safe Tomorrow")

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	World Day Against Speciesism (Aim: To raise awareness against discrimination based on species) (The term 'Speciesism' was coined in 1970 by psychologist and ethicist Dr. Richard D. Ryder.)
June 6	UN Russian Language Day (In 2010, the United Nations introduced dedicated days for each of the UN's six official languages: Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian, & Spanish) (The day also marks the 227th birth anniversary of Alexander Sergeevich Pushkin, the 'Father of Modern Russian Literature')
	World Pest Day or World Pest Awareness Day (Theme - "Defending Health Across Borders: The Global Power of Pest Management")
June 7	World Food Safety Day (Theme - "From Burden to Solutions: Safe Food Everywhere")
June 8	UN World Oceans Day (Theme - "Reimagine: Beyond the World We Know, a New Relationship with Our Ocean")
	World Brain Tumor Day (since 2000) (symbol - Grey Ribbon) (Theme - "A Closer Look")
June 9	World Accreditation Day (since 2008) (Theme - "Innovation, Trust and Sustainability: The Power of Accreditation")
	International Archives Day (Theme - "#ArchivesForJustice: Rights, Memory & Futures")
June 10	International Day for Dialogue among Civilizations
June 11	International Day of Play (Theme - "Protect Play, Protect Childhood")
June 12	World Day Against Child Labour (Theme - "Red Card to Child Labour: Fair Play for Children, Decent Work for Adults")
June 8-12	International Archives Week (Theme - "Archives for Justice: Rights, Memory & Futures")
June 13	International Albinism Awareness Day (Theme - "Proudly in My Skin - Celebrating All Skin Tones")
June 14	World Blood Donor Day (Theme - "One Drop of Humanity. Give Blood. Save Lives.")
June 15	World Elder Abuse Awareness Day (Theme - "Beyond Awareness: Making Elder Abuse Prevention Work")
	Global Wind Day
	Asean Dengue Day (Theme - "ASEAN United: Zero Dengue Deaths – A Future We Build Together by 2030")
June 16	UN International Day of Family Remittances (Theme - "Beyond Transfers: Turning Remittances into Rural Resilience, Entrepreneurship and Employment")
June 17	World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought (Theme - "Rangelands: Recognize. Respect. Restore.")
	World Crocodile Day (Theme - "Legacy in Every Scale")
June 18	Sustainable Gastronomy Day
	International Day for Countering Hate Speech (Theme - "Hate Speech and Artificial Intelligence")

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	World Autistic Pride Day (Theme - “Acceptance, inclusion, and autistic identity”)
	International Picnic Day
June 19	International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict (since 2015) (Campaign Focus - “Conflict-Related Sexual Violence Against Children Safeguarding Futures and Empowering Caregivers”)
	World Refugee Day (2001) (Theme - “Solidarity with Refugees”)
	World Sickle Cell Day (Theme - “Closing the Survival Gap: Equity in Sickle Cell Disease”)
	National Reading Day (The day honors the legacy of P.N. Panicker, the “Father of the Library Movement in Kerala”)
June 21	12th International Day of Yoga (Theme - “Yoga for Healthy Ageing”)
	UN International Day of the Celebration of the Solstice
	World Music Day
	World Hydrography Day (since 2006) (Theme - “Transforming How Ocean Data is Shared”)
June 16-22	Sustainable Gastronomy Week (Theme - “Celebrating Food Heritage”)
June 23	United Nations Public Service Day (Theme - “Transforming Public Institutions: Advancing Innovation, Participation, and Inclusion.”)
	International Widows’ Day (Theme - “Invisible Women, Invisible Problems.”)
June 24	International Day of Women in Diplomacy
	Passport Seva Divas (The day commemorates the enactment of the Passports Act in 1967.)
June 25	Day of the Seafarer (since 2011) (Theme - “Carrying World Trade. Carrying the Risks.”)
	World Vitiligo Day (Theme - “From Stigma to Strength”)
	Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas (On this day in 1975, then-President Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed proclaimed a National Emergency under Article 352 of the Constitution, citing threats arising from internal disturbances.)
June 26	UN International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking (Theme - “World Drug Problem: Persisting Issues, New Challenges, Innovative Responses.”)
	UN International Day in Support of Victims of Torture
	World Refrigeration Day (Theme - “Cool Intelligence”)
June 27	International Day of Deafblindness
	World MSME Day (Theme - “Empowering MSMEs through Innovation and Sustainable Industrial Development”)
June 21-27	World Allergy Week (Theme - “Allergy Care is Essential Care.”)
June 28	National Insurance Awareness Day (originated in USA)
June 29	UN International Day of the Tropics

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	20th National Statistics Day (It honors the birth anniversary of Professor Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis)
June 30	World Asteroid Day
	International Day of Parliamentarism or World Parliament Day (Theme - "Bring Human Rights into Focus")

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